Future Founder & Leader

Curriculum Handbook

40 quarterly projects · 168 lessons · ages 9–14

Compiled verbatim from the validated curriculum content. Interactive version: **athlon1987.github.io/fullstack-nanodegree-vm**

How this curriculum works

Each age band runs four **pillars** in parallel — Think, Communicate, Build, and Create Wealth — with one quarterly **project** per pillar. Every project ends in a real, tangible **artifact**, and every lesson follows the same six-step loop:

1. **Concept** — learn the idea
2. **Real example** — see it in the world
3. **Apply it** — advance the project artifact
4. **Reflect** — think about what happened
5. **Get feedback** — improve it
6. **Teach it back** — teach someone else (the retention step)

Every lesson also carries an **AI judgment note**: when to reach for AI and — more important — when not to. Projects and lessons unlock in order via prerequisites; success criteria are observable things a parent can verify.

Age band	Status
9–10	Complete — 16 projects, 4 per pillar
11–12	Complete — 16 projects, 4 per pillar
13–14	In progress — 8 of 16 projects

Contents

- Create Wealth Q1: Ship a Real Micro-Offer
- Create Wealth Q2: Know Your Numbers

Ages 9-10

THINK · Q1

The Noticing Game

th-9-10-q1 · supporting: Explore

WHAT’S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, thinking is concrete and literal, and learning happens through play, doing, and collecting rather than abstract discussion. Kids this age are natural noticers and sorters — they love grouping, comparing, and asking 'why' — but they can't yet hold a hypothesis or run a fair test the way an older child can. Keep every loop short, hands-on, and finishing the same day, or attention drifts.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value at this age is being the one who *noticed* something real that everyone else walked past, and getting to share it. It's not money and not a product — it's 'look what I found out'. The audience is family and friends, and the reward is their genuine interest.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child becomes a 'noticer' — collecting and studying ordinary things (leaves, coins, sounds, bugs) and spotting things grown-ups miss. The pull is the pride of being sharp-eyed and the small delight of surprising an adult with something they noticed. Collecting and sorting are already deeply satisfying at this age, so the activity motivates itself.

THE ARTIFACT

A 'noticing journal' or discovery card: a small collection the child observed and sorted into groups, with one real 'why' question and their best guess at the answer.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child looked closely enough to describe details they hadn't noticed before.
- They sorted their collection into groups and can explain the rule they used.
- They asked one real 'why' question and offered a guess.

1 Look really closely

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Most people glance at things. A noticer *looks* — long enough to see the little details everyone else misses. Slowing down and really looking is the first thinking skill.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Look at a single leaf for a whole minute. Suddenly you see tiny lines, little holes, colours changing at the edge — all there the whole time, just unnoticed.

3 APPLY IT

Pick five ordinary things (a coin, a leaf, a shoe, whatever). Look at each for one minute and write or draw one detail you'd never noticed before.

4 REFLECT

Which thing surprised you most when you really looked? Was the detail there all along?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show an adult one of your things and share your detail. Ask if they'd ever noticed it. Their surprise is your reward.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Play the one-minute looking game with a younger child and help them find a detail.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a look-with-your-own-eyes game — no screen needed. The whole point is *you* noticing, which a computer can't do for you.

You'll need: Noticing journal pages (5 slots for detail drawings)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Five never-before-noticed details are recorded from real objects.

2 Sort it into groups

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Once you've collected things, you can sort them — big/small, smooth/rough, by colour. Sorting is thinking: you're deciding what's the same and what's different, and picking a rule.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Tip out a box of buttons and you'll naturally start grouping them — by colour, then by size. Scientists sort the whole world this way, from animals to stars.

3 APPLY IT

Gather a collection (leaves, rocks, toys, coins). Sort it into groups. Write down the rule you used, then re-sort it a totally different way.

4 REFLECT

You sorted the same things two different ways — so which grouping is 'right'? (Trick question: it depends on what you care about.)

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your groups to someone and see if they can guess your sorting rule. If they can't, was your rule clear?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Give a friend your collection and challenge them to sort it, then explain their rule to you.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Sort with your own hands and eyes — that's the thinking. No app needed to move real objects into real piles.

You'll need: Sorting mat / group labels

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A collection was sorted two different ways with each rule stated.

Unlocks after: Look really closely

3 Ask a big 'why?'

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Noticers don't just look — they wonder. Pick one thing you noticed and ask why it's like that. Then make your best guess. A good guess isn't cheating; it's how thinking starts.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Why are most leaves green?' or 'Why do heavier coins feel colder?' You don't need the final answer yet — asking the question and guessing is the win.

3 APPLY IT

Pick one thing from your collection and write a 'why' question about it. Then write your best guess at the answer.

4 REFLECT

Where did your guess come from — something you already knew? Good guesses usually connect to things you've seen before.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask an adult your 'why' question. Compare their answer to your guess. Were you close?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Ask a family member to make up their own 'why' question about something at home, and swap guesses.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Make your *own* guess first, before anyone (or any computer) tells you the answer. The guessing is the exercise; getting handed the answer skips the workout.

You'll need: Why-question + guess card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One real 'why' question and a reasoned guess are written down.

Unlocks after: Sort it into groups

4 Share your discovery

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

A discovery isn't finished until you share it. Telling someone what you noticed, sorted, and wondered turns you from a looker into a discoverer.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Show-and-tell works because sharing a real find is exciting for everyone. 'Look what I noticed' is a great thing to be able to say.

3 APPLY IT

Finish your noticing journal (details + your groups + your why-question and guess) and present it to your family like a real discovery.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to share something *you* noticed? Which part were you proudest of?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your listeners what they found most interesting. Note it — it tells you what makes a discovery exciting to others.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help someone else in your family start their own noticing journal.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Share it with real people, face to face. The joy here is a real person going 'wow, I never noticed that' — that's a human moment, not a screen one.

You'll need: Completed noticing-journal template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The child presented a completed noticing journal to a real audience.

Unlocks after: Ask a big 'why?'

THINK · Q2

The Deciding Game

th-9-10-q2 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can compare two things but tend to decide on impulse or on a single flashy feature — the biggest, the shiniest, the one their friend picked. They're ready to learn that a choice can be made *on purpose*, by listing reasons, if the choices are concrete and real (which pet, how to spend Saturday, which project to do). Having just practised noticing in Q1, they can now notice the differences that matter between options.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being a good decider — making a choice you can actually explain, instead of 'I just wanted to'. At this age it's the pride of being trusted to decide something real, and being able to give your reasons like a grown-up.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child gets to make a *real* decision that actually counts — and the deal is: you can choose, as long as you can explain why. Being genuinely trusted with a real choice is deeply motivating at this age, and the 'explain your reason' rule turns a snap judgement into real thinking without it feeling like a chore.

THE ARTIFACT

A real decision the child made using a good-points / not-so-good-points comparison, captured on a decision card with the final choice and the main reason for it.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child compared at least two real options side by side.
- They listed good and not-so-good points for each instead of deciding on one feature.
- They can explain the single reason that tipped their choice.

Unlocks after: The Noticing Game

1 Two choices, side by side

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

The first step in a good decision is putting your choices next to each other so you can really see them. It's hard to choose well when the options are jumbled in your head — line them up.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Deciding how to spend Saturday? Write it out: 'Option A: go to the park. Option B: build a fort.' Now you can actually look at them instead of just feeling torn.

3 APPLY IT

Think of a real choice you have this week. Write your two options side by side on a card.

4 REFLECT

Was it easier to think once you saw both written down? Our heads get muddled; paper helps.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your two options to a parent and check you've written them clearly.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling line up two choices they're stuck between.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is your real choice about your real life — a computer doesn't know what you'd enjoy. Line the options up yourself.

You'll need: Decision card (two-option layout)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Two real options are written side by side.

2 Good points and not-so-good points

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Every choice has good bits and not-so-good bits. A good decider looks at *both* for each option, instead of only seeing the fun part of the one they already want.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Park: good — fresh air, friends; not-so-good — might rain. Fort: good — cosy, creative; not-so-good — big mess to clean up. Now the choice is clearer.

3 APPLY IT

For each of your two options, write two good points and one not-so-good point.

4 REFLECT

Did writing the not-so-good points change how you felt about your favourite? Sometimes it does.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask someone if they can think of a good or not-so-good point you missed.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend how to find the 'not-so-good points' of something they're excited about.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You know your life best — the real good and bad points come from you, not a screen. Do the thinking yourself.

You'll need: Good/not-so-good points sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Both options have good and not-so-good points listed.

Unlocks after: Two choices, side by side

3 What matters most?

~15 min

1 **CONCEPT**

Usually one thing matters most to you. Naming it helps you decide. If staying dry matters most today, that points one way; if being creative matters most, another. The deciding reason is the one you care about most.

2 **REAL EXAMPLE**

If you really don't want to clean up a big mess today, that one thing might tip you to the park — even if the fort sounded fun. Knowing what matters most decides it.

3 **APPLY IT**

Look at your points and circle the ONE that matters most to you right now. That's your deciding reason.

4 **REFLECT**

Was it easy to pick the one that matters most? Sometimes two feel equal — then you get to just choose.

5 **GET FEEDBACK**

Tell someone your 'matters most' point and see if they understand why it's the tie-breaker for you.

6 **TEACH IT BACK ★**

Ask a family member what would matter most to *them* in your choice — notice it might be different!

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

What matters most to you is *yours* — nobody else, and no computer, can decide what you care about most.

You'll need: Matters-most circle card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One 'matters most' reason is identified.

Unlocks after: Good points and not-so-good points

4 Decide and explain

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Now make your choice and say your reason out loud. 'I chose the park because staying dry mattered most today.' A decision you can explain is a good decision — even if it turns out imperfect.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Explaining your reason is what makes you a decider, not a coin-flipper. And if it doesn't go perfectly, you'll know exactly what to think about next time.

3 APPLY IT

Make your real choice and write (or say) your one-sentence reason on your decision card. Then actually do it!

4 REFLECT

After doing it — was it a good choice? What did you learn for next time? (Both good and 'oops' are useful.)

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent your choice and reason. Ask if your reason made sense to them.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk a sibling through the whole Deciding Game with a small choice of their own.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Owning your choice — and its reason — is the skill. It has to be your decision, made and explained by you.

You'll need: Completed decision card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real decision was made and carried out.
☐ The child stated a one-sentence reason for it.

Unlocks after: What matters most?

THINK · Q3

Step by Step

th-9-10-q3 · supporting: Build

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children often freeze at a task that looks 'too hard' because they see it as one big scary lump. Learning to break a tricky task into small steps and do them one at a time is a genuine superpower they can grasp now, especially with concrete tasks (a recipe, a build, a puzzle). Having learned to notice (Q1) and decide (Q2), they now learn to actually *tackle* something hard.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is getting through something that felt too hard by breaking it down — the proud realisation that 'hard' usually just means 'lots of small steps I haven't sorted yet'. It's the first taste of not giving up when something looks big.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child picks something they've wanted to do but that felt too hard, and conquers it by breaking it into steps. The triumph of finishing a 'too hard' thing — and realising the trick that made it possible — is powerfully motivating, and it builds the grit to try the next hard thing.

THE ARTIFACT

A tricky task the child broke into small steps and completed, with the steps written out as a 'step ladder' they followed.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child took something that felt too big and broke it into small steps.
- They put the steps in a sensible order and did them one at a time.
- They finished the task, or got much further than they would have by charging in.

Unlocks after: The Deciding Game

1 Big things feel scary in one lump

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

When something looks 'too hard', it's usually because you're seeing the whole thing at once. 'Tidy my whole messy room' feels impossible. But it's really just a pile of small, easy jobs hiding inside one big scary word.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Bake a cake' sounds hard. But it's really: get ingredients, mix, pour, bake, wait, decorate. Six small steps — each one easy. The lump was the only scary part.

3 APPLY IT

Pick one real thing you've been putting off because it feels too big. Just name it for now.

4 REFLECT

Why has this felt too hard? Is it really hard, or just big?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent your 'too big' task and see if they agree it's been feeling scary as one lump.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Ask a family member about a task *they* find too big, and guess why it feels that way.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Pick something from your own real life — you know best what's been nagging at you. This is your task to name.

You'll need: Too-big-task card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One real 'too big' task is named.

2 Break it into a step ladder

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Now chop the big task into small steps — each one a single easy thing you could do in a few minutes. Write them as a ladder, bottom to top. Suddenly the impossible thing is just a list of easy things.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Tidy my room' becomes: 1) pick up clothes, 2) put books on shelf, 3) clear the desk, 4) bin the rubbish, 5) make the bed. Five easy rungs instead of one scary word.

3 APPLY IT

Break your task into small steps and write them as a step ladder, in order.

4 REFLECT

Does the task look less scary now it's a list of small steps? That shrinking feeling is the whole trick.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your step ladder to someone. Ask if any step is still too big and needs splitting again.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling turn one of their big tasks into a step ladder.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Try breaking it down yourself first — figuring out the steps is the brain exercise. If you get stuck, an adult can help more than a screen, because they know your task.

You'll need: Step-ladder worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The task is broken into ordered small steps.

Unlocks after: Big things feel scary in one lump

3 One step at a time

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Now just do the first step. Then the next. Don't look at the whole ladder — look at the one rung in front of you. Ticking off steps one by one is how big things actually get done.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You don't climb a ladder by jumping to the top — you take one rung at a time. Same with your task: first step done, tick, next step. Before long, you're at the top.

3 APPLY IT

Do your task one step at a time, ticking off each step as you finish it.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to tick off each step? Small wins add up to a big finish.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show someone your ticked-off ladder as you go. Let them cheer each step.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why doing 'one rung at a time' beats staring at the whole ladder.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is you doing the real work, step by step. The doing is yours — a computer can't tick your rungs for you.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The child worked through the steps in order, tracking progress.

Unlocks after: Break it into a step ladder

4 Stuck? Try, tweak, ask

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Sometimes a step is harder than expected. That's normal — it doesn't mean stop. Try it, tweak your way if it doesn't work, and ask for help if you're really stuck. Getting unstuck is part of the skill.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

If 'put books on the shelf' fails because the shelf is full, you tweak: maybe some books go in a box. A blocked step isn't the end — it's a little puzzle inside the big one.

3 APPLY IT

Find the step that was trickiest and write what you did to get past it — a tweak, a try, or asking someone.

4 REFLECT

When you got stuck, what helped most — trying again, changing your plan, or asking? Remember it for next time.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell an adult about a step you got stuck on and how you got unstuck. Ask if they'd have done it differently.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the 'try, tweak, ask' trick for when a step gets hard.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

When stuck, a real person who knows your task usually helps more than a screen. Learn to ask for help — that's a strength, not a weakness.

You'll need: Got-unstuck card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The task was finished or substantially advanced.
☐ The child can describe how they handled a stuck moment.

Unlocks after: One step at a time

THINK · Q4

Plan the Showcase

th-9-10-q4 · supporting: Communicate, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

This is the year's capstone, and Think leads it. At 9–10, a child can genuinely plan a small real event if it's broken into steps (Q3), helped along with clear decisions (Q2), and grounded in noticing what's needed (Q1). Owning the plan for a real Showcase Day — a small at-home event where they show and sell what they've made this year — is a huge, proud milestone. Keep the scope small and the child genuinely in charge.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being the *planner* of a real event that actually happens — the whole year's thinking skills put to work on something that matters. It's the leap from doing small tasks to organising a whole day, and being trusted to do it.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child is put genuinely in charge of planning a real event that their family will attend. Being trusted to run the plan — making the decisions, owning the list, setting the date — is enormously motivating at this age. The event is real, the responsibility is real, and that pulls their best thinking out of them.

THE ARTIFACT

A written plan for Showcase Day: what the day will include, a list of everything needed, a step-ladder of things to do (with who and when), and the key decisions made — pulling together noticing, deciding, and step-planning from the whole year.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child decided what Showcase Day will include and can explain their choices.
- They listed what's needed and broke the preparation into ordered steps.
- They presented the plan and a real date was set.

Unlocks after: Step by Step

1 What's the showcase?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

First, decide what your Showcase Day will be: a small event where you show and share the things you've made this year, with a little stall to sell some. Use your deciding skills to choose what to include — you can't do everything, so pick the best bits.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your showcase might be: a table showing your inventions and digital creation, a little stall selling your bookmarks, and a five-minute 'tour' you give your family. Small, real, and doable in an afternoon.

3 APPLY IT

Decide what your Showcase Day will include. Write a short list of the 3–4 things that will happen.

4 REFLECT

Did you pick things you're proud of and that are doable at home? What did you leave out, and why?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Share your showcase idea with a parent and check it's the right size — not too big, not too small.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a sibling what your Showcase Day will be and why you chose those parts.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is your day, built from your year — you decide what goes in it. That's yours, not a computer's.

You'll need: Showcase plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A short list of what Showcase Day will include is decided.

2 Notice what's needed

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Use your noticing skills to spot everything the day needs — a table, chairs, signs, snacks, money box, your things to show. Missing one thing can cause a wobble on the day, so list it all now.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A stall needs: a table, a sign with prices, your things laid out, a box for money, and a chair. Noticing all of it beforehand means no panic on the day.

3 APPLY IT

Walk through your Showcase Day in your mind and list everything you'll need for each part.

4 REFLECT

Which thing would be easiest to forget? Those are exactly the ones a good list catches.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your 'needed' list to a parent and ask what you've missed.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a family member list what's needed for something *they're* planning.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Picturing your real day at your real home is something only you can do. Walk through it in your own mind.

You'll need: Needed-things checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A checklist of everything needed for the day exists.

Unlocks after: What's the showcase?

3 Make the step ladder

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Now use your step-by-step skill to turn the whole plan into ordered steps: what to do this week, what to do the day before, what to do on the morning. A big event is just a step ladder, same as any tricky task.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

This week: make the goods and the sign. Day before: set up the table, make snacks. Morning of: lay out the stall, put up signs, invite everyone in. One rung at a time.

3 APPLY IT

Break your whole plan into a step ladder, in order, with roughly when each step happens.

4 REFLECT

Looking at your ladder, is anything left too late? Better to spot it now than the morning of.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your step ladder to a parent and agree which steps they might help with.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone how a whole event becomes a simple step ladder.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Build your own ladder — sequencing the steps is the thinking. An adult can help with timing since they know the household's week.

You’ll need: Event step-ladder sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The preparation is broken into an ordered, timed step ladder.

Unlocks after: Notice what's needed

4 Share the plan and set the date

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

A plan isn't real until people agree to it. Present your whole plan to your family, get their buy-in, and set a real date. Now Showcase Day is actually happening — and the other three parts (inviting, making, selling) can begin.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You show your family the plan, they say 'great — let's do it two Saturdays from now', and suddenly it's real. That date is what turns a plan into an event.

3 APPLY IT

Present your full plan to your family and agree on a real date for Showcase Day. Write the date at the top of your plan.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to present a whole plan you made? What questions did your family ask?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family if the plan makes sense and if the date works for everyone.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the whole plan for your Showcase Day as if inviting them to help.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a real family conversation to agree a real date — a very human, in-person moment. Present it yourself, proudly.

You'll need: Finalised plan with date

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The plan was presented to the family.
☐ A real date for Showcase Day was set.

Unlocks after: Make the step ladder

COMMUNICATE · Q1

Tell a Story People Remember

co-9-10-q1 · supporting: Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children love stories and can retell events, but they tend to ramble — every detail feels equally important and the point gets lost. 'Beginning, middle, end' is a handle they can genuinely grasp at this age, and they light up performing for a real audience. Keep it spoken and playful; writing long pieces is a different, harder skill best kept small here.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value at this age is a listener who's genuinely gripped — leaning in, laughing, remembering your story afterward. It's the first taste of holding an audience, usually family or friends, with something you experienced or imagined.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child tells a real story to a real listener and finds out whether it landed — did they laugh, gasp, remember it later? A live audience reacting (or not) is powerfully motivating at this age; performing and being enjoyed feels great, and the flat moments teach fast.

THE ARTIFACT

A short told-or-recorded story (2–3 minutes) about something real that happened, with a clear beginning, middle, and end, delivered to a real listener.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The story has a clear beginning, middle, and end a listener can follow.
- The child left out boring bits and kept the interesting part.
- A real listener could retell the main thing that happened afterward.

1 Beginning, middle, end

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Every good story has three parts: a beginning (who and where), a middle (what happened — usually a problem or surprise), and an end (how it turned out). That shape is what makes a story feel like a story.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'I went to the park (beginning), a dog stole my sandwich (middle), and the owner bought me an ice cream to say sorry (end).' Simple — but it's a real story because it has all three.

3 APPLY IT

Think of something real that happened to you. Say it in just three sentences: beginning, middle, end.

4 REFLECT

Which part was hardest to pin down? Often it's the middle — the actual interesting thing.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell your three-sentence version to someone. Ask if it felt complete or like something was missing.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a younger child turn something that happened to them into a beginning-middle-end.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use your own real memory here — a story that happened to *you* beats any made-up one a computer could write, because you actually lived it.

You'll need: Three-part story card (beginning / middle / end)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real event is told in a clear three-part shape.

2 Keep the good part

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

A rambly story buries the good bit under boring details. Find the most interesting moment — the surprise, the problem, the funny part — and make sure it shines. Cut the rest.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Nobody needs to hear what you had for breakfast before the dog stole your sandwich. Skip to the good part — the theft!

3 APPLY IT

Take your story and underline the single most interesting moment. Cross out two boring details that don't help it.

4 REFLECT

Was it hard to cut things? We get attached to details even when they slow the story down.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell the trimmed version to someone. Did it feel snappier than before?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Listen to a friend's story and gently help them spot the one boring bit to cut.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You decide what the 'good part' is — it's your story and your sense of what's exciting. That judgement is yours to build, not a computer's to hand you.

You'll need: Story-trimming worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The most interesting moment is identified and at least two boring details cut.

Unlocks after: Beginning, middle, end

3 Use your voice and face

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

The same words are boring in a flat voice and thrilling with expression. Slowing down at the exciting bit, going quiet, making a face — that's how you pull a listener in.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Watch how a good storyteller drops their voice to a whisper right before the scary part. You lean in without even deciding to.

3 APPLY IT

Tell your story out loud twice — once totally flat, once with your best voice and faces. Feel the difference.

4 REFLECT

Which version would *you* rather listen to? What did your voice do at the exciting moment?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Perform the expressive version for someone and watch their face. Did they react more than to the flat one?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a family member the flat-vs-expressive trick with a single sentence.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is all you — your real voice and face. It's a performing skill, and no screen can do the performing for you.

You'll need: Expression practice prompts

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The story was performed with deliberate voice/expression changes at key moments.

Unlocks after: Keep the good part

4 Tell it for real

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Now put it together and tell your whole story to a real audience. The test of a story is simple: can they remember what happened afterward?

2 REAL EXAMPLE

If your friend is still talking about your sandwich-thief dog the next day, your story worked. Being remembered is the goal.

3 APPLY IT

Tell (or record) your full 2–3 minute story for a real listener, using your three-part shape, the good part, and your best expression.

4 REFLECT

Where did your listener react most? That's the part that worked — remember what you did there.

5 GET FEEDBACK

A little later, ask your listener to retell your story. What they remember (and forget) shows you what landed.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Coach someone else through telling their story to a real audience.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Tell it to a real person, not a device. The whole reward — a human remembering your story — only happens with a real listener.

You'll need: Listener retell check card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A complete story was told to a real audience.
☐ The listener could retell the main event afterward.

Unlocks after: Use your voice and face

COMMUNICATE · Q2

Ask and Listen

co-9-10-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can ask questions but often wait to talk rather than truly listen, and their questions tend to be yes/no ones. Learning to ask an open question and actually listen to the answer is a real leap. Interviewing a real person they like — a grandparent, a neighbour, a family friend — is concrete, warm, and gives instant reward. Having learned to *tell* a story in Q1, they now learn to *draw out* someone else's.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is making a real person feel truly listened to, and learning something about them you never knew. At this age that connection — an older person lighting up because a child actually wanted to hear their story — is the whole reward.

MOTIVATION LEVER — BELONGING

The child interviews someone they care about and discovers a real story they'd never heard. The warm connection — someone feeling genuinely listened to, and the child feeling closer to them — is powerfully motivating at this age. It turns 'practising questions' into a real relationship moment they'll want to repeat.

THE ARTIFACT

A short interview of a real person: a few good questions asked, answers truly listened to, and one surprising or interesting thing learned, shared back to the family.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child asked at least two open questions (not just yes/no ones).
- They listened well enough to ask a follow-up based on the answer.
- They can share one thing they learned that they didn't know before.

Unlocks after: Tell a Story People Remember

1 Questions that open people up

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Some questions get a one-word answer ('Did you like school?' → 'Yes'). Others open people up ('What was school like when you were my age?'). Open questions start with what, how, or why and invite a real story.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Was your childhood fun?' gets a shrug. 'What did you do for fun when there were no phones?' gets a whole story. Same idea, very different question.

3 APPLY IT

Write three open questions (starting with what, how, or why) for someone you'd like to interview.

4 REFLECT

Which of your questions do you think will get the best story? Why that one?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Read your questions to a parent and ask which would open *them* up most.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling turn a yes/no question into an open one.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI could suggest generic questions, but the best ones fit the real person you're interviewing — and only you know them. Write your own.

You'll need: Open-question starter card (what/how/why)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three open questions are written for a real person.

2 Really listen

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Listening isn't waiting for your turn to talk — it's actually taking in what the person says. Look at them, don't interrupt, and let there be little quiet gaps. Good listeners make people want to keep talking.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You can feel the difference between someone who's really listening and someone who's just nodding while thinking about themselves. Be the first kind.

3 APPLY IT

Practise listening with a family member for two minutes: they talk, you only listen — no interrupting. Then tell them one thing they said.

4 REFLECT

Was it hard not to jump in? Most people find it surprisingly tricky to just listen.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the person: 'Did you feel listened to?' Their answer tells you how you did.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Play the two-minute listening game with a friend and swap roles.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Listening is a human-to-human skill — a screen can't practise it for you. This one's all about real attention to a real person.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The child listened without interrupting and recalled what was said.

Unlocks after: Questions that open people up

3 Ask 'tell me more'

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

The magic follow-up is simple: 'tell me more' or 'why was that?' It shows you were listening and it unlocks the best part of the story — the bit that doesn't come out in the first answer.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Grandpa says 'I had a dog named Rex.' You say 'tell me more about Rex!' — and out comes the whole adventure. The follow-up got the good stuff.

3 APPLY IT

Do your real interview. Ask your open questions, listen, and use 'tell me more' at least twice.

4 REFLECT

Which 'tell me more' got the best story? Following someone's answer beats sticking to your list.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Notice how the person responds when you ask for more — do they light up? That's you doing it right.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone the 'tell me more' trick and how it unlocks better stories.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Following up means responding to what the *real* person actually just said — you can only do that live, in the moment. No script or app can do it for you.

You'll need: Interview record sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real interview happened with at least two follow-up questions used.

Unlocks after: Really listen

4 Share what you learned

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Finish by sharing the best thing you learned with your family. Passing on someone's story is a kind of gift — and it makes the person you interviewed feel special.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Did you know Grandpa once had a dog who followed him to school every day?' Now the whole family knows a story that might have been lost. You saved it.

3 APPLY IT

Share the most interesting thing you learned with your family, told as a little story (using your Q1 storytelling skills!).

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to pass on someone's story? Did the person you interviewed enjoy being talked about?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family what surprised them most about what you learned.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Encourage a family member to interview someone and share what *they* learn.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Real stories from real people are treasures a computer could never invent. Share this one proudly — it's genuinely yours to tell.

You'll need: Story-share card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One thing learned was shared as a short story to the family.
☐ The child connected it back to the real person interviewed.

Unlocks after: Ask 'tell me more'

COMMUNICATE · Q3

Make Your Case

co-9-10-q3 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children often ask for things by whining, demanding, or repeating 'pleeease'. They're ready to learn something better: making a calm, clear case with real reasons. They can hold two or three reasons in mind and, with help, anticipate the grown-up's likely 'but'. Real stakes make this land — a later bedtime, a pet, a class idea. Having learned to listen in Q2, they now learn to be worth listening to.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being taken seriously — getting a fair hearing, and sometimes a yes, because you made a thoughtful case instead of a fuss. It's the discovery that good reasons, said calmly, are far more powerful than volume.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child argues for something they genuinely want, and finds that a calm, reasoned case gets them taken seriously in a way whining never does. The pull is real influence over their own life — being heard and treated like someone with sensible reasons. That taste of being taken seriously makes them want to do it well.

THE ARTIFACT

A real case the child made to a real person (a parent or teacher) for something they want, using two or three reasons and a response to the likely 'but'.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child gave two or three real reasons, not just 'because I want it'.
- They thought about the other person's likely worry and had a response.
- They made the case calmly and can say how it was received.

Unlocks after: Ask and Listen

1 A good reason beats a whine

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Whining and demanding make people say no faster. A calm, clear reason makes them actually think about it. The secret to getting a fair hearing isn't being louder — it's being reasonable.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Can I stay up later, PLEEEASE?' gets a quick no. 'Could I stay up 15 minutes later on Fridays, since there's no school the next day?' gets a real 'hmm, let me think.' The reason changed everything.

3 APPLY IT

Think of one real thing you'd like to ask for. Write it as a calm request instead of a demand.

4 REFLECT

How do you usually ask for things — calmly or with a fuss? Which do you think works better?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Try your calm version on a parent (just the request, no reasons yet) and notice if they listen differently.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a sibling the difference between whining for something and asking calmly.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is about your real wish and your real family — you know the situation. Frame your own request; it means more coming from you.

You’ll need: Calm-request card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real want is framed as a calm request rather than a demand.

2 Give two or three reasons

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

'Because I want it' isn't a reason — it's a wish. Real reasons explain *why* it's a good idea, ideally good for others too, not just you. Two or three solid reasons make a case hard to wave away.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

For the later Friday bedtime: 1) no school next day, 2) I'll still get enough sleep, 3) we could use it as family film time. Three reasons — and one even helps the whole family.

3 APPLY IT

Write two or three real reasons for your request. Try to make at least one good for someone besides you.

4 REFLECT

Which of your reasons is strongest? Reasons that help others too are often the most convincing.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Test your reasons on someone neutral. Ask which reason they find most convincing.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend find a 'good for others too' reason for something they want.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Come up with your own reasons first — thinking of *why* is the real skill. If you ask AI, you must believe the reasons yourself, or they'll sound fake when you say them.

You'll need: Reasons worksheet (2–3 slots)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Two or three genuine reasons are written, ideally one benefiting others.

Unlocks after: A good reason beats a whine

3 Answer the 'but'

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

The person you're asking will have a worry — a 'but'. If you think of it first and have an answer ready, your case gets much stronger. It shows you've thought about their side, not just yours.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The 'but' for a later bedtime is 'but you'll be tired'. Your answer: 'I'll have a quiet wind-down and still wake up fine — we can try it one Friday and see.' You met their worry head-on.

3 APPLY IT

Guess the other person's biggest 'but'. Write it down, then write your calm answer to it.

4 REFLECT

Was it easy to guess their worry? Thinking about the other person's view is a real thinking skill (and it's kind).

5 GET FEEDBACK

Check your guessed 'but' with someone who knows the person. Did you guess their worry right?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone how guessing the 'but' makes a request stronger.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Guessing what a *specific real person* worries about needs your knowledge of them — you know your parent or teacher far better than any computer does.

You'll need: Answer-the-but card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The likely objection is anticipated and answered.

Unlocks after: Give two or three reasons

4 Make your case for real

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Now put it together and actually make your case: calm request, your reasons, your answer to the 'but'. Then — importantly — listen to the reply gracefully, even if it's not a full yes. A good case-maker is always respectful.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You make your case well and get 'let's try it for two Fridays and see'. That's a win! Even a 'not yet' often comes with a reason you can work with next time.

3 APPLY IT

Make your real case to the real person, calmly. Afterward, write down how it went and what they said.

4 REFLECT

How did making a calm, reasoned case feel compared to how you'd normally ask? What was the result?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Whatever the answer, ask the person: 'Did I make my case well?' Their feedback helps you next time.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of your case — your reasons, the 'but', and how it went.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a real, calm conversation between you and a real person — no script can do it for you. Listening well to their reply is as important as your reasons.

You'll need: Case outcome card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The case was made calmly to a real person.
☐ The child listened to the response and can describe how it went.

Unlocks after: Answer the 'but'

COMMUNICATE · Q4

Invite and Present

co-9-10-q4 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Communicate becomes hosting. At 9–10 a child can invite people by making a case (Q3), tell the story of what they made (Q1), and talk with visitors by listening (Q2) — and now they pull all three together on a real day, in front of a real audience. Presenting to guests is a stretch but a thrilling one, and the whole year has built toward being able to do it.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being a real host: getting people to come, and helping them understand and enjoy what you show. It's the year's communication skills made real — inviting, storytelling, and talking with guests all in one afternoon.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child hosts real guests at their Showcase Day, presenting what they made all year. A real audience — coming because they were invited well, then listening to the child's story — is deeply motivating. The child is briefly the star of their own event, which pulls out their best, bravest communicating.

THE ARTIFACT

Real invitations made for Showcase Day, plus a short 'welcome and tour' the child gives visitors on the day, telling the story of what they made this year.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child invited real guests with a genuine reason to come.
- They prepared and rehearsed a short spoken welcome/tour.
- On the day they presented to guests and answered questions by listening.

Unlocks after: Make Your Case, Plan the Showcase

1 Invite people well

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

An invitation is a little case: give people a real reason to come. Use your 'make your case' skill — tell them what they'll see and why it'll be fun, not just when and where.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Come to my Showcase Day! I'll show the inventions and digital story I made this year, and there's a stall with things I made — plus snacks!' That's an invite people actually want to say yes to.

3 APPLY IT

Make invitations for your guests. Include a real reason to come, plus the date and time from your plan.

4 REFLECT

Which part of your invite is most tempting? A good reason to come is what fills the room.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show an invite to a parent and ask if they'd want to come based on it.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling write an inviting invitation for something of theirs.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Invite your real people in your own warm words — a heartfelt invite from you beats a fancy one from a computer.

You'll need: Invitation template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Real invitations with a reason to come were made and given out.

2 Prepare your story

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Guests will want to know about what you made. Use your storytelling skill: prepare a short beginning-middle-end story of your year — what you tried, what was tricky, what you're proud of.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'At the start of the year I could barely finish a project (beginning). I learned to break things into steps and fix real problems (middle). Now I've made all this — my favourite is my invention (end).' A real story of your year.

3 APPLY IT

Write a short beginning-middle-end story of your year's making to tell your guests.

4 REFLECT

What are you proudest of from this year? That belongs in the 'end' of your story.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell your year-story to a parent and ask if it's clear and interesting.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Ask a family member to tell *their* beginning-middle-end of something they learned this year.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is your real year and your real pride — only you can tell it truthfully. Use your own memories, not a made-up story.

You'll need: Year-story card (beginning/middle/end)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A short three-part story of the year is prepared.

Unlocks after: Invite people well

3 Practise your welcome

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Rehearse a short 'welcome and tour' — greet guests, tell your year-story, and point out what you made. Practising a few times means you'll feel calm and proud on the day instead of frozen.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Good hosts rehearse. 'Welcome! Let me show you around — here are my inventions, and this is the digital story I made...' Said a few times in practice, it flows easily on the day.

3 APPLY IT

Practise your welcome and tour out loud two or three times, using your best voice and expression (from Q1).

4 REFLECT

Where do you stumble? Those spots need one more practice — that's what rehearsing is for.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Do your welcome for a family member as a dress rehearsal. Ask what would make it warmer or clearer.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone why hosts rehearse, using your before/after.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Rehearsing your real voice for a real welcome is all you — a screen can't practise being a warm host for you.

You'll need: Welcome/tour script card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The welcome/tour was rehearsed until it flowed.

Unlocks after: Prepare your story

4 Host on the day

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

On Showcase Day, welcome your guests, tell your story, show your work — and when they ask questions, use your listening skill to really hear them and answer. You're the host now: everything this year has led here.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A guest asks 'how did you make the phone stand?' You listen, then tell them the story of that invention. That back-and-forth — presenting and listening — is you being a real host.

3 APPLY IT

On Showcase Day, give your welcome, tell your year-story, and answer at least three guest questions by listening carefully.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to host? Which part were you proudest of? What surprised you?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Afterward, ask a guest what they enjoyed most about your welcome and tour.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone who missed it the story of hosting your Showcase Day.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Hosting real guests is a fully human moment — presenting, listening, answering, all live. This is the year's communication skills, all yours.

You'll need: Host-day question notes

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The child presented a welcome/tour to real guests.
☐ They answered guest questions by listening and responding.

Unlocks after: Practise your welcome

BUILD · Q1

Make Something Real

bu-9-10-q1 · supporting: Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children love making things with their hands and can follow a few simple steps, but they lose heart quickly if a project is too big or the first try looks messy. They don't need computers or code — they need the pure experience of turning an idea into a real object someone enjoys. Keep it finishable in one or two sittings so the pride of 'I made this' arrives before frustration does.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value at this age is 'I made this real thing, and someone likes it or uses it.' The magic is watching an idea in your head become an actual object in your hands. Usefulness or joy to one real person matters far more than how polished it looks.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child makes one real thing — a card, a paper toy, a simple gadget, a decoration — and gives it to someone who genuinely enjoys it. The deep satisfaction of finishing something real with your own hands, plus a real person's delight, is the driver. Finishing is the reward; keep it small enough to finish.

THE ARTIFACT

One simple made thing (a craft, a paper build, a decoration, or a very simple digital drawing) that a real person uses or enjoys.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child finished a real thing, not just started one.
- They planned it before making it (even a quick sketch).
- A real person used or enjoyed it, and the child improved one thing after seeing them.

1 Pick something small to make

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

The trick to finishing is starting small. Pick one simple thing to make for one real person. Big dreams are exciting but small things actually get finished — and a finished thing beats a giant unfinished one.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'A birthday card for Grandma' will get made. 'A giant castle model' probably won't. Small and finished wins.

3 APPLY IT

Choose one small thing to make and one person to make it for. Say it out loud: 'I'll make a ___ for ___.'

4 REFLECT

Is your thing small enough to finish today or tomorrow? If not, what's a smaller version?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell an adult your plan and ask: 'Is that small enough to finish?' Listen to their honest answer.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling pick one small thing to make instead of something too big.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You pick the thing and the person — a computer doesn't know who in your family would love a homemade gift. That's yours to decide.

You'll need: Make-it plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A small, finishable thing and a real recipient are chosen.

2 Plan it first

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Before you make, plan: draw what it'll look like and gather what you need. A quick plan means fewer 'oh no, I don't have glue' moments halfway through.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Builders draw a picture and lay out their tools before starting. Two minutes of planning saves a lot of stopping and starting.

3 APPLY IT

Draw a quick picture of your thing and list what you need to make it. Gather it all before you start.

4 REFLECT

Looking at your plan, is anything missing or too tricky? Better to spot it now than halfway through.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your plan to someone and ask if they see anything you forgot.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend why drawing a plan first makes making easier.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Draw your plan yourself — the plan is your idea taking shape, and doing it by hand helps you think it through.

You'll need: Plan-and-gather sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A simple plan drawing and a materials list exist, and materials are gathered.

Unlocks after: Pick something small to make

3 Make it and finish it

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Now make your thing, following your plan, all the way to finished. It won't be perfect — that's completely fine. Finished-and-a-bit-wonky beats perfect-and-unfinished every time.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The first thing anyone makes is a little rough. That's not failure, that's normal — every maker's first try looks like a first try.

3 APPLY IT

Make your thing from start to finish. If a bit goes wrong, keep going — you can fix it after.

4 REFLECT

What was trickier than you expected? That's the part you'll be better at next time.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your finished thing to an adult. Ask what they like about it before you point out the flaws.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone why 'finished but wonky' is better than 'perfect but never done'.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is hands-and-materials making — no screen. The wobbly bits are proof you made it yourself, and that's a good thing.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real finished thing exists, completed by the child.

Unlocks after: Plan it first

4 Give it and make it better

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Give your thing to the person it's for and watch. What they enjoy, and any little thing that could be better, tells you how to improve — the first real lesson of every maker.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You give Grandma the card and notice her name is spelled wrong. Next card, you check the spelling first. The person using it shows you the fix.

3 APPLY IT

Give your thing to the real person. Watch their reaction, then improve one small thing (or note it for next time).

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to give something you made? What one thing would you do better next time?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the person what they liked most and if there's anything they'd change. Take it kindly.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend give something they made and spot one improvement together.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A real person's smile is the feedback that matters here — that's a human moment no device can give you.

You'll need: Improve-one-thing card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The thing was given to its real person.
☐ The child named or made one improvement based on the real reaction.

Unlocks after: Make it and finish it

BUILD · Q2

Fix a Real Problem

bu-9-10-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can spot small annoyances and are thrilled by the idea of 'inventing' a fix, but they need the problem kept small and the materials kept simple (household bits, tape, cardboard). Having practised making a thing in Q1, they now aim it at a real problem — the first taste of building *to solve*, not just to make. Keep it finishable so the 'it actually works!' moment arrives.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is 'I made something that fixed a real annoying thing'. It's the leap from making for fun to making that's *useful* — an invention, however humble, that genuinely helps in daily life.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child becomes an inventor: they hunt down a real little annoyance at home and build a fix for it. The pull is the pride of solving a real problem with your own hands and hearing 'oh, that's clever, it actually helps!' Spotting a problem nobody bothered to fix, and fixing it, feels genuinely powerful at this age.

THE ARTIFACT

A simple hand-made solution to a real small problem at home (a cable tidy, a phone stand, a reminder chart, a door-stopper) that actually helps.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child identified a real, specific annoyance — not an invented one.
- They built a fix from simple materials and finished it.
- The fix was tried against the real problem and genuinely helped (or was improved until it did).

Unlocks after: Make Something Real

1 Hunt for an annoying problem

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Inventors don't start with an idea — they start with a problem. Look around your home for small annoying things: tangled cables, a door that won't stay open, a lost pencil. Annoyances are invention opportunities.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Someone got annoyed that their phone kept sliding off the table while playing music. That annoyance became the phone stand — a real invention born from a real irritation.

3 APPLY IT

Walk around your home and list three small annoying problems. Circle the one you'd most like to fix.

4 REFLECT

Is your circled problem small enough to fix with things you have at home? Keep it simple.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family which of your three annoyances bugs *them* too. A shared annoyance is a great one to fix.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling hunt for their own annoying-problem to fix.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The annoyances in *your* home are yours to spot — a computer can't walk around your house. This hunting is real-world detective work.

You'll need: Problem-hunt list (3 slots)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three real home annoyances are listed and one chosen.

2 Think of a simple fix

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Now dream up a fix. It doesn't need to be fancy — the best fixes are usually simple. Sketch a couple of ideas and pick the one you could actually build with what you have.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

For the sliding phone: idea one, a blob of sticky putty; idea two, a folded cardboard stand. The cardboard one is cheap, simple, and buildable — perfect.

3 APPLY IT

Sketch two different fixes for your problem. Pick the simplest one you can build from stuff at home.

4 REFLECT

Why did you pick that fix over the other? Simple-and-buildable usually beats clever-but-hard.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your two ideas to an adult and ask which they'd try first, and why.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend come up with two fixes for their problem and choose one.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You could ask AI for fix ideas, but try your *own* ideas first — inventing the fix is the fun, brain-stretching part, and you might surprise yourself.

You'll need: Two-idea sketch sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Two fix ideas sketched, one chosen for being simple and buildable.

Unlocks after: Hunt for an annoying problem

3 Build your fix

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Time to build. Gather your materials and make your fix, following your sketch. First inventions are often rough and that's fine — you just need it to work, not to be beautiful.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The first cardboard phone stand might be a bit wobbly. Doesn't matter — if the phone stays up, it works. Wobbly-but-working is a real invention.

3 APPLY IT

Build your fix from start to finish. If a bit doesn't work, adjust and keep going.

4 REFLECT

What was trickier to build than you expected? That's where you learned the most.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your built fix to someone before testing it. Ask what they think might work or not.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone how you built your fix, step by step.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is real building with real materials — hands, not screens. The making is yours, wobbles and all.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A finished fix exists, built by the child from their chosen idea.

Unlocks after: Think of a simple fix

4 Does it actually help?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

The real test: does your fix solve the real problem? Try it against the actual annoyance. If it helps — you're an inventor! If not quite, tweak it until it does. Real inventors improve until it works.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Put the phone on your stand and play music. Does it stay up now? If it tips, add a bit more support and try again. Testing against the real problem is how you know.

3 APPLY IT

Test your fix on the real problem. Does it help? If not fully, make one improvement and test again.

4 REFLECT

Did your fix work first time, or did it need a tweak? Most real inventions need at least one tweak.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your family if the annoying problem is better now. Their 'oh, that helps!' is your success.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone your working fix and how you tested it against the real problem.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

The real test is the real problem in your real home — no simulation needed. Trust what actually happens when you try it.

You'll need: Test-and-improve card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The fix was tested against the real problem.
☐ It helped, or was improved until it did.

Unlocks after: Build your fix

BUILD · Q3

Make Something on a Screen

bu-9-10-q3 · supporting: Create

WHAT’S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, after two quarters of hands-on making, a first *digital* creation is exciting and doable with kid-friendly tools — a slideshow story, a digital comic, a simple animation. Keep it small and purposeful, and hold the same rule as always: understand what you make and stay the boss of the tool. This is the gentle on-ramp to the 'Build' skills that grow through the later years, introduced without drowning them in screens.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value here is the thrill of a new kind of making — 'I made a real thing on a screen, and it's mine.' The same pride as a hand-made object, now in a digital shape someone can view and enjoy.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child makes their first real digital creation and shows it to someone who enjoys it. The novelty of making on a screen, combined with the familiar pride of finishing something real, is highly motivating — and doing it with the 'I understand every part' rule means they feel like a maker, not just a button-presser.

THE ARTIFACT

One simple digital creation (a short slideshow story, a digital drawing or comic, or a simple animation) made with a kid-friendly tool and viewed by a real person.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child planned the digital thing before making it.
- They can explain what every part of it is and how they made it — nothing is a mystery button.
- A real person viewed it and the child improved one thing based on the reaction.

Unlocks after: Fix a Real Problem

1 You can make on a screen too

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

You've made things with your hands — now you can make things on a screen: a story slideshow, a comic, a little animation. It's the same idea (make a real thing someone enjoys), just with a digital tool instead of glue and cardboard.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A slideshow that tells the story of your weekend, with your own drawings or photos on each slide, is a real digital creation — and you can share it with family far away.

3 APPLY IT

Pick one small digital thing to make and who it's for. Say it: 'I'll make a ___ for ___.'

4 REFLECT

Is your digital idea small enough to finish? Same rule as hand-making: small and finished beats big and abandoned.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell an adult your idea and ask them to help pick a simple, safe kid-friendly tool for it.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a sibling that making on a screen follows the same steps as making by hand.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A grown-up should help you choose a safe tool. And remember: the *idea* is yours — the tool just helps you make it. You're the maker, not the tool.

You'll need: Digital project brief card · List of kid-safe creation tools

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A small digital creation and its audience are chosen.

2 Plan it first (yes, still!)

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Making on a screen doesn't skip the planning. Sketch your slides or scenes on paper first — what's on each one, in what order. A paper plan makes the screen part quick and calm instead of confusing.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Before touching the computer, comic-makers draw tiny boxes on paper showing each scene. Then the digital part is just 'copy my plan onto the screen' — much easier.

3 APPLY IT

Sketch your digital thing on paper — each slide, scene, or part, in order.

4 REFLECT

Did planning on paper first make the idea clearer? It almost always does.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your paper plan to someone and check the order makes sense before you build.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend why planning on paper first makes screen-making easier.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Plan with your own hands on paper — this is your thinking. Doing it yourself keeps you the boss of the whole project.

You'll need: Storyboard/plan sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A paper plan of the digital creation exists, in order.

Unlocks after: You can make on a screen too

3 Make it — and understand every part

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Now build your digital thing from your plan. The golden rule: understand every part you add. If a tool (or AI) makes something for you, make sure you know what it is and could explain it — otherwise it's not really yours.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

If you use a tool to add a picture, you should be able to say 'I chose that picture and put it there because...' If you can't explain a part, you're not the maker of it yet.

3 APPLY IT

Make your digital creation from your plan. For each part, be ready to say what it is and why it's there.

4 REFLECT

Is there any part you can't explain? If so, learn it or change it — a maker understands their own work.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show a parent the thing as you build and have them point to any 'mystery part' you can't explain. Go understand it.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through your digital creation, explaining each part in your own words.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If AI helps you make a part (like a picture), you must still understand and choose it — **never keep a part you can't explain.** A maker who can't explain their work is just copying; you're better than that.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A finished digital creation exists.
☐ The child can explain every part in their own words.

Unlocks after: Plan it first (yes, still!)

4 Show it and make it better

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Show your creation to a real viewer and watch how they react. Where they smile, where they look confused — that tells you what to keep and what to fix. Then improve one thing. Same as hand-making: real viewers make your work better.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You show your slideshow story and your viewer looks lost on slide 3. That's your fix — maybe slide 3 needs to be clearer or split in two.

3 APPLY IT

Show your creation to a real person, stay quiet, and note where they react or get confused. Improve the most confusing part.

4 REFLECT

Was the confusing part one you were proud of? Making for a viewer is different from making for yourself.

5 GET FEEDBACK

After improving, show it again. Did the fix work?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the 'show it, watch quietly, fix what confused them' rule for digital things too.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A real human viewer's reaction is the best feedback — a screen can't be delighted or confused the way a person can. Trust the real reaction.

You'll need: Viewer-reaction card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real person viewed the creation.
☐ One improvement was made from real reaction and re-checked.

Unlocks after: Make it — and understand every part

BUILD · Q4

Make the Showcase Things

bu-9-10-q4 · supporting: Create, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Build supplies what the day shows and sells. At 9–10 a child can make a small batch of things and a sign, pulling together hand-making (Q1), problem-solving (Q2), and their first digital creation (Q3). Keep the batch small — a few good items plus one digital piece — so 'finished and good' beats 'lots and rushed', the lesson they've heard all year.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is having real things to show and sell — the maker's contribution to the day. It's every making skill from the year, aimed at one real event: a small collection the child is proud to put on a table in front of guests.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child produces the actual stuff of their Showcase Day — things people will look at, pick up, and buy. Knowing real guests will see and judge the work raises the bar in a good way, and the pride of a table full of things you made yourself is a powerful finish to the year of building.

THE ARTIFACT

A small set of things for Showcase Day: a few physical items to show or sell, plus at least one digital piece (a sign, poster, or slideshow made on a screen).

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child made a small batch of good-quality physical things (not many rushed ones).
- They made at least one digital piece and can explain every part of it.
- The display was set up and tested, with one thing fixed after testing.

Unlocks after: Make Something on a Screen, Plan the Showcase

1 What to make for the day

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Decide your small batch: a few items to show or sell, plus one digital piece like a sign. Remember the year's rule — a few good things beat a pile of rushed ones. Choose what you can make really well in the time you have.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your batch might be: six good bookmarks to sell, your phone-stand invention to show, and a digital price sign made on screen. Small, doable, and proud-making.

3 APPLY IT

List your small batch: the physical things and the one digital piece you'll make for the day.

4 REFLECT

Is your batch small enough to make *well* in the time before the day? Quality over quantity, as always.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your batch plan to a parent and check it fits the time in your step ladder.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a sibling why a small batch of good things beats lots of rushed ones.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You decide what to make from your year's skills — that's yours. Keep it to what you can genuinely do well.

You'll need: Batch plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A small, realistic batch (physical + one digital) is planned.

2 Make the physical things

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Make your batch of physical items using everything you've learned about hand-making — plan, gather, make well, finish. These are going in front of guests, so make each one something you'd be proud to sell.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Making six bookmarks: you plan the design, gather materials, and make each one carefully. They don't have to be identical — but each should be good enough that you'd happily hand it over.

3 APPLY IT

Make your batch of physical things, finishing each to a quality you're proud of.

4 REFLECT

Would you pay for these yourself? If not, which needs improving before the day?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your finished items to an honest family member and ask which is best and which needs work.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone your batch and explain how you kept the quality up.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Hand-making is yours — the care in each item is what makes guests want them. No shortcut replaces good making.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A small batch of good-quality physical items is finished.

Unlocks after: What to make for the day

3 Make the digital sign

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Make your digital piece — a sign, price list, or slideshow — using your screen-making skill. Keep the golden rule: understand every part. A neat digital sign makes your stall look real and welcoming.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A digital sign reading 'Aisha's Handmade Bookmarks — RM2 each' with a little drawing, made on screen and printed out, makes the whole stall look proper.

3 APPLY IT

Make your digital sign or slideshow from a quick plan. Be ready to explain every part of it.

4 REFLECT

Can you explain every part of your digital piece? If any bit is a mystery, learn it or change it.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your digital piece to a parent and have them check it's clear and readable from a distance.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through how you made your digital sign, part by part.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If AI helped with an image or layout, you must still understand and have chosen it — **never show a part you can't explain.** The sign is yours because you understand it.

You'll need: List of kid-safe creation tools

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A digital piece is finished and the child can explain every part.

Unlocks after: Make the physical things

4 Set it up and test

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Before the day, set up your display exactly as it'll be — items laid out, sign up. Then test it like a guest would see it, and fix the one thing that looks off. A tested setup means a calm, proud day.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You lay out your stall the night before and notice the sign is hard to read from where guests will stand. You move it higher — problem fixed before anyone arrives.

3 APPLY IT

Set up your full display and look at it as a guest would. Fix the one thing that most needs it.

4 REFLECT

What looked different once it was all set up? Seeing it as a guest often reveals a quick fix.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Have a family member look at your setup as a 'pretend guest' and say what catches their eye or confuses them.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone why testing the setup beforehand makes the real day go smoothly.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Seeing your real display in your real space is something only you can do — trust your own eyes and a family member's.

You'll need: Setup checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The full display was set up and tested from a guest's view.
☐ One improvement was made before the day.

Unlocks after: Make the digital sign

CREATE WEALTH · Q1

Make and Share

cw-9-10-q1 · supporting: Build, Communicate

WHAT’S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, money is barely abstract and profit means little — but the idea that you can make something real that another person genuinely *wants* is powerful and graspable. A 'mini-business' at this age is very simple: handmade cards, a helper coupon, a small treat. The reward isn't earnings; it's the discovery that making something good and offering it can lead to a real 'yes, please' or 'thank you'. Keep any money tiny and the loop short.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value here means a real person *chooses* to have the thing you made — a genuine 'yes' or a delighted 'thank you', not just a grown-up being kind. It's the very first taste of creating something others actually want, which is the seed of every business.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child makes something small and real, then offers it to a real person and finds out if they truly want it. Even without money, a real person choosing your thing feels different from pretend play — it's a small, safe, genuine stake. Landing that first honest 'yes' is a memorable milestone that makes them want to make the next thing.

THE ARTIFACT

One small thing made and offered to a real person, with the honest response recorded (a genuine yes/thank-you, or a no with its reason).

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child made something real to offer.
- They offered it to a real person outside their own household or immediate family.
- They can say, in the person's own words, why the answer was yes or no.

1 What would make someone happy?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

To make something people want, first notice what would make a real person happy. Watch and listen — what does someone near you enjoy, need, or wish for?

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A girl noticed her neighbour loved her garden but had no plant labels. Little painted labels were a perfect gift — because she spotted what would make *that* person happy.

3 APPLY IT

Think of one real person and write down two things that might make them happy that you could make or do. Pick one.

4 REFLECT

Did you pick something *they'd* like, or something *you'd* like to make? The best pick is a bit of both.

5 GET FEEDBACK

If you can, gently ask that person (or someone who knows them) what they enjoy. Adjust your idea.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling think of something that would make a specific family member happy.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A computer can't see who's around you or what they'd love. This noticing is yours — it's the real skill.

You'll need: Who-would-love-this card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One idea is chosen based on what a real, specific person would want.

2 Make one good one

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Make *one* really good version, not lots of rushed ones. A good thing earns a real 'yes'. A sloppy thing, however many you make, earns polite nos.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

One beautifully painted plant label makes the neighbour say 'oh, I'd love some!' Ten smudged ones don't. Quality does the asking for you.

3 APPLY IT

Make one really good version of your thing. Take your time and make it something you'd be proud to give.

4 REFLECT

Would you be happy to receive this yourself? If not, what would make it better?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your one good version to someone honest and improve it once based on what they say.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a friend why one good one beats ten rushed ones.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The making is yours to do well. If it's something on a screen, you should still understand and control how it's made — don't hand the whole job to a computer.

You'll need: Proud-to-give checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One good version exists, improved once after honest feedback.

Unlocks after: What would make someone happy?

3 Offer it for real

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

The big moment: actually offer your thing to a real person and ask if they'd like it. Whether it's a gift or a small trade, a real person really choosing is what makes it count.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The girl knocked on the neighbour's door: 'I made these plant labels — would you like some?' The neighbour's happy 'yes please!' was the whole reward.

3 APPLY IT

Offer your thing to a real person (beyond your own home). Ask kindly if they'd like it. Notice their honest reaction.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to offer something you made? A little nervous? That nervous-brave feeling is part of it.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Notice exactly what they said and did. Write it down — those real words are gold.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell a family member about your offer and how you asked, so they could try it too.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

No device can make the offer for you — the little bit of bravery in asking a real person is exactly what you're practising.

You'll need: Offer record card (who / their reaction)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The thing was genuinely offered to a real person and their reaction noted.

Unlocks after: Make one good one

4 What happened?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Look at what happened. A 'yes' or 'thank you' means you made something wanted — brilliant. A 'no' isn't bad; it usually comes with a reason that helps you make something even better next time.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

If someone says 'no thanks, I don't have plants', that's not a fail — it tells you to offer plant labels to gardeners next time. The no taught you who to ask.

3 APPLY IT

Write down what happened and why. If it was a yes, what made them happy? If a no, what was their reason?

4 REFLECT

What's the one thing you learned that would make your next 'make and share' go better?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Talk it over with a parent: what would you make, or who would you offer to, next time?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of your make-and-share and the one thing it taught you.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Afterward, if you're puzzling over a 'no', you could talk it through with an adult or even AI — but the real lesson came from the real person, and that's what counts most.

You'll need: What-I-learned card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The outcome and its reason are recorded in the person's own words.
☐ The child named one thing to do differently next time.

Unlocks after: Offer it for real

CREATE WEALTH · Q2

Save, Spend, Share

cw-9-10-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, money is becoming a bit more real, and children can genuinely grasp the three-jar idea — some to save, some to spend, some to share — if it's concrete and the amounts are tiny. Waiting (delayed gratification) is hard at this age, so a saving goal must be short-term and visible. Having made and offered something in Q1, they now meet the natural next question: what do you do with what you get?

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is feeling genuinely in charge of your own small money — making a plan on purpose instead of spending it all the moment you get it. The reward is the grown-up feeling of having decided, and watching a small saving goal actually get closer.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child is trusted to manage a small, real amount of their own money and make real choices about it. Being in charge — genuinely deciding save vs spend vs share, and watching a goal jar fill — is deeply motivating at this age. The trust itself is the driver; nobody has to force a plan when the money and the choice are really theirs.

THE ARTIFACT

A three-jar (save / spend / share) plan for a small real amount of money, with a chosen saving goal and at least one real money choice recorded.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child split a small real amount into save, spend, and share.
- They chose a real short-term saving goal and can name it.
- They can explain one money choice they made and why.

Unlocks after: Make and Share

1 Money can do three jobs

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Money isn't just for spending right now. It can do three jobs: **save** (keep for something bigger later), **spend** (enjoy now), and **share** (give to help someone). Smart money people use all three.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Get RM6? You might put RM2 to save, RM2 to spend, RM2 to share. Three little jars, three jobs — and you decide how much goes where.

3 APPLY IT

Set up three jars (or cups) labelled Save, Spend, Share. They're ready for your money.

4 REFLECT

Which jar do you think will be hardest to put money in? For most people it's Save — because waiting is hard.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three jars to a parent and talk about what each one is for.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain the three jobs of money to a younger child using the jars.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

This is about your real money and real jars you can touch — much more powerful than anything on a screen. Set them up for real.

You'll need: Three jar labels (Save / Spend / Share)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three labelled jars are set up.

2 Pick a save goal

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Saving is much easier when you're saving *for* something. Pick one thing you really want that costs a bit more than you have now. That's your goal — the reason the Save jar is worth it.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Wanting a RM15 toy when you get RM3 a week means saving over a few weeks. But now every coin in the Save jar is exciting, because it's getting you closer.

3 APPLY IT

Choose one real thing you want to save for. Write it on your Save jar and how much it costs.

4 REFLECT

Is your goal something you'll still want in a few weeks? Good saving goals are things you really care about.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent your save goal and check it's a realistic thing to save for.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a sibling pick a save goal worth waiting for.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Your goal is about what *you* really want — that's yours alone to choose. No computer knows what would make you happy.

You’ll need: Save-goal label

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real, specific saving goal is chosen and its cost noted.

Unlocks after: Money can do three jobs

3 Choose on purpose

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

When you get some money, decide *on purpose* how to split it across your three jars — instead of spending it all at once. This is you being the boss of your money, not the other way round.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You get RM6. You *could* spend it all on sweets. Or you choose: RM3 to save for the toy, RM2 to spend now, RM1 to share. That's a plan you made, not an accident.

3 APPLY IT

Take a small real amount of money and split it across your three jars on purpose. Write down how you split it.

4 REFLECT

Was it tempting to put it all in Spend? How did it feel to save some on purpose?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show a parent your split and explain why you chose it. Ask what they think.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone how you split your money on purpose across the three jars.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This choice is yours to make — being the boss of your own money is the whole point, and that can't be handed to a computer.

You'll need: Money-split record card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real amount was split across the three jars with the split recorded.

Unlocks after: Pick a save goal

4 Watch it grow

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Keep adding to your Save jar and watch it get closer to your goal. Seeing it grow — and finally reaching the goal — teaches the best money lesson of all: waiting a little can get you something better.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Week by week the Save jar fills. The day it finally holds enough for the toy feels amazing — better than spending it on small stuff would have. That feeling is the reward for patience.

3 APPLY IT

Track your Save jar over the next few weeks. Mark how close you are to your goal each week.

4 REFLECT

How does it feel to watch your savings grow toward something you want? Was the waiting worth it?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show a parent your progress tracker. Celebrate together when you hit the goal.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of saving up and reaching your goal — and how waiting paid off.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Watching real coins fill a real jar toward a real goal is the lesson here — no app needed. The patience is yours to build.

You'll need: Save-goal progress tracker

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The child tracked their savings toward the goal over time.
☐ They can explain what saving on purpose taught them.

Unlocks after: Choose on purpose

CREATE WEALTH · Q3

A Little Business

cw-9-10-q3 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 9–10, children can make a simple offer to a few real people and keep a simple tally, though real profit and complex pricing are still beyond them. The leap this quarter is doing it *more than once* and *keeping track* — discovering that repeating and counting teaches you what works. Keep money tiny and the whole thing playful. This sets up the year-end capstone where several skills come together.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is making something a few real people genuinely want, and using a simple tally to see what worked. It's the first real 'little business' — not about getting rich, but about the loop of offer, count, learn, improve.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child runs a tiny real business — a few offers to a few real people — and keeps score. Real people choosing (or not), and a tally that visibly adds up, makes it feel like a genuine venture rather than pretend. Watching the count grow and spotting what people liked is motivating in the same way keeping score in a game is.

THE ARTIFACT

A small repeated offer made to at least three real people, with a simple tally of yeses/nos and what was made or earned, plus one noticed pattern about what people liked.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child offered the same thing to at least three real people.
- They kept a simple written tally of the results.
- They can name one thing people liked or one thing they'd change, based on the tally.

Unlocks after: Save, Spend, Share

1 Do it more than once

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

In Q1 you made one offer. A little business means doing it a few times with a few people. Repeating is where you start to learn — one yes could be luck, but three tries shows you a real pattern.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Selling bookmarks to one aunt tells you little. Offering them to three neighbours tells you if people actually want bookmarks — or if you should make something else.

3 APPLY IT

Pick something simple to offer (make it, or a small service) and list three real people you could offer it to.

4 REFLECT

Why is trying three people better than trying one? What might three answers show you that one can't?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Run your idea past a parent and check your three people are ones you can safely reach.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a sibling why doing a thing three times teaches more than doing it once.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The real people you'll offer to are from your own life — a computer can't pick them. That's yours to plan.

You'll need: Little-business plan card (offer + 3 people)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ An offer and three real people to approach are chosen.

2 Keep a simple tally

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

A little business keeps score. Make a simple tally: who you asked, yes or no, and what you made or earned. The tally turns your business from guessing into knowing.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A tally might read: Aunt — yes — RM2; Neighbour — no; Friend — yes — RM2. Now you can *see* it worked twice out of three, and earned RM4. Real numbers, not vibes.

3 APPLY IT

Make a tally sheet with columns: who, yes/no, what I made. Get it ready before you start offering.

4 REFLECT

Why write it down instead of just remembering? What might you forget without a tally?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your blank tally to an adult and check it's clear and easy to fill in.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend how a simple tally helps a little business keep score.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Keep your tally by hand — writing down your own real results helps you understand them. This is your score to keep.

You'll need: Tally sheet (who / yes-no / earned)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A clear tally sheet is ready to use.

Unlocks after: Do it more than once

3 Run it and notice what people liked

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Now make your offers and fill in your tally. As you go, notice *why* people said yes or no — 'she liked the colour', 'he didn't need one'. Those little reasons are the most valuable part of the tally.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You notice both yeses loved the sparkly bookmarks but nobody wanted the plain ones. That's gold — it tells you exactly what to make more of.

3 APPLY IT

Make your three offers, fill in your tally, and jot the reason next to each yes or no.

4 REFLECT

Do you see a pattern in the reasons? Patterns are the business telling you what to do next.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Share your filled tally with a parent and talk about what the reasons show.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone one pattern you spotted in why people said yes or no.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The reasons come from real people you spoke to — no computer could tell you why *your* neighbour said yes. That listening is the valuable skill.

You'll need: Filled tally with reasons

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ At least three real offers were made and tallied with reasons.
☐ The child spotted at least one pattern.

Unlocks after: Keep a simple tally

4 Do one thing better

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

The point of a tally is to improve. Look at your pattern and pick one thing to do better next time — make more of what people liked, change what they didn't. That's how a little business grows.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your tally says sparkly sells, plain doesn't. Next time: make mostly sparkly ones. One clear improvement, straight from your own numbers.

3 APPLY IT

Based on your tally, write down the one thing you'll do better next time and why.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to change your plan based on real results instead of guessing? That's what real businesses do.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell a parent or mentor your improvement idea and why your tally points to it.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the loop: offer, tally, spot the pattern, do one thing better.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your improvement comes from your own real results — that's the honest way to get better. Trust your tally over any guess.

You'll need: Do-better card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One specific improvement is chosen, justified by the tally.
☐ The child can explain the offer-tally-improve loop.

Unlocks after: Run it and notice what people liked

CREATE WEALTH · Q4

Run Your Stall

cw-9-10-q4 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT’S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Wealth is the live stall on Showcase Day. At 9–10 a child can set simple prices, offer to real visitors (Q1), keep a tally (Q3), and then save/spend/share what they earn (Q2) — the whole year's money and value skills in one real event. This is also the final project of the year, so it closes with a reflection on how far they've come.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value here is running a real little stall, earning a little real money, and deciding what to do with it. It's every wealth skill from the year — make, offer, price, tally, manage — brought to life in front of real customers, for real.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child runs a genuine stall with real customers and real (small) money on a real day. The stakes are exciting and safe: actual guests deciding to buy, an actual tally climbing, actual earnings to manage afterward. Nothing motivates the year's wealth lessons like a real till at the end of a real event.

THE ARTIFACT

A stall run on Showcase Day with a tally of sales, followed by a save/spend/share plan for the earnings — plus a short reflection on the whole year.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child set simple prices and ran a stall for real guests.
- They kept a tally of what sold and what they earned.
- They made a save/spend/share plan for the earnings and can reflect on their year.

Unlocks after: A Little Business, Plan the Showcase

1 Set your prices and offers

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Decide what you'll sell and for how much, using your little-business skills. Keep prices simple and fair — a price is you saying what your thing is worth. Have your digital sign show the prices clearly.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Bookmarks RM2, or 3 for RM5.' Simple, clear, and the '3 for RM5' gives people a reason to buy more. Fair prices that a guest can understand in a second.

3 APPLY IT

Set a simple price for each thing you're selling. Write them on your sign.

4 REFLECT

Are your prices fair — not too cheap, not too dear? Think back to what you learned about pricing this year.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your prices to a parent and check they feel fair for what you made.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why a clear, fair price helps a stall sell.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your prices depend on your effort and your real guests — you decide them. A computer's guess matters less than what feels fair to you.

You'll need: Price-setting card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Simple, fair prices are set and shown on the sign.

2 Run the stall

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

On the day, run your stall: greet guests warmly, tell them about your things, and make your offers. Use your listening skill — a friendly stall-holder who listens sells more than a pushy one.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Hi! These are bookmarks I made — this sparkly one's my favourite. Would you like one?' Friendly, honest, and you listen to what they say. That's how a real stall feels.

3 APPLY IT

Run your stall on Showcase Day. Greet each guest, offer your things kindly, and make some real sales.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to sell to real guests? Easier or harder than you expected?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Notice which of your offers guests responded to best. That's real-time learning.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of a sale you made and how you made it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Running a real stall with real guests is fully human — warmth, listening, offering. No screen does this for you; it's your moment.

You'll need: Money box / float

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The stall was run for real guests with real offers made.

Unlocks after: Set your prices and offers

3 Keep the tally

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

As you sell, keep your tally — what sold, and what you earned. At the end, add it up. Your tally tells the true story of the day: what people wanted and how you did.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

End-of-day tally: 5 bookmarks sold, RM11 earned, and the sparkly ones went first. Real numbers that show you exactly what worked.

3 APPLY IT

Keep your tally through the stall, then add up your total earnings at the end.

4 REFLECT

What does your tally show about what guests liked most? Same lesson as your little business — the tally teaches.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your final tally to a parent and talk about what sold best and why.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone your tally and what it tells you about the day.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Keeping and adding your own tally helps you understand your own day — do the counting yourself.

You'll need: Sales tally sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A tally of sales and total earnings was kept and totted up.

Unlocks after: Run the stall

4 Save, spend, share — and look back

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Now use your three-jar skill on real earnings: decide how much to save, spend, and share, on purpose. Then look back on your whole year — everything you learned to get to this day. That's a lot to be proud of.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You earned RM11: maybe RM5 to save, RM4 to spend, RM2 to share. And you look back — a year ago you couldn't finish a project; today you planned and ran a whole showcase. That's real growth.

3 APPLY IT

Split your earnings into save/spend/share on purpose. Then write or tell one thing you're proudest of learning this year.

4 REFLECT

Looking across the whole year — noticing, making, telling stories, running a stall — what changed most about what you can do?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Sit with a parent and share your save/spend/share plan and your proudest moment of the year.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell a family member the story of your whole year of learning, ending with Showcase Day.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

How you split real earnings and what you're proud of are deeply yours. This is your year — own it, in your own words.

You'll need: Earnings save/spend/share card · Year-reflection card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Earnings were split across save/spend/share on purpose.
☐ The child reflected on their growth across the whole year.

Unlocks after: Keep the tally

Ages 11-12

THINK · Q1

The Question Detective

th-11-12-q1 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, thinking is mostly concrete but early abstract reasoning is appearing: a child can separate 'what I know' from 'what I'm guessing' if you give them the handle to do it. Fairness and rules feel enormous at this age, and they love catching an adult being wrong — that instinct is exactly the engine of good reasoning. Attention runs in shorter bursts than a teenager's, so loops must be quick and produce a visible result the same day.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age 'value' isn't money — it's being *trusted to figure something out*. Cracking a real question by yourself, and being able to show how you did it, is the reward. The audience is usually people they know (family, a friend, a teacher), and the win is 'you were right, and you can prove it'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child picks a real question they personally want answered — is the '5-second rule' real, does our dog actually understand words, is the shortcut to school really faster — and gets to be the detective who settles it. The pull is the satisfaction of cracking it themselves plus the small thrill of proving something the grown-ups only assumed. No one has to make it fun; a genuine unanswered question they chose does that.

THE ARTIFACT

An 'investigation board' (paper or a simple slide) that states one real question, separates what was known / assumed / checked, shows the evidence gathered, and gives a verdict with the reasoning visible.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child can point to the difference between a fact, a guess, and an opinion on their board.
- They gathered at least one piece of real evidence themselves rather than just looking up an answer.
- They can explain, out loud, why their verdict follows from their evidence.

1 Fact, guess, or opinion?

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Three different things get said in the same confident voice: a **fact** (checkably true), a **guess** (might be true, not checked yet), and an **opinion** (how someone feels). Smart thinking starts with telling them apart.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'It rained here yesterday' is a fact you can check. 'It'll rain tomorrow' is a guess. 'Rainy days are the best' is an opinion. Same tone of voice — very different things.

3 APPLY IT

Grab five statements from a cereal box, an advert, or a family conversation. Label each one fact, guess, or opinion. The tricky ones are the point.

4 REFLECT

Which was hardest to label? Sneaky statements often dress an opinion up as a fact — did you catch any?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your five labels to a parent or friend. Where you two disagree, talk out why — the disagreement usually reveals the sneaky one.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach a younger child the three types using their own toys or snacks as examples. If they can label three new statements right, you nailed the teaching.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a *no-AI* lesson on purpose. The skill is your own ear catching the difference — outsourcing that to a chatbot defeats it. Later, once you can label reliably, AI can be a sparring partner to check yourself.

You'll need: Fact/Guess/Opinion sorting sheet (5 rows)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Five statements are labelled with at least one 'sneaky' one identified.

2 A question you can actually answer

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Big questions like 'are dogs smart?' can't be settled. Good detectives shrink a big question into a small, checkable one — 'does my dog come to the word *walk* even when I say it flat, with no excited voice?'

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Is the school shortcut faster?' is too vague. 'Is the alley route faster than the main road when I walk normally?' can be timed and settled this week.

3 APPLY IT

Take your big curious question and rewrite it as one small question you could actually check in a few days. Write both versions so you can see the shrink.

4 REFLECT

Did shrinking the question change what you'd need to look at? Smaller questions usually point straight at the evidence you need.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask an adult: 'If I checked this, would it really answer my big question?' Adjust if they poke a hole.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend shrink one of *their* big questions into a checkable one.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Fine to ask AI 'help me make this question more specific' — it's good at that. But you decide if the smaller question still matches what you actually wanted to know; the model can't feel your curiosity for you.

You'll need: Big-question / small-question worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One checkable small question is written that clearly connects to the bigger curiosity.

Unlocks after: Fact, guess, or opinion?

3 Go get the evidence

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Evidence is proof you gather *yourself*: a measurement, a count, a test, a careful look. Looking up someone else's answer isn't evidence — it's borrowing a verdict.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

To test the alley shortcut, you don't Google it — you walk both routes with a timer, three times each, and write down the numbers. Now you *have* proof.

3 APPLY IT

Run your check at least three times and write down what happened each time. Three tries, because one could be a fluke.

4 REFLECT

Did every try give the same result? If not, what might explain the difference — and does it change your answer?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your raw results to someone and ask: 'Would you believe this? Is three tries enough?' Note their answer.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why doing the test three times beats doing it once.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Do NOT ask AI for the answer to your question — that skips the whole job. AI can help you *design* a fair test ('how do I make this timing fair?'), but the evidence has to come from you doing it.

You'll need: Evidence log (3+ rows for repeated tries)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ At least three real observations were gathered and recorded by the child.

Unlocks after: A question you can actually answer

4 Show your verdict — and your working

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

A detective doesn't just announce 'guilty'. They walk you through the clues so you can see it too. Your verdict is only as strong as the reasoning you can show.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'The alley is faster — here are my six times, the alley averaged 4 minutes, the main road 6. That's my proof.' Anyone can now check your thinking, not just trust your word.

3 APPLY IT

Finish your investigation board: the question, what you knew vs assumed, your evidence, and the verdict with the reasoning laid out.

4 REFLECT

If someone disagreed with your verdict, which part of your board would they attack? Is that part solid?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Present the board to two people. Ask each to try to poke a hole. Fix the weakest spot they find.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk a family member through your whole investigation as if teaching them to be a detective — question, evidence, verdict.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you tidy how the board *reads*, but the reasoning must be yours and you must be able to defend every step without it. If you can't explain a line on your board yourself, take it off.

You'll need: Investigation board template (question / known / assumed / evidence / verdict)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A completed board shows the reasoning, not just the answer.
☐ The child defended their verdict against at least one challenge.

Unlocks after: Go get the evidence

THINK · Q2

Don't Get Fooled

th-11-12-q2 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children are increasingly online and surrounded by ads, headlines, and confident claims — but they tend to believe things that look official or that they *want* to be true. They're now ready for the crucial next step beyond Q1's 'investigate your own question': evaluating claims that other people are pushing at them, and asking 'who's telling me this, and why?'. This is real, immediately useful, and slightly thrilling — nobody likes being fooled.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is not being anyone's fool — seeing through a misleading ad, a clickbait headline, or a too-good-to-be-true claim, and knowing how to check before believing. It's the beginning of thinking for yourself instead of swallowing whatever you're told.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child learns to think for themselves rather than be told what to believe — and at this age, being 'nobody's fool', the one who spots the trick, feels genuinely powerful and a little cool. Catching a real ad or headline trying to manipulate them turns critical thinking into a satisfying game of not-getting-caught.

THE ARTIFACT

A 'fool-proofing' breakdown of three real claims, ads, or headlines the child found, each showing the trick being used and how they checked whether it was true.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- For each claim, the child identified who was saying it and what they wanted.
- They named the specific trick or missing information in each.
- They checked at least one claim against another source before deciding.

Unlocks after: The Question Detective

1 Who's telling you, and why?

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Before believing a claim, ask two questions: who is saying it, and what do they want? An ad wants your money. A headline wants your click. Knowing the motive behind a message tells you how carefully to check it.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Dentists recommend this toothpaste!' — but the ad was paid for by the toothpaste company. Who's telling you (the seller) and why (to sell) changes how much you should trust it.

3 APPLY IT

Find three real claims (ads, headlines, posts). For each, write who's saying it and what you think they want.

4 REFLECT

Did knowing the 'why' change how much you believed any of them? Motive is a big clue.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three to a parent and compare your guesses about who benefits.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend how to ask 'who's telling me and why?' about an ad they've seen.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can also have a 'why' — it's trained to sound confident even when unsure. Ask 'who/why' about AI answers too, and never treat a confident tone as proof.

You'll need: Who/why breakdown sheet (3 claims)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three real claims are analysed for source and motive.

2 Spot the common tricks

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Misleading messages use a few tricks over and over: exaggeration ('the BEST ever!'), fake urgency ('only 2 left!'), missing information (leaving out the bad bits), and cherry-picking (showing only the numbers that help them). Once you know the tricks, you see them everywhere.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'9 out of 10 people loved it!' sounds great — until you ask how many people they asked. If it was 10 friends of the seller, the number means nothing. That's cherry-picking plus missing information.

3 APPLY IT

Look at your three claims again and name the trick each one uses (or admit if one seems honest).

4 REFLECT

Which trick fools you most easily? Knowing your own weak spot helps you guard it.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a parent if they can spot a trick you missed in your three claims.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the four common tricks with an example of each.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you name the tricks in an ad — a fair use. But spotting them yourself first builds the instinct that protects you when no AI is around.

You’ll need: Trick-spotting reference card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Each claim's trick (or honesty) is identified.

Unlocks after: Who's telling you, and why?

3 Check before you believe

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

The real defence is checking. Cross-check a claim against a different, independent source — one that doesn't benefit from it. If you can't find the claim anywhere trustworthy, that's a red flag.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A post says a certain food is 'poison'. You check a couple of reliable health sources — none agree. The claim doesn't survive the check, so you don't spread it.

3 APPLY IT

Pick your most doubtful claim and check it against at least one independent source. Write what you found.

4 REFLECT

Was the claim true, false, or somewhere in between? How hard was it to find a trustworthy check?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your checking to an adult and ask if your source was a good, independent one.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone how to cross-check a surprising claim before believing it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can point you toward sources, but it sometimes makes things up ('hallucinates'). Always confirm with a real, findable source — don't let a confident AI answer be your only check.

You'll need: Cross-check worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ At least one claim was cross-checked against an independent source.

Unlocks after: Spot the common tricks

4 Share what you found

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Put it together: present your three claims, the tricks they used, and what your checking revealed. Teaching others to spot tricks is how you protect your friends and family too — being fool-proof is more useful when it spreads.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You show your family: 'This ad exaggerates, this headline uses fake urgency, and this so-called fact turned out to be false when I checked.' Now they're a bit harder to fool too.

3 APPLY IT

Finish your fool-proofing breakdown of all three claims and present it to your family.

4 REFLECT

Which of your three was the sneakiest? What will you check more carefully from now on?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your audience which breakdown surprised them most. Note it.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk a family member through all three claims and how you saw through them.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The judgement of what's misleading is yours, built from your own checking — that's the skill worth having. Share it in your own words.

You'll need: Fool-proofing summary template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A three-claim breakdown was completed and presented.
☐ The child can explain the trick and the check for each.

Unlocks after: Check before you believe

THINK · Q3

Do Real Research

th-11-12-q3 · supporting: Create Wealth, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can run a simple structured investigation of what real people think — a small survey or a set of interviews — count the responses, and spot patterns. This is a real step beyond Q2's 'check other people's claims': now they *generate* new knowledge by gathering their own data. Keep the sample small and real. It also lays the groundwork for the year-end launch, where knowing your customer beats guessing.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is finding out what people actually think or want by asking properly, instead of assuming — real evidence you gathered yourself. It's the grown-up power of replacing 'I reckon' with 'I asked twelve people and here's what they said'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child becomes someone who can *find things out* — running a real mini-study and discovering something they (and often the adults) didn't know. The satisfaction of a surprising, data-backed finding, and being able to say 'I have evidence', is powerfully motivating and makes them feel genuinely capable.

THE ARTIFACT

A mini research finding: a clear question, data gathered from at least five real people, patterns counted, and a conclusion drawn — even if it surprises them.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child wrote one clear research question they could actually answer by asking people.
- They asked the same questions to at least five real people and recorded answers.
- They counted the patterns and drew a conclusion supported by the data.

Unlocks after: Don't Get Fooled

1 Ask one clear research question

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Research starts with one clear question you can answer by asking people — 'what snack do kids in my class most wish the canteen sold?' Vague questions ('what do people like?') give mush. A sharp question gives usable answers.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Would people my age pay for a homework-reminder app?' is answerable. 'Is technology good?' is not — too big, too fuzzy to gather real data on.

3 APPLY IT

Write one clear research question you genuinely want answered and could ask real people.

4 REFLECT

Could five people actually answer your question in a sentence? If not, sharpen it.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Run your question past a parent — is it clear and answerable, or too broad?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend sharpen a fuzzy research question into an answerable one.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you narrow a question, but the thing you're curious about is yours. And AI can't tell you what your real classmates think — only asking them can.

You'll need: Research-question card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One clear, answerable research question is written.

2 Ask real people

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Ask the *same* questions to several people — that's what makes it research rather than a chat. Same questions, several people, answers written down. Consistency is what lets you compare and count later.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You ask five classmates the exact same three questions about canteen snacks. Because the questions were identical, you can line up the answers and see what most people said.

3 APPLY IT

Ask your question (plus one or two follow-ups) to at least five real people. Write down every answer.

4 REFLECT

Did asking everyone the same way feel a bit formal? That sameness is exactly what makes the results trustworthy.

5 GET FEEDBACK

After two people, check with a parent that your questions are getting useful answers before doing the rest.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why asking everyone the *same* questions matters in research.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you word neutral questions (ones that don't push people toward an answer). But the answers must come from real people — invented data is worthless and dishonest.

You'll need: Response record sheet (5+ people)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The same questions were asked to at least five real people and answers recorded.

Unlocks after: Ask one clear research question

3 Count the patterns

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Now turn answers into numbers. Tally how many people said each thing. Patterns you can count ('4 out of 5 wanted spicy snacks') are far stronger than a vague feeling ('people seemed to like spicy stuff').

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your tally: 4 of 5 want spicy snacks, 3 of 5 would pay RM2, nobody wanted sweets. Suddenly you can *see* what people want, in numbers.

3 APPLY IT

Tally your answers into counts. Note the clearest pattern in the numbers.

4 REFLECT

Did the numbers match what you expected before you started? Data often corrects our hunches.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your tally to a parent and check your counting is fair and accurate.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone how counting answers turns opinions into evidence.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Count your own data by hand — it's a small amount and doing it yourself keeps you honest about what it really says.

You'll need: Tally/pattern sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Answers are tallied and the main pattern is identified.

Unlocks after: Ask real people

4 Draw a conclusion

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Finish by stating what your data shows — your conclusion — in one clear sentence, backed by the numbers. Good researchers follow the data even when it disagrees with what they hoped.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Most kids my age want spicy snacks and would pay RM2 — so a spicy snack stall could work.' That conclusion is earned by real evidence, not a guess.

3 APPLY IT

Write your conclusion in one sentence, backed by your numbers. Note if it surprised you.

4 REFLECT

Did your evidence support your first hunch, or change your mind? Changing your mind because of data is a strength.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Present your question, data, and conclusion to your family and ask if the conclusion follows from the numbers.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through your whole mini-study, from question to evidence-backed conclusion.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The conclusion must come from *your* data, honestly read — not from what you wish were true, and not from an AI guess. Let the evidence lead.

You'll need: Conclusion card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A one-sentence conclusion supported by the data is written.
☐ The child can explain how the numbers back the conclusion.

Unlocks after: Count the patterns

THINK · Q4

Plan the Launch

th-11-12-q4 · supporting: Create Wealth, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

This is the year's capstone, and Think leads it: a real mini-launch to genuine customers. At 11–12 a child can plan it using evidence from their own research (Q3), make reasoned decisions (Q2), and break a real project into ordered steps. Grounding a launch in what they actually found out about customers — rather than hope — is a major, real-world milestone. Keep the scope small, safe, and adult-supported throughout.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is being the strategist of a real launch — using evidence, not wishful thinking, to decide what to sell, to whom, where, and how. It's every thinking skill from two years pointed at one genuine question: how do we make this actually work?

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The child owns the plan for a real launch that real customers will attend or buy from. Being genuinely in charge of a strategy — one grounded in their own research and judged by real results — is deeply motivating at this age. The launch is real, the responsibility is theirs, and that pulls out serious, evidence-based thinking.

THE ARTIFACT

A launch plan grounded in research: what to launch, the target customer (from real data), where and when, an ordered step plan, and a clear measurable goal (e.g., 10 real customers or RM50 profit).

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The choice of what to launch is justified by research, not just a hunch.
- There is a specific target customer and a measurable goal.
- The plan has ordered steps and a set launch date agreed with an adult.

Unlocks after: Do Real Research

1 Decide what to launch

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Use your research to choose what to launch. The whole point of Q3 was evidence about what people want — now you spend it. Pick the thing your data says real customers will actually pay for, not just the thing you feel like making.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your research found most classmates want spicy snacks and would pay RM2. So you launch a spicy-snack stall — a choice backed by evidence, far safer than guessing they'd want something.

3 APPLY IT

Using your research findings, decide what you will launch. Write one sentence linking your choice to the evidence.

4 REFLECT

Is your choice driven by your data or by what you personally fancy making? Let the evidence win.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Explain your choice and its evidence to a parent — does the launch idea follow from your research?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone how you used real research to pick what to launch.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This decision rests on your real data about your real community — yours to make. AI can't know what your customers said; only your research can.

You'll need: Launch-choice card (idea + evidence)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A launch idea is chosen and justified by research.

2 Who's it for, and what's the goal?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Name your target customer (from your research) and set one measurable goal for the launch — a number you can check afterward. A goal turns a vague hope into something you can actually hit or miss and learn from.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Target: kids in my year who buy snacks at break. Goal: sell to 10 real customers and make RM20 profit on launch day. Now success is a clear number, not a feeling.

3 APPLY IT

Write your target customer and one measurable goal for the launch (customers, sales, or profit).

4 REFLECT

Is your goal ambitious but reachable? Too easy teaches nothing; impossible just disheartens.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Check your goal with a parent or mentor — is it realistic for a first launch?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why a measurable goal beats 'I hope it goes well'.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your target customer comes from your research; your goal is your judgement about what's reachable. Both are yours — set them honestly.

You'll need: Target + goal card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A specific target customer and a measurable goal are set.

Unlocks after: Decide what to launch

3 Where, when, and how

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Decide the launch setting — a safe pop-up (a school fair, a community table) or a small, adult-supervised online drop. Every launch needs a real place and time, and at your age it needs an adult in the loop for safety.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You and a parent decide: a stall at the school open day next Saturday. Real place, real date, adult present. That's a launch that can actually happen safely.

3 APPLY IT

With an adult, choose a safe launch setting, place, and date. Write them into your plan.

4 REFLECT

Is your setting somewhere your target customer will actually be? Right product, wrong place still fails.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Confirm the setting and safety plan with a parent before going further.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why the launch setting has to match where your customers are.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Anything public or online needs a real adult's approval and involvement — that's a safety judgement no tool makes for you. Keep an adult in the loop.

You'll need: Launch-setting plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A safe, adult-approved launch setting, place, and date are decided.

Unlocks after: Who's it for, and what's the goal?

4 Build the step plan and get buy-in

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Turn the whole launch into an ordered step plan — what the three other tracks (promote, build, sell) each need to do and by when. Then present it to your family or mentor for buy-in. Now the launch is real and the other three parts can begin.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your plan: this week — build the product and write the promo; next week — rehearse the pitch and promote; launch day — run the stall and track sales. Everyone knows their part.

3 APPLY IT

Break the launch into ordered steps across the four tracks. Present the full plan and confirm the date.

4 REFLECT

Does your plan connect all four pillars into one launch? That's the whole two years coming together.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Present the plan to family/mentor and ask what you have missed or scheduled too late.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through your entire launch plan as if recruiting them to help.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Sequencing your own launch is the strategic thinking that matters here — do it yourself. An adult helps with timing and safety, since they know the real-world constraints.

You'll need: Launch step-plan sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ An ordered step plan across all four tracks exists.
☐ The plan was presented and the launch date confirmed.

Unlocks after: Where, when, and how

COMMUNICATE · Q1

Say It So They Get It

co-11-12-q1 · supporting: Think, Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12 a child can hold a listener in mind — they're starting to notice when someone doesn't follow them, though they don't yet reliably adjust. They know a lot about the things they love and will happily info-dump; the growth edge is shaping that flood so someone else can actually receive it. Short, performable tasks with a real listener beat abstract 'communication skills' talk.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is a real person's face lighting up with 'oh, I get it now'. Making something you understand land in someone else's head is a genuine gift — and at this age it's mostly given to people they know: a parent, a friend, a younger sibling.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child explains something they genuinely love — a game, a hobby, an animal — to a real person who honestly doesn't know it, and finds out whether that person actually understood. The live reaction (confusion or the click of understanding) is the motivator; you can't fake your way past a real listener's blank face, and landing it feels great.

THE ARTIFACT

A 2-minute explainer (performed live or recorded as a short video) that makes one real listener genuinely understand something they didn't before — plus that listener's honest 'did you get it?' verdict.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A real listener can restate the main idea in their own words afterward.
- The explainer starts from something the listener already knew.
- The child cut at least one thing that was interesting to them but confusing to the listener.

1 Start where they already are

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

People understand new things by hooking them onto things they already know. Start from the listener's world, not yours — a bridge from something familiar to something new.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Explaining chess to someone new? 'It's like a battle where every soldier moves in its own special way' lands better than opening with 'the knight moves in an L'. The battle idea is already in their head.

3 APPLY IT

Pick your topic. Write one sentence that connects it to something your listener already knows and likes. That's your opening bridge.

4 REFLECT

What does your listener already know that you can build on? If you don't know, that's your first question to ask them.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Try your opening bridge on your real listener and watch: did they nod, or look lost? Adjust.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend how to make a 'bridge' opening for a topic *they* care about.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

AI can suggest analogies if you're stuck — a fair nudge. But the best bridge uses what *this specific listener* knows, and only you know them. Don't hand your listener a stranger's analogy.

You'll need: Bridge-opening worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ An opening line exists that links the topic to the listener's existing knowledge.

2 One idea at a time

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

When you love a topic, everything feels important and it all rushes out at once — and the listener drowns. Great explaining is putting ideas in a line, one clear step after another.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A good recipe never says 'do everything now'. It's step 1, step 2, step 3. Explaining works the same way: land one idea, then the next.

3 APPLY IT

List everything you want to say, then number them into an order where each step makes sense only after the one before. Cross out any that don't earn a place.

4 REFLECT

Which idea *must* come first for the rest to make sense? Getting the order right is half the battle.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Read your ordered steps to someone. Ask where they got lost — that's usually where two ideas got crammed together.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help someone put their own jumbled explanation into a clear order.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You can ask AI to help sort your points into an order, then check the order yourself against your listener. If a step only makes sense to you and not to them, the order is still wrong — trust the human, not the tidy list.

You'll need: Idea-ordering worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The explanation is broken into an ordered sequence with at least one idea cut.

Unlocks after: Start where they already are

3 Show it, don't just say it

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

A picture, a demo, or a quick example lands harder than words alone. Showing turns a vague idea into something the listener can actually see.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Explaining how a lever works? Don't just describe it — grab a ruler and a pencil and lift a book. Now they *see* it, and they'll remember.

3 APPLY IT

Find one place in your explainer to show instead of tell — a drawing, an object, a quick demo. Build it into your 2 minutes.

4 REFLECT

Where in your explanation did the listener's eyes glaze? That's the spot that most needs a show-not-tell.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Do the explainer with your 'show' moment. Ask the listener which part stuck most — was it the shown bit?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Challenge a friend to add a 'show' moment to their explanation and compare before/after.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can suggest what to demonstrate, but the actual showing — the object, the drawing, your hands — is yours to make real. A demo you performed beats a clever one you only described.

You'll need: Show-don't-tell idea card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The explainer includes at least one concrete demonstration or visual.

Unlocks after: One idea at a time

4 Deliver it and read the room

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

The final skill is watching your listener while you talk and adjusting — slowing down at a frown, moving on at a nod. An explainer is a two-way thing, not a speech at someone.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A good teacher notices the class going quiet-confused and stops to re-explain. They're reading faces, not just reciting.

3 APPLY IT

Deliver your full 2-minute explainer to your real listener. Watch their face and adjust live at least once.

4 REFLECT

Where did you have to slow down or change course? Those spots show you what's genuinely hard to explain.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Afterward, ask your listener to say the main idea back in their own words. If they can, you succeeded. If not, find where it broke.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the trick of 'ask them to say it back' as the real test of any explanation.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

This is a *no-AI* delivery — it's a human moment between you and a real listener. Reading a real face and adjusting is the whole skill, and no tool can stand in that spot for you.

You'll need: Listener 'say-it-back' check card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The explainer was delivered live and adjusted at least once mid-way.
☐ The listener restated the main idea in their own words.

Unlocks after: Show it, don't just say it

COMMUNICATE · Q2

Write to Convince

co-11-12-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, writing is developing fast and children hold strong opinions they're keen to defend. They can now learn to structure a persuasive piece — claim, then reasons, then evidence — and publish it somewhere real. This builds on Q1's clear spoken explaining and adds the harder discipline of persuading on paper, where you can't read the listener's face and every word has to carry itself.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is actually changing someone's mind or decision with your writing — a real person reads what you wrote and reconsiders, recommends, or acts. It's the first taste of influence through words that outlive the moment you speak them.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child writes a persuasive piece and publishes it to a real audience — a family chat, a class board, a note on the fridge — then sees genuine reactions. Real readers responding (agreeing, pushing back, acting on it) makes writing feel powerful rather than like homework. The stakes of a real audience sharpen every choice.

THE ARTIFACT

A short persuasive piece (roughly 150–250 words — a review, a recommendation, or an opinion) published to a real audience, containing a clear claim, reasons, and evidence.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The piece opens with one clear claim or opinion.
- It supports the claim with reasons and at least one piece of real evidence.
- It was published to a real audience and the child noted the reaction.

Unlocks after: Say It So They Get It

1 Start with your claim

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Persuasive writing begins with one clear claim — the single thing you want the reader to believe or do. If your reader can't tell what you're arguing for in the first line, you've already lost them.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'This game is the best value on the app store' is a claim. 'Some thoughts about games' is not. The claim tells the reader exactly where you're taking them.

3 APPLY IT

Pick something you have a real opinion on (a game, book, place, idea). Write your claim in one clear sentence.

4 REFLECT

Is your claim something people could actually disagree with? If nobody could disagree, it's not worth persuading.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your claim to someone and ask if it's clear what you're arguing. Sharpen it if not.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend turn a vague opinion into one sharp claim.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The opinion must be genuinely *yours* — persuasion built on a claim you don't actually believe reads hollow. Don't let AI pick your position.

You'll need: Claim-writing card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One clear, arguable claim is written.

2 Back it with reasons and evidence

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

A claim without support is just a shout. Give two or three reasons, and back at least one with real evidence — a fact, an example, a number, a comparison. Evidence is what turns 'because I say so' into 'because look'.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Claim: this game is great value. Reason + evidence: 'It costs RM10 but has 40 hours of levels — that's cheaper per hour than a single cinema trip.' The number makes it convincing.

3 APPLY IT

Write two or three reasons for your claim, and add one real piece of evidence to your strongest reason.

4 REFLECT

Which reason is strongest? Persuasive writers lead with their best, not their first.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Read your reasons to someone and ask which convinced them most — and which fell flat.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone the difference between a reason and actual evidence for it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If you use AI to check a fact, verify it's real before you publish — putting a made-up statistic in your writing destroys your credibility. Real evidence only.

You'll need: Reasons + evidence organiser

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Two or three reasons with at least one real piece of evidence are written.

Unlocks after: Start with your claim

3 Answer the other side

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Strong persuasion admits the other side exists — then answers it. Naming the main objection and responding to it shows you've thought it through and makes doubters trust you more, not less.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Some say RM10 is too much for a phone game — but most games at that price give a few hours; this gives forty.' You raised the objection and knocked it down. Now the reader has no easy escape.

3 APPLY IT

Write the strongest objection to your claim, then add a sentence answering it, into your piece.

4 REFLECT

Was it uncomfortable to argue against yourself? Doing it well is what separates convincing from ranting.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask someone who disagrees with you what their objection is. Did you already answer it? If not, add it.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone why answering the other side makes an argument stronger, not weaker.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can suggest objections you hadn't thought of — a genuinely useful sparring partner here. But you decide which are real and how to answer them honestly.

You'll need: Objection + answer card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The main objection is named and answered within the piece.

Unlocks after: Back it with reasons and evidence

4 Publish and see the reaction

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Finish, polish, and publish to a real audience — a family group, a class board, a note somewhere people will read it. Then watch what happens. Real reactions are the truest feedback a writer gets.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You post your game review in the family chat and your cousin actually buys the game because of it. That's persuasion working — your words changed a real decision.

3 APPLY IT

Polish your piece and publish it somewhere real. Note who read it and how they reacted.

4 REFLECT

Did anyone agree, disagree, or act on it? What in your writing seemed to land hardest?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask one reader what convinced them most and what they'd push back on. Keep it for next time.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of publishing your piece and the reaction it got.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you fix spelling and flow before publishing, but the argument and voice must stay yours — readers can feel when writing isn't really a person's. Keep it sounding like you.

You'll need: Publish + reaction log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The piece was published to a real audience.
☐ The child recorded real reader reactions.

Unlocks after: Answer the other side

COMMUNICATE · Q3

Pitch It

co-11-12-q3 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can prepare and deliver a short spoken pitch to a small group, with a hook, a clear core message, and basic handling of questions. This steps up from Q2's written persuasion to live, on-your-feet persuasion in front of several people — where nerves are real and rehearsal genuinely helps. It directly prepares them to pitch their year-end launch.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is winning a room — getting a group interested in and on board with your idea, live and in person. It's a high-stakes, high-status skill at this age: the ability to stand up, say something well, and have people lean in.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child delivers a real pitch to a real small group and feels the room respond. Standing up in front of peers or family and landing it carries real weight at this age — a successful pitch feels like a genuine win, and that pull makes the rehearsal and nerves worth pushing through.

THE ARTIFACT

A short pitch (about 60–90 seconds) delivered live to a real small group, with a strong hook, one clear message, and at least one audience question handled.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The pitch opens with a hook that grabs attention in the first line.
- It has one clear message the audience could repeat afterward.
- The child delivered it live and handled at least one real question.

Unlocks after: Write to Convince

1 The hook

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

You have about five seconds before a group tunes out. A hook — a surprising fact, a question, a bold claim — buys their attention. Open strong, or the best pitch in the world goes unheard.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'What if I told you our class wastes 200 sheets of paper a week?' grabs everyone. 'Um, so, I want to talk about paper...' loses them instantly. Same topic, totally different opening.

3 APPLY IT

Pick something you want to pitch. Write three possible hooks, then choose the strongest.

4 REFLECT

Which hook would make *you* look up if you were half-listening? That's your winner.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Try your top hook on someone and watch — did they actually look up?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend write a hook for something they want to pitch.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can brainstorm hook ideas, but pick and shape the one that fits your real idea and your voice — a hook you don't believe falls flat when you say it.

You'll need: Hook-writing card (3 options)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A strong opening hook is chosen from several options.

2 One clear message

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

A pitch isn't everything you know — it's *one* thing you want them to remember or do. Pick your single core message and build the whole pitch around it. If the audience leaves remembering one sentence, what should it be?

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Core message: 'Let's put a paper-recycling box in every classroom.' Everything else in the pitch supports that one idea. Clear and repeatable.

3 APPLY IT

Write your one core message in a single sentence. Then note two quick points that support it.

4 REFLECT

If your audience forgot everything but one sentence, is your core message the one they'd keep?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Say your message to someone and, a minute later, ask them to repeat it. Did it stick?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone why a pitch needs one core message, not ten.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

AI can help you tighten your message to one line, but the idea and the two supporting points should be yours and true — you have to defend them live.

You'll need: Core-message + support card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One clear core message and two supporting points are written.

Unlocks after: The hook

3 Handle questions

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

After a pitch, people ask things — and how you handle it matters as much as the pitch. Listen fully, don't panic, and it's fine to say 'good question' and think for a second. Honest answers beat bluffing.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Who empties the recycling boxes?' You don't have a perfect answer, so you say: 'Good question — I'd suggest a class rota; I can work out the details.' Calm and honest wins trust.

3 APPLY IT

Guess the three hardest questions your pitch might get. Write a calm, honest answer for each.

4 REFLECT

Which question worried you most? Preparing it turns a scary moment into an easy one.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone fire your three questions (and a surprise one) at you. Practise staying calm.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend the trick of 'listen, pause, answer honestly' for tough questions.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you anticipate questions — useful prep. But answer honestly in the moment; if you don't know, saying so is stronger than a confident bluff.

You'll need: Anticipated-questions sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three likely questions are anticipated with prepared honest answers.

Unlocks after: One clear message

4 Deliver it live

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Now put it together and pitch — hook, message, support — to a real small group, then take their questions. Stand tall, speak up, use the voice and expression skills you've built. This is the whole skill, live.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You pitch the recycling idea to your family or class, land the hook, deliver your message, and field two questions calmly. Whether they say yes or not, you *pitched* — and that's the win.

3 APPLY IT

Deliver your pitch live to a real small group and handle at least one real question.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel up there? What worked, and what would you tighten next time?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your audience: was the message clear, and was the hook strong? Note their answers.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Coach someone else through delivering a short pitch of their own.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Delivering live to a real group is fully human — presence, nerves, real questions. No tool stands up there for you; this one's all yours.

You'll need: Pitch delivery checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The pitch was delivered live to a real group.
☐ At least one real question was handled.

Unlocks after: Handle questions

COMMUNICATE · Q4

Promote and Pitch

co-11-12-q4 · supporting: Think, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Communicate brings in the customers. At 11–12 a child can pull together persuasive writing (Q2) and live pitching (Q3) to promote a real launch and win over real potential customers — not just family. This is persuasion aimed at driving actual action (show up, buy), the highest-stakes communicating of the two years.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is getting real people interested enough to turn up or buy — persuasion that moves strangers to act. It's the difference between a good product nobody hears about and a launch people actually come to.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The child promotes to real potential customers and pitches live at the launch, then sees whether their words brought people in. Persuasion that visibly works — a stranger showing up because of your promo, buying after your pitch — is thrilling and validating, and it makes every rehearsal worth it.

THE ARTIFACT

Promotional materials (a written promo plus a short spoken launch pitch) prepared, rehearsed, and delivered to real potential customers before and at the launch.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The written promo is honest, clear, and tempting to the target customer.
- The spoken pitch has a hook and one clear message and was rehearsed.
- Both were delivered to real potential customers (safely, with adult approval).

Unlocks after: Pitch It, Plan the Launch

1 Write the promo

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Write a short promotional message using your persuasive-writing skills: a clear claim, a reason to care, aimed at your target customer. Keep it honest — over-promising wins one sale and loses all trust.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Spicy homemade snacks at Saturday's open day — RM2, made fresh, tested on the whole class. Come hungry!' Short, honest, tempting, and aimed right at snack-buyers.

3 APPLY IT

Write your promo message (a few lines) for your target customer. Make it honest and tempting.

4 REFLECT

Would your target customer stop and read this? Does it promise only what you can deliver?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your promo to a parent for approval and a 'would this make you come?' check.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend how to write an honest promo that still tempts people.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help polish the wording, but keep it true and in your voice — and never promise what your product can't deliver. Honesty is your reputation.

You’ll need: Promo-writing card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ An honest, tempting promo aimed at the target customer is written.

2 Prepare the launch pitch

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Prepare a short spoken pitch for launch day using your Q3 pitching skills — a hook, one clear message, and a friendly close that invites the sale. This is what you say to someone standing at your stall or watching your drop.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Hungry? These are fresh spicy snacks I made and tested with my whole class — RM2 each, and the first batch always goes fast. Want to try one?' Hook, message, invite to buy.

3 APPLY IT

Write your 20–30 second launch pitch: hook, core message, and a friendly invitation to buy.

4 REFLECT

Does your pitch end by actually inviting the sale? Many pitches forget to ask.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Say your pitch to a parent and ask if it would make them want to try one.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone the shape of a good sales pitch: hook, message, invite.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help draft it, but you deliver it live in your own voice — a pitch that sounds scripted or fake loses customers. Make it sound like you.

You'll need: Launch-pitch card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A short launch pitch with hook, message, and invitation is prepared.

Unlocks after: Write the promo

3 Rehearse and refine

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Rehearse your pitch until it flows, and get a second pair of eyes on your promo. The launch is a one-shot moment — practising now means you'll be confident and clear when real customers are watching.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You practise the pitch ten times and it stops sounding stiff. A friend reads your promo and points out a confusing line. Both are far better before launch day than during it.

3 APPLY IT

Rehearse your pitch several times aloud, and refine your promo based on one piece of feedback.

4 REFLECT

Where does your pitch still stumble? Those spots need one more run-through.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Do a full dress rehearsal for a family member and ask what would make it land better.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why rehearsing a one-shot pitch matters so much.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Rehearsing your real voice is all you. AI can suggest a tweak to wording, but the confident delivery only comes from your own practice.

You'll need: Rehearsal checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The pitch was rehearsed to fluency and the promo refined once.

Unlocks after: Prepare the launch pitch

4 Promote for real

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Put your promo out (safely, adult-approved) before the launch, and deliver your pitch to real customers on the day. This is the whole communication arc — writing and speaking to persuade — driving a real event.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your promo goes up on the approved school board mid-week; on Saturday you pitch to everyone who stops by. Some came because of the promo; some buy because of the pitch. Persuasion, working.

3 APPLY IT

Share your promo (adult-approved) ahead of the launch, then deliver your pitch to real customers on launch day.

4 REFLECT

Did your promo bring anyone in? Did your pitch turn lookers into buyers? What worked best?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Afterward, ask a customer what made them stop or buy — the promo, the pitch, or the product?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of promoting and pitching your launch and what landed.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Delivering to real customers is fully human and needs adult-approved, safe channels. This is your voice winning real people — no tool does it for you.

You'll need: Promo + pitch outcome log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The promo was shared safely and the pitch delivered to real customers.
☐ The child noted what drew customers in.

Unlocks after: Rehearse and refine

BUILD · Q1

Make a Thing That Works

bu-11-12-q1 · supporting: Think, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can follow a multi-step plan and love making something *real* appear from their own effort, but they get discouraged fast when a first attempt is messy. They don't need programming syntax; they need the experience of turning an idea into a working thing and seeing a real person use it. Keep the build small enough to finish in a sitting or two so the payoff arrives before the patience runs out.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value at this age is: 'I made this, and it actually works, and someone used it.' The thrill is the gap between an idea in your head and a real thing on a screen that does something. Usefulness to one real person beats polish.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child builds the smallest possible working version of something useful — a quiz for a friend, a tiny web page for a family event, a simple automation — and watches a real person use it. The magic of 'the thing I imagined now exists and works' is the driver, sharpened by one real user actually trying it. Finishing something real is the reward.

THE ARTIFACT

One small working digital thing (a quiz, a one-page site, a simple automation) that does something useful, tried at least once by a real person who isn't the builder.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The thing runs and does what it's meant to for a real user.
- The child can explain in plain words what each part does — nothing in it is a mystery to them.
- They changed at least one thing after watching a real person get confused by it.

1 Who is it for, and what does it do?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Before building anything, name the one person it's for and the one thing it does for them. A builder who skips this makes something cool that nobody needs.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'A quiz to help my little brother practise his times tables' beats 'a maths app'. One person, one job — now you know exactly what to build.

3 APPLY IT

Write one sentence: 'This is for [name], and it helps them [do one thing].' If you can't, your idea isn't ready yet.

4 REFLECT

Is the one thing small enough to actually finish? Beginners always pick too big — what could you cut?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Tell your chosen person your sentence and ask: 'Would that actually help you?' Listen for a real yes.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend write their own 'for [name], helps them [do X]' sentence.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Fine to brainstorm ideas with AI, but *you* pick the real person and the real job — the model doesn't know who's actually in your life to help.

You'll need: One-sentence project brief card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A one-person, one-job project sentence is written and checked with the real person.

2 Sketch before you build

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Draw the thing on paper first — what's on the screen, what happens when you tap. A sketch is cheap to change; a half-built project is painful to change.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Game designers draw levels on paper before touching a computer. Ten seconds with a pencil can save an hour of building the wrong thing.

3 APPLY IT

Sketch every screen or step of your thing on paper, with arrows showing what happens next. Keep it rough.

4 REFLECT

Walking through your own sketch, where does it get confusing? Better to find it now, on paper.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show the sketch to your real user and have them 'tap' through it with a finger. Note where they hesitate.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone why sketching first saves time, using your own before/after.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Sketch by hand yourself — this is thinking, not decoration. AI can't do your thinking about what the thing should be; that has to live in your own head first.

You'll need: Blank sketch/flow sheets

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A hand sketch shows every screen/step with the flow between them.

Unlocks after: Who is it for, and what does it do?

3 Build the smallest version

~45 min

1 CONCEPT

Build the tiniest version that works at all — one question, one page, one action. You can always add more, but only once the small thing runs. Understand every piece you put in.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The first version of a big app is usually embarrassingly basic — one screen that barely works. That's correct. Small-and-working beats big-and-broken every time.

3 APPLY IT

Build the smallest working version from your sketch, using whatever tool fits (a no-code builder, a simple site maker, AI help). Get it to actually run.

4 REFLECT

Can you explain what every part does? Anything you can't explain is a part you don't yet control.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show a mentor or parent the running thing and have them point to any part that looks like a 'mystery box' to you. Go understand that part.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through your build and explain what each piece does in plain words.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

AI can help you build — but the rule is: **never ship what you can't explain.** If AI made a piece you don't understand, either learn it or take it out. A builder who can't explain their own thing isn't really building, they're copying.

You'll need: List of kid-safe no-code / site-builder tools

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A minimal version runs and does its one job.
☐ The child can explain every part of it in their own words.

Unlocks after: Sketch before you build

4 Test it on a real person and fix one thing

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

You can't see your own thing clearly — you know how it's *meant* to work, so you skip past the confusing bits. A real user finds them in seconds. Then you fix the worst one.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Watch someone use your quiz without helping them. Where they get stuck or press the wrong thing tells you exactly what to fix — no guessing needed.

3 APPLY IT

Hand your thing to your real user and stay quiet. Write down every place they get confused. Then fix the single most confusing one.

4 REFLECT

Was the confusing part the bit you were most proud of? That happens a lot — building for yourself vs building for them are different.

5 GET FEEDBACK

After fixing, have them try again. Did the fix work? If not, you found the wrong thing to fix.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach a friend the rule: 'watch them use it, stay silent, fix what confused them.'

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

A real human tester beats any AI check here — AI won't get confused the way a real 8-year-old will. Use AI afterward only to help *fix* the specific thing your tester tripped on.

You'll need: User-test observation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real person tested the thing while the builder observed silently.
☐ At least one change was made based on real confusion, then re-tested.

Unlocks after: Build the smallest version

BUILD · Q2

Build Version Two

bu-11-12-q2 · supporting: Think, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can handle the real iteration loop: get a thing into several people's hands, gather feedback that's actually useful, decide what matters, and build a genuine second version. This is a clear step up from Q1's single-user test — the leap from 'I made a thing' to 'I made it noticeably better because I listened'. It also introduces a mature judgement: not every request should be built.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is making something measurably better by listening to real users — the core loop every real builder lives by. It's the difference between a one-off project and a thing that actually improves, and the pride is in the visible jump from v1 to v2.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child watches several real people use their creation, then builds a version two that's clearly better — and gets to see users prefer it. The satisfaction of a real, visible improvement driven by their own good decisions is deeply motivating, and it feels like how 'real' makers and companies work.

THE ARTIFACT

Version two of a digital or physical thing, improved from feedback gathered from at least three real users, with a short before/after showing what changed and why.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- At least three real people used version one, and the child gathered their feedback.
- The child chose which changes mattered instead of trying to do all of them.
- A real version two exists, and the child can explain why each change was made.

Unlocks after: Make a Thing That Works

1 Get it into real hands

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

One tester tells you a little; several tell you a pattern. Get your thing (from Q1, or a new small one) into the hands of at least three real people and let them actually use it — no hovering, no explaining.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A quiz app tested by one friend seems fine. Tested by five, you notice three of them get stuck on the same screen — that's a real pattern you'd never have seen from one.

3 APPLY IT

Get your thing used by at least three real people. Just watch and let them use it naturally.

4 REFLECT

Did more testers reveal problems one wouldn't have? Patterns need a few people to show up.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask each tester to simply use it while you watch quietly. Note where each one struggles.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why three testers beat one for finding real problems.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Real human testers find real human confusion — something AI can't simulate well. Use real people here; no shortcut.

You'll need: Tester observation grid (3+ users)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ At least three real people used the thing while the child observed.

2 Gather feedback that's useful

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Vague feedback ('it's nice') is useless. Ask questions that get real answers: 'What was confusing?' 'What would you change?' 'Where did you get stuck?' And trust what you *saw* them do over what they politely say.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A tester says 'it's great!' but you watched them fail the same button three times. What they *did* is the real feedback; the polite words are just being kind.

3 APPLY IT

For each tester, write down one thing they said and one thing you saw them struggle with.

4 REFLECT

Where did what people said differ from what they did? Which do you trust more, and why?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Compare your notes with a parent — do any struggles show up across multiple testers?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend how to ask feedback questions that get useful answers, not just 'it's nice'.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you write good feedback questions to ask. But the feedback itself must come from real users doing real things — that's the data that counts.

You'll need: Feedback capture sheet (said vs did)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Useful feedback (said and observed) is captured for each tester.

Unlocks after: Get it into real hands

3 Decide what to change

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

You can't and shouldn't build every request. Pick the changes that matter most — the problems several people hit, or the one that ruins the experience. Saying no to some feedback is as important as saying yes to the rest.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Testers asked for rainbow colours, a login, and a fix for the stuck button. The stuck button broke the whole thing for three people — that's the one that matters. The rainbow can wait forever.

3 APPLY IT

List all the feedback, then circle the two or three changes that matter most. Note why you're skipping the rest.

4 REFLECT

Was it hard to ignore some requests? Good builders choose; they don't just obey every suggestion.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Explain your chosen changes to a mentor and why you're skipping the others. Does your reasoning hold?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone why building every request would actually make a thing worse.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This choosing is judgement — the most human part of building. Don't outsource it; a list of 'what users want' isn't a decision about what to build.

You'll need: Change-prioritisation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Two or three priority changes are chosen with reasons for skipping others.

Unlocks after: Gather feedback that's useful

4 Build v2 and compare

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Build your version two with the changes that mattered. Then show the before and after — ideally to a tester — so the improvement is visible. Seeing v1 and v2 side by side is proof your listening paid off.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

V2 fixes the stuck button and adds clearer instructions. You show a tester both versions and they breeze through v2. That visible jump is the whole reward.

3 APPLY IT

Build version two with your priority changes. Write a short before/after: what changed and why.

4 REFLECT

Is v2 clearly better? What did listening to real users get you that guessing wouldn't have?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show v2 to at least one original tester. Ask if it's better and where.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through your v1 → v2 story and how feedback drove it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you build the changes, but keep the rule from Q1: understand every part. A v2 full of parts you can't explain isn't really your improvement.

You'll need: Before/after comparison card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real version two exists with the priority changes built.
☐ The child can explain each change and show the improvement.

Unlocks after: Decide what to change

BUILD · Q3

Build for Strangers

bu-11-12-q3 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT’S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can take a build that worked for friends and make it work for people who've never met them: clear instructions, works without anyone explaining, looks trustworthy, and handles mistakes without breaking. This is a genuinely new design skill — empathy for a user you'll never talk to — and a clear step past Q2's iteration with friends. It prepares them to ship to real customers at the launch.

WHAT “CREATING VALUE” MEANS HERE

Value here is a thing that works for people who've never met you — the real line between a friend-project and an actual product. When a stranger can pick it up and succeed with no help, you've built something that can stand on its own in the world.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child watches a true stranger — someone who's never seen the thing and can't ask them for help — use their creation successfully. That moment, when it works without the maker in the room, feels like leveling up from 'kid who made a thing' to 'someone who builds real products'. It's a proud, concrete milestone.

THE ARTIFACT

A build made 'stranger-ready': clear instructions, works unaided, looks trustworthy, handles at least one common mistake, and tested by someone who didn't know it beforehand.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The thing can be used by someone with no explanation from the maker.
- It guides a first-timer and handles at least one likely mistake gracefully.
- A real person who'd never seen it succeeded in using it.

Unlocks after: Build Version Two

1 Strangers don't have you to explain

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

When friends test your thing, you're standing there to explain. Strangers aren't — they have only what's on the screen or page. So everything a user needs must be built *in*. If it needs you to explain it, it's not ready for strangers.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your quiz made sense because you told your friend 'tap the green one to start'. A stranger sees no green button explained anywhere and is stuck on the first screen. The instruction lived in your mouth, not the product.

3 APPLY IT

Look at your Q2 build and list every place where a stranger would need you to explain something. Those are your gaps.

4 REFLECT

How many hidden 'you have to explain it' moments did you find? Most builds have more than the maker expects.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a parent to spot places where your thing assumes the user already knows something.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why a thing that needs the maker present isn't really finished.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You know your build; imagining a stranger's confusion is your job here. AI can't feel lost the way a real first-timer will — but it can help you write clearer instructions once you've found the gaps.

You'll need: Stranger-gap checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Places needing explanation are identified across the build.

2 Clear instructions and signposting

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Guide the first-timer. A short instruction, a clear label, an obvious 'start here' — these signposts let a stranger find their way. Good design quietly tells people what to do next, without a manual.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Adding 'Tap START to begin' and numbering the steps turns a confusing screen into one a stranger breezes through. Small signposts, big difference.

3 APPLY IT

Add clear instructions and signposts to fix the gaps you found. Keep them short and obvious.

4 REFLECT

Could a stranger now get started without asking anyone? Read it as if you'd never seen it.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show the updated version to someone and ask if it's now clear where to begin.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend how one good 'start here' signpost helps a first-timer.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI is genuinely helpful for drafting clear, friendly instructions. But test them on a real person — clarity is judged by a confused human, not by how good the words look.

You'll need: Instruction/signpost worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Clear instructions and signposts were added to guide a first-timer.

Unlocks after: Strangers don't have you to explain

3 Handle mistakes gracefully

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Strangers will do unexpected things — tap the wrong button, leave a box blank, get it 'wrong'. A good build expects this and handles it kindly, with a helpful nudge instead of breaking or a scary error. Plan for the mistake.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A stranger leaves the name box empty and taps submit. Instead of crashing, your quiz gently says 'Please add your name first'. It caught the mistake and helped, rather than breaking.

3 APPLY IT

Think of one common mistake a stranger might make. Build a graceful response to it (a gentle message or a safe default).

4 REFLECT

What's the most likely 'wrong' thing a stranger could do? Handling that one well covers a lot.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone deliberately 'do it wrong' and see if your build handles it kindly.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why good things expect mistakes instead of assuming everyone does it right.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

AI can help you build the graceful response, but keep the Q1 rule — understand every part. And you must decide *which* mistakes matter; that's judgement about your real users.

You’ll need: Mistake-handling card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ At least one common user mistake is handled gracefully.

Unlocks after: Clear instructions and signposting

4 Test with a true stranger

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

The real test: someone who has never seen your thing and can't ask you for help. Watch them (silently!) try to use it. If they succeed alone, it's stranger-ready. If they get stuck, you've found the last gaps to fix.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You give your quiz to a cousin who's never seen it, say nothing, and watch. They start, play, and finish with no help. That silent success is proof you built for strangers.

3 APPLY IT

Find someone who's never seen your build. Let them try it with zero help while you watch. Note any sticking points and fix the worst one.

4 REFLECT

Where did the stranger struggle that friends never did? Strangers reveal the truth about your design.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the stranger afterward: was anything confusing or missing? Take it seriously.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone why a true stranger is the best test of whether a thing is really finished.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Only a real, unfamiliar human can truly test this — AI already 'knows too much' and won't get lost like a real first-timer. Use a real stranger.

You'll need: Stranger-test observation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A true first-timer used the build unaided.
☐ Remaining gaps were noted and the worst one fixed.

Unlocks after: Handle mistakes gracefully

BUILD · Q4

Ship the Product

bu-11-12-q4 · supporting: Think, Create Wealth

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Build produces what the launch sells. At 11–12 a child can pull together iteration (Q2) and building-for-strangers (Q3) to make the actual product or service customers will buy — tested, stranger-ready, and in enough quantity to hit the launch goal. This is the leap to making something genuinely ready to sell to people they've never met.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is a real product or service ready for real customers — the maker's contribution to the launch. It's every building skill from two years, aimed at one bar: a stranger can buy it, use it, and be happy, with no help from you.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The child produces the real thing that real strangers will pay for and use on launch day. Knowing paying customers — not just friends — will judge the work raises the bar in a motivating way, and a table of finished, sell-ready product (or a service ready to deliver) is a powerful, tangible source of pride.

THE ARTIFACT

The finished, stranger-ready product or service, produced in enough quantity/capacity for the launch goal, and given a final test by a stranger.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The product/service is stranger-ready: usable and trustworthy with no help from the maker.
- There is enough stock or capacity to meet the launch goal.
- A final stranger test was done and the last issue fixed before launch.

Unlocks after: Build for Strangers, Plan the Launch

1 Decide the product and how much you need

~15 min

1 CONCEPT

Match your product to the launch goal. If the goal is 10 customers, you need enough for at least 10 (plus a few spare). Making too little means turning customers away; too much wastes effort. Plan the quantity on purpose.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Goal: 10 snack sales. So you make 12 portions — enough for the goal plus a couple extra, without over-making and wasting ingredients you paid for.

3 APPLY IT

Decide exactly what you're making/offering and how many, based on your launch goal. Write the number.

4 REFLECT

Does your quantity match your goal, with a small buffer? Too little or too much both cost you.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Check your quantity plan with a parent against your goal and your budget.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why you plan quantity from the goal, not just 'as many as possible'.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is simple planning tied to your real goal and budget — do it yourself so you understand your own numbers.

You’ll need: Quantity-plan card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Product and quantity are decided to match the launch goal.

2 Make it stranger-ready

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Apply your Q3 skills: the product must work for strangers. That means clear labelling, obvious use, trustworthy presentation, and no need for you to explain anything. A launch customer should 'get it' instantly.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Your snacks get clear labels ('Spicy — RM2'), neat packaging, and an allergy note. A stranger can see what it is, what it costs, and trust it — no explanation needed.

3 APPLY IT

Make your product stranger-ready: labelling, presentation, and anything a customer needs to know without asking.

4 REFLECT

Could a total stranger understand and trust your product at a glance? If not, what's missing?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your prepared product to someone unfamiliar and ask if anything is unclear.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend what 'stranger-ready' means for a product on a stall.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help with clear label wording or a neat design, but keep the Q1 rule — understand and stand behind every part. And a real stranger's glance is the true test of clarity.

You'll need: Stranger-ready checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The product is labelled, presented, and usable with no maker explanation.

Unlocks after: Decide the product and how much you need

3 Produce enough for the launch

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Now actually produce your batch (or prepare to deliver your service) to the quantity you planned — at consistent quality. The tenth item should be as good as the first. Consistency is what a real customer expects.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You make all 12 snack portions to the same standard, not great-then-sloppy. Every customer gets the quality you promised in your pitch.

3 APPLY IT

Produce your full batch (or set up your service capacity) at consistent quality.

4 REFLECT

Did quality hold from first to last? Tiredness makes the last few slip — how did you keep them good?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Have someone check a few items from across your batch for consistent quality.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why consistency across a whole batch matters for real customers.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Production is your real work and craft — no shortcut. The consistency that builds a good name comes from you.

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Enough product for the goal is produced at consistent quality.

Unlocks after: Make it stranger-ready

4 Final stranger test and fix

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

One last check before launch: have a stranger 'buy' and use your product exactly as a customer would. Any confusion or flaw they hit is your final fix — far better found now than in front of paying customers.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A neighbour 'buys' a snack, and you notice the label smudges when handled. You fix the labels the night before — crisis avoided before real customers ever see it.

3 APPLY IT

Run a final stranger test of the whole customer experience. Fix the last issue it reveals.

4 REFLECT

What did the final test catch? The last stranger always finds something the maker can't see.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask your final tester: as a customer, would you buy this and be happy? Take the answer seriously.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone why a final stranger test right before launch is worth the effort.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Only a real, fresh stranger can catch what you've gone blind to — AI can't experience your product as a surprised customer. Use a real person for the final check.

You'll need: Final-test card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A final stranger test of the full experience was done.
☐ The last issue was fixed before launch.

Unlocks after: Produce enough for the launch

CREATE WEALTH · Q1

Your First Real Yes

cw-11-12-q1 · supporting: Build, Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, money is becoming real but is still often secondary to the pride of *making something people want*. A child this age can make one good thing and offer it, but handling many customers, real pricing strategy, or rejection from strangers is a stretch — the first 'yes' often comes from someone they know, and that's developmentally right. Keep stakes tiny and real, and keep the loop short so the yes arrives quickly.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value at this age means someone *chooses* to have the thing you made — a real, voluntary yes, even from a neighbour or aunt, as long as it isn't just to be kind. The lesson isn't profit; it's the discovery that making something good and offering it can lead to a genuine 'yes, I'd like that'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child makes one real thing (a baked treat, a small craft, a simple helper service) and aims for one honest yes from a real person. The stakes are small but real — a real person really deciding — which feels different from pretend play. Landing the first genuine yes is a memorable, motivating milestone at this age.

THE ARTIFACT

One real thing made or one real service offered, plus a record of the first genuine yes (who, what they said) and any nos with their reasons.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child made or prepared something real to offer.
- They made a real ask to at least one person outside the immediate household.
- They can say why the person said yes or no, in the person's own words.

1 What do people around you actually want?

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

You can only sell or give something people actually want. So start by *noticing* — what do the people near you wish they had, or wish was easier?

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A kid noticed her neighbours' plants dying while they were at work. 'I'll water your plants for RM5 a week' was an offer people actually wanted — because she spotted a real wish first.

3 APPLY IT

Watch the people around you for a day. Write down three things they seem to want or find annoying. Circle one you could help with.

4 REFLECT

Is the thing you circled something *they* want, or something *you'd* enjoy making? The best ideas are both — but their want has to be real.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the person: 'Would something like this be useful to you?' Write down their actual words.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a sibling why you should find out what people want *before* making something.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you think of ideas after you've watched real people — but it can't see your neighbours. The noticing has to be yours; that's the actual skill.

You'll need: Noticing worksheet (3 wants + circle)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three real wants are noted and one is chosen based on a real person's want.

2 Make one good one

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Beginners rush to make ten of something and they're all a bit rubbish. Make *one*, and make it genuinely good. One good thing earns a yes; ten rushed ones earn nos.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A boy selling friendship bracelets made one beautiful sample first. People saw the good one and *then* ordered — the quality did the selling.

3 APPLY IT

Make one really good version of your thing (or plan your service carefully). Take your time; this one has to be good enough to earn a yes.

4 REFLECT

Would *you* say yes to your own thing? If not, what needs to be better before you offer it?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your one good version to someone honest and ask what would make it better. Improve it once.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell a friend why 'one good one' beats 'ten rushed ones'.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

If your thing is digital, AI might help you make it — but you must be able to make it good *and* understand it. For a hands-made thing, the craft is yours; don't fake quality you didn't build.

You'll need: Quality checklist card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One genuinely good version exists, improved at least once after feedback.

Unlocks after: What do people around you actually want?

3 What's it worth?

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

A price (or a trade) is you saying what your thing is worth. Too cheap and it feels worthless; too dear and people say no. You're looking for a fair number that feels right to both sides.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The plant-watering kid started at RM2 and everyone said yes instantly — too cheap. At RM5, people still said yes, and she earned more for the same work. The price was a question she tested.

3 APPLY IT

Decide a fair price or trade for your thing and write one sentence on why. Think about the time and materials it took.

4 REFLECT

Does your price feel a little scary to say out loud? A price that feels slightly bold is often about right.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Say your price to one person and watch their reaction before they answer. Note whether they blinked.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why a price that everyone accepts instantly might be too low.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can tell you what similar things cost, as a rough guide. But the fair price depends on your effort and your real people — trust what they show you over what the model guesses.

You'll need: Simple pricing worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A price or trade is set with a stated reason.

Unlocks after: Make one good one

4 The first ask

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Everything so far was getting ready. It becomes real when you actually ask someone: 'Would you like this?' A yes is exciting; a no isn't failure — it usually comes with a reason you can learn from.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A girl selling cookies heard 'no thanks, I don't like chocolate' — so her next batch had a plain option, and that person bought. The no taught her the fix.

3 APPLY IT

Make your real ask to at least one person outside your home. Write down what they said — yes or no — and their reason.

4 REFLECT

How did asking feel? If a no stung, remember: it's information, not a verdict on you. What did it teach you?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Share your yes/no and the reason with a parent or mentor, and decide together one thing to try differently next time.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of your first ask — the yes or the no — and what you learned from it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

No tool can make the ask for you, and that's the point — the small nervousness of a real ask is exactly the thing you're practising. Use AI only afterward, to help think through what a no was telling you.

You’ll need: First-ask record card (who / yes-no / reason)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A real ask was made to someone outside the household.
☐ The response and its reason were recorded, and one next step was chosen.

Unlocks after: What's it worth?

CREATE WEALTH · Q2

Did You Actually Make Money?

cw-11-12-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can grasp a genuinely important idea that younger kids can't: money coming in is not the same as money made. They can list simple costs, track revenue, and work out real profit by subtracting. This builds directly on Q1's first sale — now they look behind the sale at whether it was actually worth it, which is the foundation of all real business thinking.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is knowing whether your thing *actually* makes money — the difference between feeling successful (money came in!) and being successful (money was left over after costs). It's a grown-up truth that reframes every little venture they'll ever run.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child discovers the real answer to 'did I make money?' about their own venture — sometimes a surprising, slightly deflating one — and then gets to fix it. The stakes are real (it's their own money and effort), and the satisfying 'aha' of seeing the true profit, then improving it, drives the learning far better than a lecture on costs ever could.

THE ARTIFACT

A simple profit calculation for a real or realistic little venture: costs listed, revenue listed, profit worked out, and a decision about what the number means.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child listed all the costs that went into their venture, not just the obvious one.
- They calculated profit as revenue minus costs and can explain the difference.
- They made one decision (raise price, cut a cost, or change) based on the real profit.

Unlocks after: Your First Real Yes

1 Money in isn't money made

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

'I sold RM20 of bracelets!' feels like success. But if the beads cost RM15, you only actually *made* RM5. The money that comes in is 'revenue'; the money you keep after costs is 'profit'. Only profit is real earnings.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A lemonade stand takes RM30 in sales — sounds great. But lemons, cups, and sugar cost RM22. Real profit: RM8. The RM30 was never the real number.

3 APPLY IT

Think of your Q1 venture (or a realistic one). Write down the revenue — all the money that came in.

4 REFLECT

Before counting costs, how much did you *feel* you made? Hold that number — it might change.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Explain 'revenue vs profit' to a parent in your own words and check you've got it right.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach a friend why 'I sold RM50!' doesn't mean 'I made RM50'.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The numbers are yours to gather from your real venture — a computer doesn't know what you actually sold. Do the counting yourself.

You'll need: Revenue tracking card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Revenue is listed and the child can define revenue vs profit.

2 Count your costs

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Costs are everything that went in: materials, packaging, even a share of things you reused. Beginners forget the small costs and think they made more than they did. A real count includes all of it.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

For the bracelets: beads RM15, string RM3, little bags RM2. That's RM20 of costs — easy to forget the string and bags and overcount your profit by RM5.

3 APPLY IT

List every cost that went into your venture — the obvious ones and the easy-to-forget small ones. Add them up.

4 REFLECT

Which cost did you almost forget? Those hidden costs are exactly what trip people up.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your cost list to a parent and ask what you might have missed.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show someone how forgetting a small cost makes you think you made more than you did.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You might ask AI to help you think of cost categories you forgot — a fair prompt. But the real amounts come from your real venture.

You'll need: Cost checklist

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A full cost list (including small/hidden costs) is totalled.

Unlocks after: Money in isn't money made

3 Work out your profit

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Now the moment of truth: profit = revenue − costs. This one subtraction tells you whether your venture actually made money. Sometimes the answer is a happy surprise; sometimes it's a useful shock.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Revenue RM30, costs RM20, profit RM10. Or maybe revenue RM30, costs RM32 — a loss of RM2! Either way, now you *know*, instead of guessing.

3 APPLY IT

Subtract your total costs from your revenue. Write down your real profit (or loss).

4 REFLECT

Was your real profit higher or lower than you felt in lesson 1? What surprised you?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your full calculation to a parent and check the maths is right.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through the profit = revenue − costs calculation with your real numbers.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Do this subtraction yourself — it's simple and it's *your* money. Understanding your own number matters more than any tool doing it for you.

You'll need: Profit calculation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Profit (or loss) is correctly calculated from real numbers.

Unlocks after: Count your costs

4 What does it mean?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

A profit number is only useful if you act on it. Low or negative profit? You have three real levers: raise the price, cut a cost, or change what you make. Deciding which to pull is real business thinking.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Profit was only RM2 per bracelet. Options: raise price from RM5 to RM7, find cheaper beads, or make a fancier bracelet people happily pay more for. You pick the lever that fits.

3 APPLY IT

Based on your profit, choose one lever — raise price, cut a cost, or change the product — and write why.

4 REFLECT

Which lever felt right for your venture? What would you expect it to do to your profit?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Talk your chosen lever over with a parent or mentor. Would they pull the same one?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the three levers for improving profit and when to use each.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you think through options, but the decision depends on your real venture and your judgement — you're the one who knows your customers and your costs.

You’ll need: Profit-lever decision card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One improvement lever is chosen based on the real profit.
☐ The child can explain why that lever fits their venture.

Unlocks after: Work out your profit

CREATE WEALTH · Q3

Get Customers

cw-11-12-q3 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 11–12, children can grasp that a venture has to reach people who don't already know them — the basics of marketing: who exactly is your customer, where are they, what's your message, and does one real attempt to reach them work. This steps up from selling to friends and family, and prepares them to bring real customers to the year-end launch. Keep every channel safe and adult-approved.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is reaching new people who become real customers — growing a venture beyond the people who already love you. It's the discovery that a good thing doesn't sell itself; you have to reach the right people with the right message.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child tries to win a customer who isn't a friend or relative — a real stranger choosing their thing because the message reached them. That first 'cold' yes is a genuine thrill and a real stake, and the feedback loop (did the message work?) makes marketing feel like a solvable puzzle rather than luck.

THE ARTIFACT

A simple marketing plan tried for real: a defined customer, a chosen channel, a clear message, and the recorded result of one real attempt to reach new people.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child defined a specific customer rather than 'everyone'.
- They wrote a clear message/offer and chose one safe channel to try it.
- They made one real attempt to reach new people and recorded what happened.

Unlocks after: Did You Actually Make Money?

1 Who exactly is your customer?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

'Everyone' is not a customer. The clearer you are about *who* your thing is for, the easier it is to reach them and speak to them. A specific customer is a marketing superpower.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Bookmarks for everyone' is hard to sell. 'Cute bookmarks for kids in my school who love reading' tells you exactly who to reach and what to say. Specific wins.

3 APPLY IT

Describe your ideal customer in one specific sentence — age, interest, what they'd want it for.

4 REFLECT

Is your customer specific enough that you could picture three real people who fit? If not, narrow it.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Run your customer description past a parent — is it specific or still too broad?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend why 'everyone' is a weak answer to 'who's your customer?'

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

You know your real community and who'd want your thing — that's yours to define. AI guessing 'your customer' can't match your on-the-ground knowledge.

You'll need: Customer-definition card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A specific customer is defined in one sentence.

2 Where are they, and what's your message?

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

To reach your customer you need two things: a channel (where they'll see you — a noticeboard, a family group, a safe class chat) and a clear message (why they'd want your thing, in a line or two). Right place plus right words equals reach.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Channel: the class reading-club board. Message: 'Handmade bookmarks that keep your page and look great — RM2, from a fellow book-lover.' It reaches the right people with the right pitch.

3 APPLY IT

Pick one safe, adult-approved channel where your customer will see you, and write a clear one- or two-line message.

4 REFLECT

Does your message speak to what your specific customer cares about? Generic messages get ignored.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your channel and message to a parent for approval and a clarity check.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why the right channel matters as much as the right message.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you polish your message wording. But keep it honest and true to your thing — and a grown-up must approve any channel where you'll post publicly.

You'll need: Channel + message worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A safe channel and a clear message are chosen and approved.

Unlocks after: Who exactly is your customer?

3 Try one channel for real

~25 min

1 CONCEPT

Now actually do it — post the message, put up the flyer, make the announcement (safely, with adult okay). One real attempt teaches you more than endless planning. You're finding out if your message reaches real new people.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

You put your approved bookmark message on the reading-club board with a few samples. Now you wait and watch — do new people, not just friends, come and ask?

3 APPLY IT

Make one real, adult-approved attempt to reach new customers through your channel. Then watch for responses.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to put your thing out to people who don't know you? A bit nervous is normal and good.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Check in with a parent about how the attempt went and whether it was safe and appropriate.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone about your real marketing attempt and what you did.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The real-world attempt is yours to make (with adult approval) — no tool can reach your real community for you. This is real action, not a simulation.

You'll need: Attempt log

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ One real, safe attempt to reach new customers was made.

Unlocks after: Where are they, and what's your message?

4 Did it work?

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Measure the result: how many new people noticed, asked, or bought? Whatever the number, it's data. If it worked, do more of it. If not, change the message or the channel — that's marketing, a loop of try, measure, adjust.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Three new people asked and one bought — so the board works, but maybe the price note wasn't clear. Next time you make the price bigger. The result told you exactly what to tweak.

3 APPLY IT

Count the response to your attempt. Write down one thing that worked and one thing to change next time.

4 REFLECT

What did this real attempt teach you that guessing never could? Marketing is learned by trying.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Share your result and your next-time change with a parent or mentor.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the marketing loop: define customer, pick channel, try, measure, adjust.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Judge your real results honestly — a small real response beats an imagined big one. Trust what actually happened over any optimistic guess.

You’ll need: Result + adjust card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The result of the attempt was measured.
☐ One thing that worked and one change for next time were identified.

Unlocks after: Try one channel for real

CREATE WEALTH · Q4

Run the Launch

cw-11-12-q4 · supporting: Communicate, Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

In the capstone, Wealth runs the live launch. At 11–12 a child can bring together pricing (Q1), profit (Q2), and getting customers (Q3) in one real event: set the price, sell to real people including new ones, track the full revenue-cost-profit picture, and measure against the goal. As the final project of the young cohort, it closes with a reflection on the whole two-year journey from 'make and share' to 'run a launch'.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

Value here is running a genuine launch — hitting the goal (or learning exactly why not) and knowing the real profit. It's the complete wealth arc made real: price, sell, reach new customers, and read the true numbers, all in one day that the whole two years built toward.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The child runs a real launch with real customers, real money, and a real goal to hit. The stakes are exciting and safe: an actual till, actual new customers won by their promotion, an actual profit to calculate. Nothing makes two years of wealth lessons click like a live launch with a scoreboard at the end.

THE ARTIFACT

The launch run with real sales (including new customers), a full revenue-cost-profit calculation measured against the goal, and a written reflection on the two-year journey.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child set a price and ran a real launch to real customers.
- They tracked revenue, costs, and profit, and compared the result to their goal.
- They reflected on their growth across the whole 9–12 journey.

Unlocks after: Get Customers, Plan the Launch

1 Set price and confirm the goal

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

Set your launch price using everything you know — it must cover costs and leave real profit (Q2), while staying fair to customers (Q1). Then confirm your measurable goal so you'll know, by day's end, whether you hit it.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Snacks cost RM0.80 each to make; you price at RM2, leaving RM1.20 profit each. Goal: 10 sold = RM12 profit. Price set, goal locked, scoreboard ready.

3 APPLY IT

Set your final price (covering costs plus profit) and write your target number for the day.

4 REFLECT

Does your price leave real profit after all costs? Recheck against your Q2 profit thinking.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Confirm your price and goal with a parent or mentor before launch.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone how you set a price that's both fair and profitable.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Your price rests on your real costs and customers — your judgement. Do the profit maths yourself so you truly own the number.

You'll need: Price + goal confirmation card

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A profitable, fair price and a target number are set.

2 Run the launch

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Launch day: sell to real customers, including new ones your promotion brought in. Be friendly, deliver your pitch, handle money carefully, and give every customer the quality you promised. This is the whole venture, live.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Customers arrive — some friends, some strangers who saw your promo. You pitch, they buy, you hand over the product and the change. A real business, running, with you at the helm.

3 APPLY IT

Run your launch: sell to real customers, use your pitch, and handle the money carefully (with adult support).

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to sell to strangers, not just friends? What was harder or easier than expected?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Notice which customers came from your promotion versus who you already knew. That tells you if marketing worked.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of a sale to a brand-new customer at your launch.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Running a real launch with real customers and money is fully human and needs adult support for safety. This is your moment — no tool runs it for you.

You'll need: Money float · Sales record sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The launch was run and sales made to real customers, including new ones.

Unlocks after: Set price and confirm the goal

3 Track revenue, costs, and profit

~20 min

1 CONCEPT

After the launch, do the full picture: total revenue in, all costs out, and real profit (revenue − costs). This is the true scoreboard of your launch — the honest number behind the busy, fun day.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Revenue: 11 sold at RM2 = RM22. Costs: RM9 of ingredients and packaging. Real profit: RM13. Now you know exactly how the launch really did.

3 APPLY IT

Calculate your launch's total revenue, total costs, and real profit.

4 REFLECT

Was the real profit more or less than it felt like during the busy day? The numbers tell the truth.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your full revenue-cost-profit calculation to a parent and check the maths.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk someone through your launch's real profit using your numbers.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Do your own launch maths — understanding your real numbers is the whole wealth skill. A tool doing it for you skips the learning.

You'll need: Launch P&L sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Real revenue, costs, and profit for the launch are correctly calculated.

Unlocks after: Run the launch

4 Did you hit the goal? And look back

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Compare your result to your goal — hit, missed, or beat it, each teaches something. Then look back across two whole years: from making and sharing at 9, to researching, building for strangers, and running a real launch now. That's a remarkable distance.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Goal was RM12 profit; you made RM13 — beaten! And two years ago you were nervously offering a bookmark to a neighbour. Now you research, build, pitch, and launch. That growth is the real prize.

3 APPLY IT

Compare your profit to your goal and note why. Then write your proudest moment and biggest lesson from the whole 9–12 journey.

4 REFLECT

Across two years — thinking, communicating, building, creating value — what changed most in what you can do and dare to try?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Sit with a parent or mentor and share your goal result and your two-year reflection.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of your whole journey, ending with launch day.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Whether you hit the goal, and what you're proud of, are honestly yours to judge and tell. This is your journey — own it in your own words.

You'll need: Goal-vs-result card · Two-year reflection sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The result was compared to the goal with a reason.
☐ The child reflected on their growth across the whole 9–12 journey.

Unlocks after: Track revenue, costs, and profit

Ages 13-14

THINK · Q1

A Case for a Change

th-13-14-q1 · supporting: Communicate

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, abstract reasoning is genuinely coming online: a teen can hold a hypothetical, argue a position they don't hold, and reason about their own reasoning — but unevenly, and with a catch: their ego is now fused to their opinions, so being wrong feels like a status injury. They crave being taken seriously by adults and can detect adult inauthenticity instantly. They can sustain a multi-week project if the payoff is visible and the stakes are theirs. The capability to separate a claim from the person making it exists at this age — but only if it's exercised deliberately.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At 13–14, 'creating value' with your thinking means **being taken seriously enough that a real decision changes**. Not winning a debate trophy — earning a real concession from the adult world because your case was genuinely good. The currency is trust and expanded autonomy, which is exactly what a 13-year-old wants most and can now legitimately earn.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The quarter's artifact is a written case for a real change the teen actually wants — a later curfew, a new privilege, a purchase, a change to a family or school rule — argued in person to the person who can actually grant it, with an agreement up front that the decision will be made on the strength of the case. The stakes are the teen's own autonomy: the single most motivating currency at this age. No adult needs to nag; wanting the change does the work.

THE ARTIFACT

A one-page written case brief for a real change the teen wants — the claim, evidence with fair baselines, the strongest version of the opposing side with their answer to it, and a small testable ask — argued in person to the real decision-maker, with the verdict and its reasons recorded at the bottom.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A one-page written case exists containing a claim, compared-to-what evidence, a steelman of the other side, and a small testable ask.
- The decision-maker confirmed, out loud, that the written steelman states their real concerns fairly.
- The case was presented in person and a real decision — yes, no, or trial — was received with reasons.
- The teen can name what evidence would change their own mind.

1 Claim or evidence?

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

A claim is what someone *says* is true. Evidence is what they can *show*. Most arguments — including yours — fail because the two get blended. The first move of a strong thinker is the split: what exactly is being claimed, what has actually been shown, and how big is the gap between them.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Everyone in my year has a phone' is a claim. A count of your actual class — 19 of 27 own one — is evidence. Ads and headlines are usually claims wearing evidence costumes: 'studies show' with no study named is still just a claim in a lab coat.

3 APPLY IT

Choose the real change you'll argue for this quarter and write your main claim in one sentence. Then split everything you'd say for it into two columns: what you can currently SHOW versus what you're merely SAYING. The 'saying' column is your evidence-hunting to-do list.

4 REFLECT

Which items in your 'show' column turned out to be just claims when you looked hard at them? Why did they *feel* like evidence?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your two columns to an adult and ask them to attack your weakest piece of evidence. Note which one fell first — that's where your case needs work.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Take one headline or ad this week and teach the split to a family member: what's claimed, what's shown, what's the gap. Then have them do the next one on their own while you coach.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

Do the split with your own head first — the split IS the skill, and outsourcing it trains nothing. Afterwards, AI is useful for *hunting* evidence to fill your gaps. But treat every number and fact it gives you as a claim until you've seen the source yourself: AI is a fast librarian, not a witness.

You'll need: Claim/evidence split sheet (show vs. say columns)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The chosen change is written as a one-sentence claim.
☐ A written show-vs-say split exists with at least three real evidence gaps identified.

2 Find the hidden assumption

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Every argument stands on things nobody said out loud. 'I should get a later curfew because I'm 13 now' silently assumes that age alone earns trust. Find the load-bearing assumption and you know exactly where an argument will crack — including your own.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A shop sign says '9 out of 10 customers recommend us.' Hidden assumption: the ten people asked were typical customers — maybe they only asked the happy ones. Companies, politicians, and teenagers all lean on hidden assumptions; the person who can *name* them controls the conversation.

3 APPLY IT

Write your case's core argument in two or three sentences. Then list every assumption it needs to be true — aim for at least three. Mark the load-bearing one: the assumption that, if false, kills the whole case. Write one line on how you'll support it.

4 REFLECT

Which assumption was hardest to spot? What does that suggest about the assumptions hiding in arguments you already *agree* with?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Without showing your list, ask your decision-maker what they think your argument assumes. Compare their list with yours — theirs is a preview of the objections your case will face.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach a friend or sibling the assumption hunt using an ad or a school rule: have them find what it silently assumes, and don't help until they've found at least one alone.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

List your assumptions unaided first. *Then*, if you like, ask an AI to list the assumptions in your argument and compare — if it found one you missed, ask yourself why you missed it. Never run it the other way round: reading the machine's list first blinds you to your own blind spots, and spotting your own is the entire skill.

You'll need: Assumption-hunt worksheet (argument + 3 assumptions + load-bearing mark)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The case's argument is written with at least three named assumptions.
☐ The load-bearing assumption is marked with a plan to support it.

Unlocks after: Claim or evidence?

3 Compared to what?

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

A number on its own is a mood; a comparison is information. 'I'm on my phone three hours a day' — is that a lot? Compared to your classmates? To last year? To time spent on homework? Strong thinkers refuse naked numbers: they always demand the baseline.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A game boasts 'over 1 million downloads!' Compared to what? The biggest games have hundreds of millions, so a million might mean tiny. '50% more effective!' — than what, than doing nothing? The comparison carries the meaning; the number is just decoration.

3 APPLY IT

Find the two or three numbers your case actually turns on (sleep, screen time, cost, marks — whatever your change touches). For each, find a *fair* baseline and rewrite the naked number as a comparison sentence for your brief.

4 REFLECT

Did any honest comparison turn out to hurt your case? What's the stronger move — hiding it, or addressing it head-on before the decision-maker finds it themselves?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your comparison sentences to someone good with numbers and ask one question: is each baseline fair, or did I pick the one that flatters me?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Next time someone quotes a number at dinner or in the group chat, ask 'compared to what?' out loud — then walk them through how the baseline changes what the number means.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a genuinely good AI use: finding baselines fast ('what's the average screen time for 13-year-olds?'). But a confident number without a source is a rumor. Get the source, check it exists, and check it says what the AI said it says. If you can't verify it, it doesn't go in your brief — one fake number and your whole case loses its credibility.

You'll need: Compared-to-what table (number / baseline / comparison sentence)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Every number in the case is written as a comparison against a named, checkable baseline.
☐ At least one comparison that does not flatter the case is included and addressed.

Unlocks after: Find the hidden assumption

4 Steelman the other side

~45 min

1 CONCEPT

A strawman is the weakest version of the other side; a steelman is the strongest. Beating a strawman convinces nobody — least of all your parents. If you can state their side so well they say 'yes, that's exactly my worry', you've earned the right to answer it. That's the move that changes minds.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Lawyers prepare the other side's case before their own. Chess players study the opponent's *best* move, not the worst one. The teen who opens with 'here's the strongest reason you'd say no — and here's my answer to it' sounds ten years older than the one who pretends there's no reason at all.

3 APPLY IT

Write the case *against* your change as if you believed it: the real worries — safety, sleep, cost, trust — at full strength, about half a page. Then write your honest answer to its single strongest point.

4 REFLECT

While writing the other side, did any of their points start to feel… right? What did that do to your own case — weaken it, or make it more honest?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Read *only* the steelman to your decision-maker and ask: did I miss a reason, or state one too weakly? Revise until they say 'that's fair' out loud. That sentence is your green light.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Find a disagreement a friend is stuck in and coach them to state the other person's side at full strength before responding. Watch what it does to the temperature of the argument — then explain to them why it works.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

First draft unaided: if you can't voice the other side without a screen, you don't understand it yet. *After* that, AI makes an excellent sparring partner — 'argue against my case as hard as you can' — to find angles you missed. Use it to pressure-test your steelman, never to outsource the understanding itself.

You'll need: Steelman worksheet (their side at full strength / your answer)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A written steelman of about half a page exists, plus an answer to its strongest point.
☐ The decision-maker said 'that's fair' (or equivalent) to the steelman after revision.

Unlocks after: Compared to what?

5 Make the case — for real

~60 min

1 CONCEPT

Thinking that never meets a decision is just practice; thinking that gets a verdict is real. Assemble the one-page brief: claim, evidence with baselines, the steelman and your answer, and — the closer — a *small, testable ask*: not 'forever', but 'a three-week trial with a review'. Small reversible asks are how good cases win.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

In real companies, big changes get pitched as small experiments: 'try it for a month, measure, then decide.' A trial with a review date is far easier to grant than a permanent change — and if your case is good, the trial itself does the rest of the arguing for you.

3 APPLY IT

Assemble your one-page case brief from lessons 1–4 and present it in person. Propose the trial version of your ask. Get an actual decision — yes, no, or trial — and write their reasons at the bottom of the brief.

4 REFLECT

Whatever the verdict: which part of your case did the most work, and which did nothing? And the thinker's question — what evidence would change *your* mind about your own ask?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Debrief the decision-maker afterwards: what nearly changed their mind, and what actually did (or would have)? Add their answer to the brief as a note to your future self.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach the whole method — claim, evidence, assumptions, compared-to-what, steelman, small ask — to a friend who wants something from *their* parents, and help them draft their own one-pager. If your friend's case wins, you've really learned it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The brief must be in your own words — a parent can smell generated text a mile away, and it costs you the exact trust you're trying to earn. The legitimate use: hand AI your *finished* draft and ask 'what's the weakest point in this case?' — then fix it yourself. If AI writes the case, you didn't make it; you just delivered someone else's.

You'll need: One-page case brief template (claim / evidence / steelman / ask / verdict)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A completed one-page brief exists and was presented in person.
☐ A real decision with stated reasons is recorded on the brief.

Unlocks after: Steelman the other side

THINK · Q2

The Decision Journal

th-13-14-q2 · supporting: Live Well

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, teens start making decisions with real consequences — how to spend money they earned, which commitments to take on, what to quit — but their forecasting is untrained: they overweight the vivid outcome, underweight the likely one, and rarely notice the option they didn't consider. The equipment for better deciding is present: they can hold multiple hypotheticals, imagine futures, and reflect on their own past calls. What's missing is a *practice* — and this is the age where one can be installed.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At 13–14, thinking creates value when it produces **decisions the teen can stand behind** — made with named options, honest odds, and a written prediction that reality later gets to grade. The value isn't being right every time; it's becoming someone whose calls visibly improve, which is what earns a teen bigger decisions to make.

MOTIVATION LEVER — AUTONOMY

The whole quarter runs on the teen's own real decisions — what to buy, join, quit, or build — not exercises. The deal that powers it: decisions worked through the journal are the teen's to make. Owning real calls, and getting visibly better at them, is the autonomy a 13-year-old is negotiating for everywhere; here it's the explicit reward for thinking well.

THE ARTIFACT

A decision journal containing at least five real decisions, each with named options, a one-way/two-way door label, best/worst/likely outcomes, the opportunity cost, and a written prediction — plus review entries where at least two predictions were graded against what actually happened.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The journal contains five real decisions with options, door type, outcomes, and predictions written before deciding.
- At least two decisions were reviewed later, with the prediction honestly graded against reality.
- The teen can explain one thing their reviews taught them about their own predicting.

Unlocks after: A Case for a Change

1 Name your real options

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Most bad decisions aren't bad choices between options — they're choices made before all the options were on the table. There are almost always more than two, and one is invisible: *do nothing*, which is also a choice. The first move: list at least three real options, including the default you'd drift into.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Should I buy the new console or not?' feels like two options. Written out, it's at least five: buy now, wait for the price drop, buy used, put the money toward something else entirely, or do nothing and keep saving. The best option is often one that wasn't in the original question.

3 APPLY IT

Start your decision journal. Take one real decision you're facing now and write at least three genuine options — including the do-nothing default. Star any option you hadn't consciously considered before writing.

4 REFLECT

Was the option you were leaning toward before the list still the best one after it? What does that tell you about deciding inside your head versus on paper?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your option list to someone who knows the situation and ask: 'what option am I missing?' Add whatever they find — the exercise works even when their option is bad, because now you chose against it consciously.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Next time a friend says 'should I do X or not?', teach them the three-options rule and help them find the hidden third option. Watch how often it changes the decision.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Write your own option list first — noticing options is the muscle. *Then* AI is a fair prompt-partner: 'what options might someone be missing here?' If it surfaces one you missed, add it and note that you missed it — that's calibration data about your own blind spots. What AI must never do is pick for you: the choosing is the entire point.

You'll need: Decision journal template (options / door / outcomes / prediction / review)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A journal entry exists with three or more real options including the do-nothing default.
☐ One option was added or starred that wasn't considered before writing.

2 One-way doors and two-way doors

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Some decisions are two-way doors — walk through, dislike it, walk back (join a club, try a price, change a hairstyle). Some are one-way — hard or impossible to undo (quit the team mid-season, post something public, spend all your savings). The rule that saves years: decide *fast* on two-way doors and *slow* on one-way doors. Most people do the opposite.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Agonising for three weeks over which free app to try is slow-deciding a two-way door — you could have tried all three in an afternoon. Impulse-posting an angry message in the group chat is fast-deciding a one-way door: the delete button doesn't unsend what forty people saw.

3 APPLY IT

Label every decision currently in your journal as a one-way or two-way door, with one line on why. Then add one real decision you've been overthinking: if it's a two-way door, decide it *today* and write down what walking it back would cost if you're wrong.

4 REFLECT

Which do you naturally do — agonise over reversible things, or rush irreversible ones? What's one one-way door you walked through this year without noticing it was one?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a parent about a one-way door they rushed and a two-way door they overthought. Compare their patterns with yours — the mislabeling habit runs in families.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach the door test to a sibling or friend with a decision on their plate: have them label it, then apply the rule — fast if two-way, slow if one-way. Make sure they can explain *why* the speed should differ.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The door label is a judgment about *your* life — how reversible something is depends on your money, your school, your family — so label it yourself. One good AI use: for a one-way door, ask 'what would make this harder to reverse than it looks?' Hidden one-way-ness is exactly the thing worth a second set of eyes. For two-way doors, skip the AI entirely: just decide.

You'll need: Door-label column in the journal

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Every journal entry carries a door label with a reason.
☐ One overthought two-way door was decided the same day.

Unlocks after: Name your real options

3 Best case, worst case, likely case

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Untrained deciding runs on the most *vivid* outcome — the daydream or the disaster. Trained deciding writes three: best case, worst case, and the boring likely case. Then it asks the two questions that matter: can I live with the worst case, and am I choosing based on the likely one — or just the shiniest one?

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Spending your savings on concert tickets to resell: best case, double your money. Worst case, the show flops and you lose most of it. Likely case, you make a little after fees and stress. The daydream sells the plan; the likely case is what you'll actually get — and the worst case is what you have to be able to afford.

3 APPLY IT

For two live decisions in your journal, write all three cases, then mark how likely each feels (a rough percentage is fine). Answer in writing: can I live with the worst case? Am I deciding on the likely case or the best case?

4 REFLECT

For which decision were the best case and the likely case furthest apart? What was making the best case feel more real than it deserved?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three cases to someone with more experience of that kind of decision. Ask one question: 'is my likely case actually likely?' Adjust, and note how far off you were.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

When someone near you is excited about a plan, ask them for their three cases out loud — kindly. Teach them the 'can you live with the worst case?' question and watch it either sober the plan or strengthen it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Write your three cases and your percentages *before* asking anything — your untrained guess is the thing being trained. Then AI is a decent reality-checker: 'what do people usually underestimate about doing X?' If its answer moves your likely case, move it — but the percentages stay yours, because in the review lesson it's *your* calibration being graded, and borrowed numbers grade nothing.

You'll need: Three-cases section in the journal

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Two decisions have written best/worst/likely cases with rough likelihoods.
☐ The 'can I live with the worst case?' question is answered in writing for both.

Unlocks after: One-way doors and two-way doors

4 Every yes is a no

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Every choice spends something — money, time, energy — that can't also be spent elsewhere. The real cost of a decision isn't its price tag; it's the *best thing you gave up* to make it. Thinkers call it opportunity cost. Until you can name what your yes is saying no to, you don't know what the decision costs.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Saying yes to a Saturday job pays RM40 a week. It also says no to the Saturday football league — and if football is where your closest friends are, the job's real price includes that. It might still be worth it. But 'worth it compared to *what*' is the only honest version of the question.

3 APPLY IT

For each live decision in your journal, add a line: 'this yes is a no to ___' — the best real alternative use of the same time or money. If you can't name one, look harder: the no is always there.

4 REFLECT

Which of your yeses had the most expensive hidden no? Have you ever made a choice that felt free but quietly cost you something you cared about?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Trade journals (or just one decision) with a friend doing the same exercise, and try to spot each other's hidden nos. Other people see your trade-offs more clearly than you do.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain opportunity cost to a younger sibling using their pocket money: the sweets they buy are also the game they're not saving for. Keep going until they can produce their own example.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Naming what *you'd* otherwise do with the time or money requires knowing your own life — that part can't be delegated. Where AI helps is completeness: 'what do people typically give up when they take on X?' can surface a category you forgot (sleep is the classic). Take the category; fill in the specifics yourself.

You'll need: 'This yes is a no to' column in the journal

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Every live decision in the journal names its opportunity cost.
☐ The teen can say aloud which yes had the most expensive hidden no.

Unlocks after: Best case, worst case, likely case

5 Predict, decide, review

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Here's what separates people who get better at deciding from people who just get older: they write the prediction down *before* deciding, and they come back and grade it. Memory rewrites history — 'I knew it all along' — but the journal doesn't. Predict, decide, review. Run that loop for a year and your judgment compounds like savings.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Poker players and fund managers keep decision journals for exactly this reason: they can't trust their memory of what they believed before the outcome. One teen's review showed she rated things '90% sure' that happened about half the time — one page of reviews taught her more about her own overconfidence than a year of being told.

3 APPLY IT

Finish the loop: make sure all five decisions carry written predictions, then review at least two whose outcomes have arrived. Grade each honestly — what did I predict, what happened, what did I miss — and write one sentence on the pattern your misses share.

4 REFLECT

Were your predictions too confident, too timid, or blind in one particular direction? What will you check for in your *next* decision because of what the reviews showed?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Walk your decision-maker (a parent works well) through one full journal entry — options, door, cases, cost, prediction, review. Ask them: 'based on this, is there a decision you'd now trust me to make alone?' That answer is the quarter's real payoff.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Set up a decision journal for a friend or sibling: template, first entry, and a review date in their calendar. Teach them the line 'memory rewrites history; the journal doesn't' — if they're still reviewing a month later, you taught it well.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The predictions and the grading must be yours — calibration is a measurement of *your* head, and letting AI write either side breaks the instrument. After several reviews, one genuinely good use: paste in your misses (just the predictions and outcomes) and ask 'what pattern do you see?' A pattern-spotter on your own honest data is AI at its best; a ghost-writer for your judgment is AI at its worst.

You'll need: Review pages in the journal + a calendar reminder for review dates

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Five decisions carry pre-decision predictions; at least two are reviewed and graded.
☐ One written sentence names the pattern in the teen's prediction misses.

Unlocks after: Every yes is a no

COMMUNICATE · Q1

Publish Something Worth Reading

co-13-14-q1 · supporting: Create

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14 the 'imaginary audience' is at full volume — teens feel watched and judged constantly, which makes publishing feel enormous, but it also means they finally *care* about audience reaction enough to revise. They can now hold a draft–edit–redraft loop across weeks, take critique of their work (if it's clearly not critique of them), and write with an authentic voice adults can't fake. What they can't yet do is judge their own writing cold — they need real reader reactions, not a grade.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when **strangers choose to spend their attention on your words** — not politeness-reads from family. Publishing one piece that real, unobligated readers actually finish is the first time a teen's words are judged purely on whether they're worth reading. That's a different act from writing for a teacher, and it's the one that matters.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL AUDIENCE

The piece is written for — and published in — a place where its real audience already gathers: the school paper or newsletter, a club or team chat, a community noticeboard, a blog shared where their people are. Real readers, reacting honestly and voluntarily, are the payoff. The teen watches actual humans respond to their words, which no grade or parental praise can substitute for.

THE ARTIFACT

One published piece (roughly 400–700 words, or the equivalent as a recorded script) on a topic the teen genuinely knows, published where its intended audience actually gathers — plus the first draft kept alongside the final to show the cuts, and a record of real reader responses.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The piece is published somewhere its intended audience actually gathers, not just shown to family.
- The teen can state the one idea of the piece in a single sentence.
- The final draft is visibly shorter and sharper than the first draft, and both exist to compare.
- At least three genuine responses from readers outside the family are recorded.

1 One idea, one reader

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Writing aimed at 'everyone' reads like it was written for no one. A piece works when one specific kind of reader feels it was written *for them* — and when it carries exactly one idea. Two ideas make two weak pieces wearing one title.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Ten tips for better gaming' vanishes into the noise. 'What I learned coming back after my account got hacked — written for players who think it can't happen to them' gets read, because a real reader recognises themselves in it and one clear idea pulls them through.

3 APPLY IT

Pick a topic you actually know from experience — not one you'd have to research from zero. Write your one idea in a single sentence, and describe your one reader in a phrase ('year 8s who skip breakfast', 'players in my league who rage-quit'). Everything you draft later must serve those two lines.

4 REFLECT

Is your one idea something your reader hasn't already heard ten times? If it's what everyone says, what do *you* know that changes it?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Say your idea sentence to one person who fits your reader description. Watch their face: interest or politeness? Ask which — and note what they say.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain the 'one idea, one reader' rule to a friend who has to write something for school, and help them boil their piece down to the two lines.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The idea must come from what *you* know — an AI's take on any topic is the average take, and average is invisible. One sharp use: ask AI 'what would most people say about this topic?' so you know exactly what NOT to write. If your idea matches the machine's list, dig deeper into your own experience until it doesn't.

You'll need: One-idea/one-reader card (two lines, kept visible while drafting)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A one-sentence idea and a one-phrase reader description are written down.
☐ One real target reader reacted to the idea and their reaction is noted.

2 Earn the first ten seconds

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

A stranger gives your piece about ten seconds before deciding to stay or scroll. The opening has to earn the rest — with a real question, a surprising fact, or the moment the story starts. One rule: the piece must pay off whatever the opening promises. A hook the piece can't cash is clickbait, and readers never forgive it twice.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Cyberbullying is a serious problem in today's society' loses the reader at 'society'. 'The message arrived at 11:43pm, and it was from my best friend' — same topic, but now you have to know what happened. Both openings are honest; only one earns the next paragraph.

3 APPLY IT

Write five different openings for your piece — a question, a moment, a surprising fact, a bold claim, and one wild card. Read each aloud. Pick the one that pulls hardest *and* that your piece can genuinely pay off.

4 REFLECT

Which opening was easiest to write, and which actually works best? Why are those usually not the same one?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show just your top two openings to someone in your reader group and ask: which one would make you keep reading — and would you feel cheated if the piece didn't deliver on it?

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Collect three openings from things you read this week — one great, one boring, one clickbait — and teach someone the difference, using the 'can it pay it off?' test.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draft your five openings yourself first — generating hooks is exactly the muscle this lesson trains. Afterwards, AI can pitch alternatives to react against; steal a *shape* if it helps, never a whole line. And reject any AI hook your piece can't pay off: borrowed clickbait spends your reader's trust, and you're the one who loses it.

You'll need: Five-openings worksheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Five distinct openings exist and one is chosen with a reason.
☐ A target reader picked between the top two and their choice is noted.

Unlocks after: One idea, one reader

3 Draft it, then cut it in half

~45 min

1 CONCEPT

First drafts are for finding what you mean; editing is where writing gets good. Nearly every first draft is a third too long — warm-up sentences, repeated points, words doing nothing. Cutting feels like losing work. It isn't. It's the work.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Due to the fact that many students find it quite difficult to wake up early in the morning' — cut to 'Most students hate early mornings' and nothing is lost except fog. Professional writers routinely cut their favourite sentences; they call it 'killing your darlings' because it hurts and it works.

3 APPLY IT

Write the full first draft in one sitting — messy is fine, just get to the end. Then make a copy and cut it by at least a third: warm-ups, repeats, every word not carrying weight. Keep both versions; the before/after is part of your artifact.

4 REFLECT

Read the two versions aloud. What did the piece *gain* by losing a third of its words? Which cut hurt most — and was the piece worse without it, honestly?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Give someone both versions without saying which is which. Ask which they'd rather keep reading and why. If they pick the long one, find out what the cut version lost.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Take a paragraph a friend or sibling wrote (with permission), and edit it together — teach them to hunt warm-up sentences and dead words. Cutting someone else's fog trains your eye for your own.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The draft must be yours — drafting is where you find what you actually think, and skipping it means publishing without ever thinking. For editing, one sharp AI use: 'what could be cut from this without losing the idea?' — then decide line by line yourself. Never 'rewrite this better': the voice stops being yours, and your reader can tell in one paragraph.

You'll need: Draft + cut-pass checklist (warm-ups, repeats, dead words)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A complete first draft exists.
☐ A cut version at least a third shorter exists alongside it.

Unlocks after: Earn the first ten seconds

4 Test it on real readers

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

You can't judge your own writing cold — you know what you *meant*, so your brain fills every gap. Real readers don't have that help. Watching where an actual reader slows down, skims, or stops tells you more than any opinion about whether it's 'good'.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A writer watches someone read their piece and sees them skim the third paragraph — the one the writer worked hardest on. The reader can't even say why. That skim is data no compliment can give: the paragraph is doing less than it costs.

3 APPLY IT

Give the piece to two or three people from your reader group. Watch them read if you can. Then ask exactly one question: 'where did you lose interest, even a little?' Revise the piece based on what they showed you — not just what they said.

4 REFLECT

Did their stumbling points surprise you? What does the gap between what you meant and what they read tell you about writing for strangers?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show one reader the before/after of your revision and ask if the fix worked. A reader confirming the fix is your sign-off to publish.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Offer the same service to a friend: watch them read *your* method — one reader, one question, revise from the stumble. Then watch a reader read their piece and hand them what you observed.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI cannot lose interest — it reads everything with infinite patience, which makes it useless for this lesson's question. Simulated 'reader feedback' from a model is practice at best. The one thing that counts here is a real human's attention faltering in front of you. Save AI for after: it can help you tighten the paragraph your real reader stumbled on.

You'll need: Reader-test sheet (reader / where they slowed / what changed)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ At least two target readers read the piece and their lose-interest points are recorded.
☐ The piece was revised and one reader confirmed the revision works.

Unlocks after: Draft it, then cut it in half

5 Publish where they already are

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

A piece nobody can find isn't published — it's stored. Publishing means putting it where your reader already spends attention: the school paper, the club chat, the noticeboard, the feed. And it means your name on it, in public, which is exactly why it counts.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The same piece posted on a blog nobody visits gets three views from family; pinned in the club's group chat where its actual readers live, it gets read, replied to, and argued with the same day. Placement did that, not the writing.

3 APPLY IT

List the two or three places your one reader actually gathers. Pick the best, handle its rules (ask the editor, the coach, the admin), and publish. Then collect what comes back: a simple tally of who read it and every genuine response, kept with the piece.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel the moment it went public under your name? Which response mattered most — and was it the one you expected to matter?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Debrief with one reader who responded: what made them read to the end? What would have made them share it with someone else? Note both for your next piece.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Walk a friend through the whole path — one idea, one reader, the hook, the cut, the reader test, the placement — and help them get their first piece actually published, not just written.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Never publish AI-written text under your name. Your name is the asset this whole quarter builds, and getting caught once — and readers do catch it — spends all of it. The legitimate final uses: a proofread for typos where you approve each fix, and afterwards asking 'why might this piece not have been shared?' as input for your next one. The words that carry your name must be yours.

You'll need: Publication checklist + response tally sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The piece is live in a place its intended audience actually gathers.
☐ A response record exists with at least three genuine reader responses from outside the family.

Unlocks after: Test it on real readers

COMMUNICATE · Q2

Reach Out and Interview

co-13-14-q2 · supporting: Explore

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, teens can hold a real conversation with an unfamiliar adult — ask, listen, follow up — but almost never do, because initiating contact feels socially radioactive at exactly the age when embarrassment peaks. The capability that's genuinely ready: composing a considered message, preparing questions, and listening for substance. The fear is the obstacle, not the skill — which makes this the highest-leverage quarter to install the habit, because a teen who can comfortably reach out to adults has an advantage that compounds for decades.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, communication creates value when it **opens a door that was closed** — a busy adult who owed the teen nothing gives an hour, answers honestly, and remembers them afterwards. The teen walks away with knowledge that isn't on any feed, and something rarer: proof that the adult world answers when you knock properly. That proof changes what a 13-year-old believes they're allowed to attempt.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

Getting a yes from a busy stranger, then running an interview that makes them talk for an hour, is a visible, unfakeable skill — and every rep gets measurably less scary and more smooth. The quarter is built as a ladder of reps: warm contact first, then colder, each one scored and debriefed. The pull is watching yourself get good at the thing most adults still fear.

THE ARTIFACT

Two completed interviews with adults doing work the teen finds genuinely interesting — landed through the teen's own outreach messages — plus a published write-up of what was learned (using the Q1 publishing skills) and thank-you notes actually sent.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- At least three real outreach messages were sent, and at least two interviews actually happened.
- The teen ran each interview from their own prepared questions and can retell the best thing each person said.
- A write-up of what was learned is published where others can read it, and thank-you notes were sent within two days.
- The teen can describe how outreach number three felt compared to number one.

Unlocks after: Publish Something Worth Reading

1 Who's worth an hour?

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Outreach starts with a real question, not a famous name. The best person to interview isn't the biggest name you can think of — it's someone close enough to reach who is actually *doing* a thing you want to understand: running the shop, coding the app, coaching the team, working the job you're curious about. Specific curiosity beats celebrity every time.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen curious about game design messaged a famous YouTuber (no reply, ever) and then the developer of a small indie game he liked — who replied in a day and talked for an hour. The indie dev gets ten messages a month, not ten thousand. Reachability is a feature, not a compromise.

3 APPLY IT

Write down what you genuinely want to understand — a job, a craft, a path. List three real, reachable people who are living it: one you already half-know (a coach, a family friend, a neighbour), two colder. For each, write the one thing you'd most want to ask them.

4 REFLECT

Is your list built on what *you* actually want to know, or on who would impress your friends? What would change if nobody ever saw who you interviewed?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your list to an adult who knows your world and ask two things: 'who am I missing?' and 'can you introduce me to any of these?' A warm introduction doubles your yes rate — asking for one is part of the skill.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend build their own three-person list for something *they're* curious about. Teach them the rule: reachable and real beats famous and silent.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The curiosity must be yours — AI doesn't know what pulls at you, and a borrowed question produces a dead interview. Where AI earns its keep here is research: once you've chosen your people, use it to learn what they've made and said publicly, so your questions start where their public answers end. Knowing someone's work before you knock is respect; asking what a two-minute search would answer is the opposite.

You'll need: Target list sheet (person / what they do / the one question)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three reachable people are listed with the one thing to ask each.
☐ One possible warm introduction is identified.

2 The message that gets a yes

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Busy people say yes to messages that are short, specific, and easy. The formula: who you are in one line, why *them* specifically (proof you know their work), one clear small ask (20 minutes, their choice of time), and an easy out. No flattery walls, no life story, no 'pick your brain'. And silence isn't a no — one polite follow-up a week later is normal, not desperate.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Hi, I'm Mira, 13, I run a small bracelet stall at my school market. I read that you started your bakery at 19 with RM500. Could I ask you three questions about your first year — 20 minutes, whenever suits you? Totally fine if you're too busy.' Four lines. She got a reply in two hours, because saying yes to that is *easy*.

3 APPLY IT

Draft your outreach message using the formula, out loud until it sounds like you. Send it to your warmest target today — before the nerves organise themselves. Log the send in a simple tracker: who, when, reply or silence, follow-up date.

4 REFLECT

What was the exact feeling in the ten seconds before you hit send? Now that it's sent — how big was the thing you were afraid of, really?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your draft to an adult before sending the colder two: 'would you say yes to this? what would make it easier to say yes to?' Tighten, then send both.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach the four-line formula to a friend who wants something from an adult — a trial, a signature, an interview — and stand next to them while they hit send on their first one. The standing-next-to matters.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draft the message yourself, then let AI tighten *your* draft — cutting is a thing it does well. Never let it write the message from scratch: recipients can smell template outreach instantly, and the whole message works because a real 13-year-old wrote it. Same for follow-ups — short, human, yours. One genuine use: paste in your message and ask 'what would make a busy person ignore this?'

You'll need: Outreach tracker (who / sent / reply / follow-up date)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three outreach messages in the four-line shape were actually sent.
☐ The tracker shows send dates and scheduled follow-ups.

Unlocks after: Who's worth an hour?

3 Questions that open people up

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Weak questions get facts you could have googled; strong questions get stories only this person can tell. The craft: open questions ('how did you…', 'what surprised you…') beat yes/no ones; 'tell me about the time…' beats 'do you like…'; and the best question in any interview is the follow-up — 'what happened next?', 'why was that hard?' — because it proves you're actually listening.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'Do you like being a vet?' gets 'yes, mostly'. 'What's a day that almost made you quit — and why didn't you?' gets ten minutes you'll never forget. Same person, same knowledge; the question decided which one you got.

3 APPLY IT

Write eight questions for your first confirmed interview: two about how they started, two about the hardest parts, two about what surprised them, one 'tell me about the time…', and one you're slightly scared to ask. Then star the three you'd keep if you only got ten minutes.

4 REFLECT

Look at your eight: how many could be answered by their website or a search? Replace those — what does that rule teach you about what an interview is actually *for*?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Test your starred three on a family member, having them role-play the interviewee. Which question made them think longest before answering? That pause is what you're hunting.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach a sibling or friend the open-vs-closed question game at dinner: take turns turning dull questions into story questions, and score whose version gets the longer answer.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Write your eight before consulting anything — the questions carry your curiosity, which is the one thing the interview runs on. Afterwards, two fair uses: ask AI what a beginner typically fails to ask people in this field, and check your list against it; and cut questions whose answers are already public. What you must not do is walk in with a machine's script — the follow-ups, which matter most, can only come from you listening.

You'll need: Question sheet (8 questions, 3 starred)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Eight questions exist with three starred, none answerable by a basic search.
☐ The starred three were tested on a stand-in and the strongest identified.

Unlocks after: The message that gets a yes

4 Run the interview

~60 min

1 CONCEPT

The interview is won by listening, not performing. Talk 20%, listen 80%. Let silences sit — people fill them with the good stuff. Follow the interesting thread even if it breaks your question order; your list is a safety net, not a script. Capture as you go: short notes for facts, full attention for stories, and always ask permission before recording anything.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen interviewing a paramedic froze when her third question got answered in one word. Then she used the rescue line — 'what happened next?' — and the paramedic talked for eight unplanned minutes about a night that changed his career. None of it was on her sheet. All of it was the interview.

3 APPLY IT

Run your first interview. Open by thanking them and saying what you're hoping to learn in one line. Ask your starred questions, chase at least one unplanned thread, and close with: 'what should I have asked that I didn't?' Write your notes up within an hour, while it's warm — then run the second interview within the fortnight.

4 REFLECT

Where did you talk when you should have listened? What was the best thing they said — and did it come from a planned question or a follow-up?

5 GET FEEDBACK

At the end of each interview, ask directly: 'how was that to be interviewed by me — anything I should do differently next time?' Adults give gold feedback to teens who ask for it straight.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Retell the best story from your interview to your family at dinner — properly, with the details that made it land. Retelling is both the retention step and the proof you were actually listening.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Nothing about the live hour can be delegated — the listening, the silences, the followed thread are the entire craft. Two hard rules: never record or transcribe a person without asking first, and never paste someone's private words into an AI tool without their permission — what they gave you, they gave *you*. After writing your own notes, it's fine to use AI to help organise them; the hour itself belongs to humans.

You'll need: Interview one-pager (starred questions + note space + closing question)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Two interviews were completed with notes written up within a day.
☐ At least one unplanned follow-up thread per interview is visible in the notes.

Unlocks after: Questions that open people up

5 Write it up, say thanks, keep the door open

~45 min

1 CONCEPT

An interview isn't finished when the call ends. Three moves complete it: a thank-you within two days that names the specific thing that helped you most; a write-up that shares what you learned (your Q1 publishing skills, back on stage); and the long game — a door left open is worth more than the hour itself. Adults remember teens who close the loop, because almost nobody does.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Six months after interviewing a local shop owner, a teen messaged her: 'I used your advice about starting smaller — here's the stall it turned into.' She replied the same day and offered him a market slot. The interview got him an hour; the closed loop got him an ally.

3 APPLY IT

Send both thank-yous, naming the one specific insight each person gave you. Then write and publish your piece — the two or three things you learned that nobody had told you before — where your Q1 audience can read it, and send each interviewee the link.

4 REFLECT

What did you learn across the two interviews that genuinely surprised you? And what did you learn about *yourself* between outreach number one and interview number two?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Note what each interviewee says when you send them the write-up — whether they correct something, share it, or offer more. Their reaction is feedback on both your listening and your writing.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Coach one friend through the full ladder — list, message, questions, interview, thank-you, write-up — for a person *they* want to learn from. When their thank-you note goes out, you've taught the whole skill.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The thank-you must be handwritten-level personal — one specific detail from *your* conversation — and the write-up must be in your voice, since your name is on it and the interviewee will read it. Fine uses: AI as proofreader, and as an organiser for your quotes (with the speaker's permission to share them). The relationship itself — the door you're keeping open — can only be maintained by a human. That's the asset. Guard it.

You'll need: Thank-you checklist + write-up template (3 things nobody had told me)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Both thank-you notes were sent within two days, each naming a specific insight.
☐ The write-up is published and the link was sent to both interviewees.

Unlocks after: Run the interview

BUILD · Q1

Build Something People Keep Using

bu-13-14-q1 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14 a teen can sustain a multi-week build–test loop, debug systematically instead of by frustration, and teach themselves a new tool from scratch when the project demands it. What drives them now is competence *witnessed by peers* — a build that stays invisible gets abandoned, however good it is. So the build must live in front of its users early. Frustration tolerance is better than at 11, but progress still needs to be visible weekly or motivation leaks away.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when something you made becomes **part of someone's routine** — used a second time, without being asked. Not the demo, not the compliment: the return visit. A teen who has watched three real people come back to their tool has learned the difference between 'I built something' and 'I built something useful', and that difference is the whole craft.

MOTIVATION LEVER — PEER STATUS

The tool is built for a real group the teen already belongs to — the class, the team, the club, the family group chat — and it lives where the whole group can see it. Being 'the one who built the thing we actually use' is visible competence, which is exactly the status currency of this age. Watching people actually use your thing, in public, does the motivating; no adult needs to push.

THE ARTIFACT

A working tool — digital or physical: a shared tracker, a sign-up system, a small app, a spreadsheet automation, a physical organiser — that a real group the teen belongs to has used more than once, plus a usage log and a change log showing at least one v2 change made because of what the users actually did.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The tool exists, works, and at least three people in the target group have used it at least twice.
- A written usage log and change log exist, with at least one change driven by observed use rather than opinions.
- The teen can explain how every part of the tool works.

1 Find a recurring pain

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

A one-off problem earns you one thank-you. A *recurring* problem earns you users. Builders hunt for things a group does repeatedly and grumbles about every time — collecting money for something, remembering whose turn it is, sharing the same information again and again. Repetition is what turns a fix into a tool.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen noticed his football team spent ten minutes of every practice arguing about who was bringing what to the next match. One shared checklist, pinned in the team chat, killed the argument — and because the problem returned weekly, so did the users.

3 APPLY IT

Watch the groups you belong to for a week. List five things a group does repeatedly and grumbles about. For each, note how often it happens and who feels it. Circle the one that recurs most often for the most people — that's your build.

4 REFLECT

Which problems on your list happen weekly or more, and which happened only once? Why would building for the once-off feel productive but be a trap?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Describe the circled pain — just the pain, not your solution — to two people in that group. Ask: 'how annoying is this, honestly, out of ten?' Write their numbers down.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a parent or friend the difference between a one-off problem and a recurring one, and why builders should chase the second. Use your own list as the example.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The noticing must be yours — AI doesn't know your team's chat or what your class grumbles about, and generic 'problems teens have' lists will point you at things nobody around you actually feels. After you've chosen, it's fair to ask AI how other groups solve this pain — copy the boring parts of their answers, and keep the part that fits *your* group yours.

You'll need: Recurring-pain log (pain / how often / who feels it)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Five observed recurring pains are logged with frequency and who feels them.
☐ One is circled, and two group members rated its annoyance.

2 Scope the smallest useful version

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Version one is the smallest thing that is *genuinely useful this week* — not the dream version. The core builder's skill isn't adding features; it's deciding what v1 will NOT do, and writing that list down before you start. Every feature you postpone is time your users get the tool sooner.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The team-checklist teen imagined an app with logins, reminders, and stats. What he shipped in week one was a single shared checklist with names next to items. It solved the argument at the very next practice. The dream version would still have been half-built a month later — solving nothing.

3 APPLY IT

Write one sentence: what v1 does, for whom, by when (within two weeks). Then write the NOT list — at least three tempting features v1 will not have — and one line on what v1 will be made of (chat pin, shared doc, spreadsheet, cardboard — whatever ships fastest).

4 REFLECT

Look at your NOT list. Which feature was hardest to postpone? Is that because users need it — or because building it sounds fun? Those are different reasons.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your v1 sentence to one person from the group and ask: 'if this existed next week, would you actually use it?' If they hesitate, the scope is wrong — adjust before building anything.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

A friend has a big project idea? Teach them the NOT list. Help them write what their version one will refuse to do — and watch how much more real the project instantly becomes.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Scoping is judgment, and the judgment must be yours: ask AI to plan your tool and it will cheerfully design the ten-feature dream version — that's the trap this lesson exists to avoid. The one sharp use is the opposite direction: show it your v1 plan and ask 'what would you cut?' If it finds something, cut it.

You'll need: v1 scope card (does / for whom / by when / NOT list)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A one-sentence v1 scope and a NOT list of 3+ postponed features exist.
☐ One group member confirmed they'd use v1 as scoped.

Unlocks after: Find a recurring pain

3 Ship it to the group

~60 min

1 CONCEPT

'Done' doesn't mean finished — it means *in their hands*. Put v1 where the group already is, tell them what it's for in one sentence, and then watch the first real uses. Something will break or confuse in front of you. Good: fixing what breaks in front of users is the fastest building there is.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The checklist went into the team chat on a Tuesday. Within an hour two players couldn't edit it — permissions. Fixed in five minutes, *because the builder was watching*. If he'd polished it privately for another month, he'd have found that bug a month later, in front of everyone, with less goodwill.

3 APPLY IT

Build v1 within your scope and ship it to the group this week — post it, pin it, hand it out. Announce it in one sentence: what it's for and how to use it. Stay close for the first uses and fix the first thing that breaks or confuses, the same day.

4 REFLECT

What was the gap between how you imagined the first use and what actually happened? What did shipping feel like — and did any of the fears come true?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask the first two users one question each: 'what nearly stopped you using it?' Fix the biggest answer within a day and tell them you fixed it — users who see their feedback land come back.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell the story of your first hour after shipping — what broke, what you fixed — to a friend who's afraid to show anyone their project. Make the case that shipping early is safer than polishing in private, not braver.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use AI freely for the boring parts of the build — a spreadsheet formula, a code snippet, a template; tools are disposable and speed is a real gain. One hard rule: you must understand every part well enough to fix it when it breaks in front of a user, because it will. If AI produced a part you can't explain, rebuild that part simpler — a tool its builder can't repair isn't yours.

You'll need: Ship-day checklist (announce line / where posted / first fixes)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ v1 is live in the place the group actually gathers, announced in one sentence.
☐ The first breaking or confusing thing was found and fixed the same day.

Unlocks after: Scope the smallest useful version

4 Watch what they do, not what they say

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

People will tell you your tool is 'cool' and never open it again; others will grumble and use it every day. Opinions are polite; usage is honest. From today your instrument panel is the usage log: who used it, when, unprompted or reminded. A second unprompted use is the only compliment that counts.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen built a homework-sharing doc. Everyone said it was a great idea — the log showed three people opened it once and nobody came back. The praise said 'build more'; the log said 'something's wrong'. The log was right: it was three taps too far away. Moved into the class chat, real usage started.

3 APPLY IT

Keep a usage log for one week: each real use — who, when, and whether they came back without being reminded. Rough counts are fine; honesty isn't optional. At week's end, write the single clearest pattern the log shows.

4 REFLECT

Where do what-they-said and what-they-did disagree in your log? Which do you instinctively want to believe — and what does the log actually tell you to do?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show the log's pattern to one heavy user and one non-user. Ask the non-user only: 'what stopped you?' Their answer plus the log is your v2 brief.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the sentence 'usage is the only honest feedback' with your own log as evidence — show them where politeness and behaviour disagreed and which one turned out to be true.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Count real uses yourself — the log must record what actually happened, and no model can see your group. Don't ask AI to *guess* why people aren't using the tool; ask the people, or watch them. Once you have a real log and real answers, AI is fine for a second opinion on the pattern — but the data comes from the world, never from the machine.

You'll need: Usage log sheet (who / when / prompted or unprompted)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A week-long usage log exists with unprompted repeat uses marked.
☐ One written pattern from the log, plus a non-user's 'what stopped you' answer, are recorded.

Unlocks after: Ship it to the group

5 Version two, from evidence

~45 min

1 CONCEPT

v2 is not 'add the features I postponed' — it's 'change what the evidence demands'. Take the usage log and the non-user answers, choose the one change most likely to increase real use, make it, and measure again. Keep or kill by evidence. That loop — ship, watch, change, watch — is the entire craft of building, and you now own it.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Real product teams run exactly this loop: they propose a change, predict what it will do to usage, ship it, and check. Half their smart-sounding changes do nothing — which is why they measure instead of argue. Your checklist tool is small; the loop is the same one.

3 APPLY IT

Write a change log entry: the change, and a one-line prediction of what it will do to usage. Make the change, tell the group in one sentence, and log another week of use. Compare before and after — did the evidence match your prediction? Keep or roll back accordingly.

4 REFLECT

Did your change do what you predicted? If not — what did the users know that you didn't? And which postponed feature from your NOT list now looks like it was never needed at all?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show a before/after usage comparison to the group's most honest member and ask: 'what one change would make you use this twice as much?' That answer is v3's brief — whether or not you build it this quarter.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach the full loop — recurring pain, smallest version, ship, watch usage, change from evidence — to a friend with a project idea, and stay with them until their v1 is actually in front of real users.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The decision of *what* to change comes from your log and your users — never from a model's feature ideas, which are guesses about a group it has never met. Once you've chosen the change, AI is a fine assistant for implementing it. Predict first, then measure: if you let AI both choose and build, you're no longer the builder — you're the audience.

You'll need: Change log template (change / prediction / result / keep-or-rollback)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A change log entry exists with a prediction and a measured before/after result.
☐ The keep-or-rollback decision is written down with its evidence.

Unlocks after: Watch what they do, not what they say

BUILD · Q2

Automate the Boring Part

bu-13-14-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, a teen can decompose a task into steps, express rules ('if this, then that'), and learn a tool from a tutorial without an adult driving — the raw material of automation. What's new at this age is the ability to think about *process itself*: to watch themselves do a chore and see the loop inside it. What still needs scaffolding is honesty about results — teens (like adults) fall in love with what they built and stop measuring whether it actually helps.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, building creates value when it **gives time back** — theirs or someone else's, every single week, without further effort. An automation that reliably saves twenty minutes a week is a machine that manufactures freedom. Learning that you can *build* leverage instead of just spending effort is one of the biggest ideas a 13-year-old can own, and this quarter makes it physical.

MOTIVATION LEVER — MASTERY

The quarter runs on a visible scoreboard: minutes saved per week, measured before and after, honestly. Watching a thing you built quietly do work while you don't is intrinsically addictive — and the measured number turns 'I made a cool thing' into 'I made a thing that provably works', which is the mastery feeling that keeps builders building.

THE ARTIFACT

One working automation — a spreadsheet that fills itself, a phone shortcut, a no-code workflow, a small script, a template pipeline — that removes a genuinely repeated task, with a before/after time measurement, a one-page 'how it works' note, and a keep-or-kill verdict based on the real numbers.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A real repeated task was measured before automation and the automation now performs it, with the weekly minutes saved written down.
- The automation survived at least one weird input or edge case, or was fenced so the weird case is handled by a human on purpose.
- A one-page 'how it works' note exists that another person could use to understand and fix it.
- The teen can explain every part of how the automation works.

Unlocks after: Build Something People Keep Using

1 Hunt the repetition

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Automation candidates hide in plain sight: tasks that are *repeated* and *rule-based* — done the same way every time, on a schedule, by rote. The hunt is a time audit: for a week, log the tasks you (or your family, or your Q1 tool's group) do repeatedly. If you can write the rule for doing it, a machine can probably follow the rule.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen logged her week and found she spent ~25 minutes every Sunday copying the week's homework deadlines from four class chats into her planner. Repeated: weekly. Rule-based: completely. That half-hour was a machine's job wearing a human's name.

3 APPLY IT

Run a five-day time audit: log every task you notice yourself or your household repeating, with rough minutes and how often. Mark each as rule-based or judgment-based. Circle the best candidate: most minutes × most rule-based. Write its rule out in plain words.

4 REFLECT

How many minutes a week does your circled task actually eat? Multiply by 52 — what does the yearly number make you feel about 'it only takes a few minutes'?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your audit to someone in your household and ask what repeated task *they'd* pay to never do again. Their answer either confirms your circle or gives you a better one with a built-in grateful user.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach a friend the two-question test — 'is it repeated? is it rule-based?' — and help them find one automation candidate in their own week.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The audit must come from watching your real week — AI can't see your Sundays, and generic 'tasks teens can automate' lists point at nobody's actual life. Once you've circled a candidate, asking AI 'how do people usually automate X?' is a fine scout for what's possible. But choose the target with your own eyes first.

You'll need: Time-audit log (task / minutes / frequency / rule-based?)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A five-day audit exists with minutes and frequency per repeated task.
☐ One candidate is circled with its rule written in plain words.

2 Draw the flow before you build

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Every automation is the same shape: input → steps → output. Drawing that flow on paper *before* touching any tool is what separates an afternoon of building from a week of thrashing. The drawing forces the two questions that kill most automations later: where exactly does the input come from, and what happens when the input is weird?

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The homework-deadline teen drew her flow: input = messages in four chats; steps = spot dates, extract subject + due date; output = planner rows. The drawing immediately exposed the hard part — the messages weren't written in any standard way. Knowing where the hard part is *before* building is the whole point of the drawing.

3 APPLY IT

Draw your automation's flow: the input and where it lives, each step as a box with its rule, the output and where it goes. Then add a 'weird input' list — at least three ways the input could arrive broken or strange — and mark which step each weird case would hit.

4 REFLECT

Which box in your flow is the hard one? Is it hard because the rule is complicated — or because the input is messier than you admitted in lesson one?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Walk someone through your drawing box by box and have them play saboteur: 'what if the input is empty? doubled? in the wrong format?' Every break they find on paper is an hour saved in the build.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach the input→steps→output shape to someone using a non-computer example — making breakfast, doing laundry — and have them draw one. The shape is the lesson; the tool never was.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Draw the flow yourself — the drawing is you *understanding* the task, and skipping it means building something you don't understand. Then a genuinely strong AI use: describe your flow and ask 'what edge cases am I missing?' Machines are excellent at imagining broken inputs. Add the good ones to your weird list — with a note of which ones you missed, because that's your blind spot showing.

You'll need: Flow-drawing sheet (input / steps / output / weird-input list)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A complete flow drawing exists with input, rule-labelled steps, and output.
☐ A weird-input list of 3+ cases exists, each mapped to the step it would break.

Unlocks after: Hunt the repetition

3 Build it with any lever

~60 min

1 CONCEPT

Tools are disposable; the flow is forever. Build the drawn flow with whatever lever ships fastest — spreadsheet formulas, a phone shortcuts app, a no-code automation, a template, a tiny script. Rule of the build: make the *smallest version that completes one real run end-to-end*, today if possible. A half-automation that runs beats a full one that doesn't exist.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The deadline teen's v1 wasn't clever: a spreadsheet where she pasted the four chats' messages into one column, and formulas pulled out anything that looked like a date. Not magic — but Sunday went from 25 minutes to 6 on the very first run, and v1 taught her exactly what v2 needed.

3 APPLY IT

Pick your lever and build the smallest end-to-end version of your flow. Run it once on real input, today's or last week's. Log what worked, what needed a human shove, and how long the run took versus your before-measurement.

4 REFLECT

Where did the build match your drawing, and where did reality disagree with the plan? What did the first real run teach you that no amount of planning would have?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Demo the working v1 to the person who feels this pain (maybe you — then demo to your household anyway). Ask: 'would you trust this to do the task without checking it?' Their hesitation points at exactly what v2 must fix.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Show a friend the before and after of your task, then help them build the smallest version of *their* candidate from lesson one — in any tool. Getting someone else's first automation running cements every step of yours.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is the lesson where AI shines as a lever: formulas, shortcut recipes, snippets of code — ask for them freely, tools are disposable. One law, same as your Q1 tool: **you must understand every part well enough to fix it when it breaks**, because automations break quietly and wrong. If AI hands you a piece you can't explain, make it explain the piece until you can — or rebuild that piece simpler. An automation you can't repair isn't leverage; it's a debt.

You'll need: Build log (lever chosen / first-run result / time vs. before)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A smallest end-to-end version ran on real input at least once.
☐ The first run's time was logged against the before-measurement.

Unlocks after: Draw the flow before you build

4 Break it on purpose

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

An automation that works on nice input is a demo. One that survives *weird* input is a tool. Today you attack your own build with the weird-input list from your drawing: empty inputs, doubles, wrong formats, the message written by the one teacher who never writes dates like anyone else. For each break: fix it, or *fence* it — make the automation stop and hand the weird case to a human on purpose.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Real engineers do this daily; they call it testing, and the good ones are proud of how hard they attack their own work. The deadline spreadsheet's famous failure: a teacher wrote 'next Friday' instead of a date. The fix wasn't teaching the sheet English — it was a fence: anything unparseable lands in a 'check me' box for human eyes. Fences are not defeats; they're design.

3 APPLY IT

Run every case on your weird-input list through the automation, plus two new weird cases invented today. Log each result: passed, fixed, or fenced. The goal isn't zero fences — it's zero *silent* failures: nothing weird may pass through looking normal.

4 REFLECT

Which break surprised you most? What's the difference in consequences between an automation that fails loudly and one that fails silently — and which kind had you built?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Hand the automation to someone else with the instruction 'try to break this'. Outsiders find breaks the builder can't imagine. Log and handle whatever they find.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach someone the demo-versus-tool distinction and the idea of a fence, using your own best break as the example. If they can explain why a loud failure beats a silent one, it landed.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Ask AI to invent attacks — 'here's what my automation does; list ten inputs that might break it' — that's the machine doing exactly what it's good at, and every attack it invents is free testing. The judgment calls stay yours: which breaks are worth fixing, which get fenced, and what the fence hands to the human. Never let 'the AI says it handles it' replace running the weird case for real.

You'll need: Break log (case / result / fixed-or-fenced)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Every weird-input case was actually run, with results logged as passed, fixed, or fenced.
☐ No weird case can pass through silently looking normal.

Unlocks after: Build it with any lever

5 Did it actually save time?

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

The last discipline is the honest ledger. Total time invested building versus minutes saved per week — divide, and you get the payback point: the week the machine breaks even. Some automations never do, and finding that out from your own numbers is not failure; it's the lesson that separates builders from tinkerers. Then write the one-page note that lets someone else run and fix it — leverage you have to babysit isn't leverage yet.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The deadline sheet: about six hours to build and debug, saves 19 minutes a week — payback in around 19 weeks, then pure profit every Sunday after, forever. Her friend's elaborate chore-wheel bot: eleven hours to build, saved four minutes a week, abandoned in a month. Same skills, honest ledgers, opposite verdicts — and both teens learned exactly the right thing.

3 APPLY IT

Fill in the ledger: hours invested, weekly minutes saved (measured across at least two real runs, not guessed), payback week. Write the keep-or-kill verdict and why. Then write the one-page 'how it works' note — what it does, where the pieces live, what the fences catch, how to fix the two most likely breaks — and have someone else run one cycle using only the note.

4 REFLECT

Does your ledger say keep or kill — and would you have believed that verdict in week one? What would you automate differently next time, knowing the build cost runs double the guess?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Present the ledger and the note to your household or group: numbers, verdict, and what the fences catch. Ask whether they'd trust the automation running unattended — and what would earn that trust if not.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach the payback-point idea to a friend with their own build: help them fill in the same ledger and reach an honest verdict. If you can talk someone through *killing* an automation they love because the numbers say so, you own this quarter.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The measurements must be real and yours — enthusiasm cooks numbers, and an AI asked 'estimate how much time this saves' will happily hallucinate a flattering figure. Measure with a clock. AI is fine help for drafting the how-it-works note from your bullet points — but walk the final note yourself against the real automation, because documentation that's *almost* right is worse than none when something breaks at 11pm.

You'll need: Payback ledger + one-page how-it-works template

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A completed ledger exists with measured (not guessed) weekly savings and a payback week.
☐ A keep-or-kill verdict is written, and someone else ran one cycle using only the how-it-works note.

Unlocks after: Break it on purpose

CREATE WEALTH · Q1

Ship a Real Micro-Offer

cw-13-14-q1 · supporting: Communicate, Build

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, abstract reasoning is coming online: a teen can hold a hypothesis, test it, and revise. Peer standing is now a dominant social force — being *seen* as competent matters more than adult approval. They can handle real transactions and real rejection, and money stops being abstract. What they can't yet do reliably is sit with delayed payoff, so feedback loops must be short and visible.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, 'creating value' means a **real stranger voluntarily pays or opts in** — not a parent buying to be kind, not a simulation. The unit of proof is the first genuine yes from someone with no obligation to say it. Scale, margin, and branding come later; the whole quarter turns on crossing from 'imagined customer' to 'real one'.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The teen sets a public, concrete target — first RM100 (or $100) of genuine revenue, or first 20 real opt-ins — and reports progress to a small group of peers doing the same. Real money and visible peer progress do the motivating; the adult never has to nag. The stakes are small enough to be safe and real enough to sting, which is exactly the range that drives effort at this age.

THE ARTIFACT

A live micro-offer (product or service) with a written one-line value proposition, a price, and a record of its first real customer interactions — captured in a simple one-page 'offer sheet' plus a running tally of yeses and nos.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- The child can state, in one sentence, who the offer is for and what problem it solves.
- At least three real people outside the family were asked to buy or opt in, and the responses (yes/no + why) are written down.
- The child can explain why they set the price they set.

1 Value = someone else's problem, solved

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Value isn't how hard you worked or how cool your idea is — it's whether it removes a problem *someone else* actually has. If no one has the problem, there's no value, however clever the solution.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A 14-year-old noticed neighbours struggling to set up new phones. She didn't build an app — she offered a 30-minute 'new phone setup' visit for RM20. The problem was real and annoying enough that people paid.

3 APPLY IT

Write down five real problems you've personally watched someone struggle with in the last month. Not global problems — small, specific, local ones. Circle the one where you could imagine helping this week.

4 REFLECT

Which of your five is a problem *you* find interesting versus one *others* actually feel? Are they the same? If not, which should win?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Read your circled problem to one person who fits the group that has it. Ask: 'Is this actually annoying to you, or only a little?' Write down their exact answer.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to a younger sibling or friend, in under a minute, why a brilliant idea nobody needs is worth nothing. Use your own example.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use AI to *broaden* your problem list — 'what do people my age's parents commonly find annoying about tech?' — after you've written your own five. Do NOT let it generate the list first: the point is to train your own noticing. And never let AI tell you whether a problem is real; only a real person you ask can answer that.

You'll need: Problem-spotting worksheet (5 rows + circle)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Five real, specific, observed problems are written down.
☐ One is circled with a reason it was chosen.

2 Find one real person, not an imaginary market

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

Beginners invent a giant 'everyone' who wants their thing. Real founders find *one* actual person first. One real yes teaches more than a thousand imagined ones.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Before building anything, a teen selling custom study playlists messaged three classmates by name and asked if they'd use one. Two said yes, one said 'only if it's free' — which taught him his price was the problem, not his product.

3 APPLY IT

Name three specific real people (first names, people you can actually reach) who have the problem you circled. Not 'students' — actual humans.

4 REFLECT

Was it easy or hard to name three? If it was hard, that's a signal — maybe fewer people have this problem than you thought. What does that tell you?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Message or speak to one of the three. Just describe the problem, not your solution, and ask if they recognise it. Write down whether they lit up or shrugged.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell a parent the difference between 'my market is teenagers' and 'my first customer is Aisha in my class', and why the second is more useful.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

AI can help you script an opening message so you're not awkward — a fine use. But it cannot be your customer. If you catch yourself asking AI 'would people want this?' instead of asking a person, stop: you're using the machine to avoid the scary-but-essential step of talking to a human.

You'll need: Named-customer worksheet (3 slots)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ Three named, reachable people are listed.
☐ At least one was actually contacted and their reaction recorded.

Unlocks after: Value = someone else's problem, solved

3 Price is a question, not a guess

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

A price is really a question you ask the market: 'is it worth this to you?' A 'no' isn't failure — it's an answer that tells you where the real line is.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The phone-setup teen first said RM10, and everyone said yes instantly — which meant it was too cheap. She raised it to RM25; some said no, most still said yes. The 'some no' is how she knew she'd found roughly the right number.

3 APPLY IT

Pick a starting price for your offer and write one sentence on why. Then write the price you'd raise to if the first three people all say yes too easily.

4 REFLECT

How did it feel to attach a number to your own work? If it felt too high, is that the price talking or your nerves talking?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Say your price out loud to one person in your target group and watch their face before they answer. Note the reaction — the pause before 'yes' is data.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain to someone why a price that everyone accepts instantly might actually be a mistake.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Ask AI how similar things are priced to get a rough range — useful reference. Then ignore it if your real three people tell you something different. The people paying always outrank the model guessing.

You'll need: Pricing worksheet (start price + raise-to price)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A starting price and a reason are written down.
☐ The price was said to at least one real person and their reaction noted.

Unlocks after: Find one real person, not an imaginary market

4 The one-line offer

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

If you can't say what you do in one sentence, the customer can't either — and a confused customer never buys. The offer sentence is: I help [who] do [what] so they [benefit].

2 REAL EXAMPLE

'I help busy neighbours set up a new phone in 30 minutes so they don't lose their photos or spend a whole afternoon.' One sentence, and the buyer instantly knows if it's for them.

3 APPLY IT

Write your offer in that exact template. Then cut every word that isn't doing work. Read it aloud — if you stumble, it's not clean yet.

4 REFLECT

Which was harder to pin down — the *who*, the *what*, or the *benefit*? The hard one is usually the part of your idea that's still fuzzy.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show the sentence to two people. Ask each to tell you, in their words, what you're offering. If they get it wrong, the sentence — not the listener — needs fixing.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend write *their* one-line offer using the template. Teaching the format is the fastest way to own it.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

This is a good place to let AI give you five rewrites of your sentence to react against — it's a sharp editor. But you must choose and finalise the line yourself, out loud, in your own voice. If the sentence sounds like a robot wrote it, your customer will feel it.

You'll need: Offer-sheet template (one page)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A single-sentence offer exists in the who/what/benefit format.
☐ Two people were able to correctly restate it back.

Unlocks after: Price is a question, not a guess

5 The first real ask

~45 min

1 CONCEPT

Everything so far was preparation. The venture becomes real the moment you ask someone to actually say yes and pay or commit. Rejection here is the tuition — every no carries a reason you can use.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen selling handmade bracelets got four nos before the first yes. The nos weren't random: three said 'too expensive', so she offered a two-for-one and the yeses started. The rejections wrote her next move.

3 APPLY IT

Make your first three real asks this week. Record each as: who, yes/no, and the reason they gave. Aim for the first genuine yes.

4 REFLECT

What did the nos have in common? A pattern in your nos is more valuable than a lucky yes — what is yours telling you to change?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Bring your yes/no tally to your peer group or mentor. Together, name the single change most likely to turn the next no into a yes.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Tell someone the story of your first no and what it taught you. Framing rejection as information — not failure — is the skill you're really building.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Use AI afterward to help you spot patterns across your nos if you're stuck. Do NOT use it to avoid making the asks — no model can make the first real ask for you, and that discomfort is the whole point of the quarter.

You'll need: Yes/No tally sheet (who / result / reason)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ At least three real asks were made and logged with reasons.
☐ The child can name one pattern in the responses and one change they'll make next.

Unlocks after: The one-line offer

CREATE WEALTH · Q2

Know Your Numbers

cw-13-14-q2 · supporting: Think

WHAT'S DEVELOPMENTALLY REAL AT THIS AGE

At 13–14, abstract quantities become workable: a teen can hold ratios, percentages, and per-unit thinking, and — crucially — can now treat *their own time* as a quantity with value, which younger children genuinely cannot. Having run a real micro-offer, they have real numbers of their own to reason about, which changes everything: arithmetic about your own money is a different subject from arithmetic about apples. The trap at this age is motivated math — bending the numbers to protect the venture they're proud of.

WHAT "CREATING VALUE" MEANS HERE

At this age, wealth-thinking creates value when the teen can look at their own venture and answer, with evidence: **am I actually making money, per unit and per hour — and what should I change because of it?** Revenue is applause; margin is truth. A 13-year-old who has once computed their real hourly earnings and *acted* on it owns an idea most adults still avoid.

MOTIVATION LEVER — REAL STAKES

The numbers under the microscope are the teen's own — their real offer, their real costs, their real Saturday afternoons. The quarter ends in a real decision (raise the price, cut a cost, change the offer, or drop it) that changes what lands in their pocket next month. Getting the math right literally pays; getting it wrong literally costs. No worksheet can compete with that.

THE ARTIFACT

A one-page money picture of the teen's real micro-offer: true per-unit cost (materials and time included), effective hourly rate, margin, and a simple profit summary — plus one pricing or cost decision actually made and carried out because of what the numbers showed.

PROJECT SUCCESS CRITERIA

- A written per-unit cost exists for the offer that includes materials, fees, and the teen's time.
- The teen can state their effective hourly rate and how it was computed.
- One real decision (price change, cost cut, offer change, or drop) was made from the numbers and actually carried out.
- The teen can explain the difference between revenue and profit using their own figures.

Unlocks after: Ship a Real Micro-Offer

1 What does one really cost?

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Most young sellers know their price and almost nothing else. The first real number is the true cost of *one* — one bracelet, one phone-setup visit, one commission. True cost means everything: materials, packaging, fees, transport, the free samples, the failed batch. Until you know what one costs, your price is a guess and your profit is a rumor.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

A teen selling cookies at RM2 each 'made money' every weekend — until she costed one cookie honestly: ingredients 60 sen, packaging 15, stall share 25, plus the burnt tray split across the batch. True cost: RM1.15. Her 'RM2 profit per cookie' was actually 85 sen. Still profit — but half of what she was celebrating.

3 APPLY IT

Cost one unit of your real offer, honestly: list every material and fee, split shared costs (equipment, transport, spoilage) across the batch, and land on a true cost-per-unit. If you sell a service, cost one *delivery* of it. Keep the working — the working is the artifact.

4 REFLECT

Which cost surprised you most by existing at all? What were you unconsciously leaving out — and why is it always the costs that make the venture look better?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your cost sheet to an adult who buys things for a household and ask: 'what am I still forgetting?' Household veterans find invisible costs instantly. Add what they catch.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Take a product a friend or sibling loves — a bubble tea, a game skin — and work out together what one probably costs to make versus what it sells for. Teach them the phrase 'true cost of one'.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The costs must come from your receipts and your reality — a model asked 'what does it cost to make cookies?' invents a generic bakery, not yours. Use AI as a checklist-checker after your own pass: 'here are my cost categories for X; what do sellers of X usually forget?' Take the categories it suggests, then fill in real numbers yourself. Never let it fill in a number.

You'll need: Cost-of-one worksheet (materials / fees / shared costs / true cost)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A written true cost-per-unit exists with every category included and shared costs split.
☐ At least one previously invisible cost was found and added.

2 Your hour has a price

~35 min

1 CONCEPT

The biggest cost in a teen venture never appears on a receipt: your time. Total the hours one unit really takes — making, selling, travelling, messaging — and divide your profit by them. That's your *effective hourly rate*, and it's the venture's most honest number. It doesn't tell you to quit; it tells you what the venture must beat, and what your time is currently teaching you it's worth.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The cookie teen: 85 sen profit per cookie, about 40 cookies per weekend — RM34. But baking, packing, selling and cleaning took nine hours: RM3.80 an hour. A neighbourhood car-wash gig pays RM10. She didn't quit cookies — she decided the extra RM6/hour was the price of learning to run something of her own. But now it was a *decision*, not a blur.

3 APPLY IT

Track or reconstruct the full hours behind your last batch or week of the offer — every stage, honestly. Compute your effective hourly rate: total profit ÷ total hours. Write one sentence: 'my venture currently pays me RM__ per hour, and that is/isn't fine because ___.'

4 REFLECT

Is your rate higher or lower than you assumed? If a friend offered you that rate to do the same work for *them*, would you take it — and what does your answer tell you?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Ask a working adult what they'd say to your hourly rate and your 'because' sentence. Their reaction — impressed, alarmed, or nodding — is context you can't compute.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach a friend with a side hustle to compute their own effective hourly rate. Warn them it might sting, and teach the follow-up line: the number isn't a verdict, it's information.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The hours must be tracked or honestly reconstructed by you — nobody else was there, and rounding your hours down is the most popular way ventures lie to their owners. AI can help with the arithmetic and with framing comparisons ('what do typical part-time options pay a 13-year-old?') — but if you catch yourself wanting the machine to make the number look better, stop: the number is doing its job.

You'll need: Hours log + hourly-rate calculation sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A full hours count for one batch/week exists, all stages included.
☐ The effective hourly rate is computed with a written 'and that is/isn't fine because' sentence.

Unlocks after: What does one really cost?

3 Margin is the game

~30 min

1 CONCEPT

Margin is the slice of each sale you actually keep: (price − true cost) ÷ price. It's the number that decides whether growth helps or hurts — selling more of a zero-margin thing just makes you busier. And there are exactly three levers that move it: raise the price, cut the cost, or cut the time. Every business decision you'll ever see is someone pulling one of the three.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Two stalls sell drinks. One sells 100 cups at 10 sen margin (RM10). The other sells 30 cups at 60 sen margin (RM18) — less work, more money. The busy stall *looks* more successful all day long. Margin is why looks lie, and why 'how many did you sell?' is the amateur question. The pro question is 'what do you keep per sale?'

3 APPLY IT

Compute your offer's margin from lessons one and two. Then write one concrete idea for each lever: what raising the price could look like, which cost could shrink, which step eats time without adding value. Rank the three by how much they'd move the margin.

4 REFLECT

Which lever feels scariest to pull — and is that fear about the business, or about awkwardness (like telling customers a higher price)? Ideas that are cheap to try but feel scary are usually the underpriced ones.

5 GET FEEDBACK

Show your three lever ideas to a fellow seller (or an adult who's run anything) and ask which they'd pull first and why. Note where their pick differs from your ranking.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Explain margin to a family member using the two-stalls story, then work out together the margin on something your household buys or makes. End with the three levers — see if they can name which one supermarkets pull hardest.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

Margin math is simple enough to own with a calculator — do it yourself so the number feels like yours. Where AI helps is lever brainstorming breadth: 'how do small sellers of X usually cut costs?' will list ideas worth stealing. Where it can't help is the ranking: which lever fits *your* customers and *your* nerve is judgment, and it's the judgment this quarter is training.

You'll need: Margin worksheet + three-levers sheet

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ The offer's margin is computed and written down.
☐ One concrete idea per lever exists, ranked by expected effect.

Unlocks after: Your hour has a price

4 Run a margin experiment

~45 min

1 CONCEPT

You don't find out what a lever does by debating it — you pull it, briefly and reversibly, and measure. Pick your top-ranked lever, predict what it will do (to sales *and* margin), run it for one real selling cycle, and compare. A price rise that loses a few customers but lifts total profit is a win the spreadsheet can see and your nerves can't.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

The cookie teen raised RM2 to RM2.50 — a two-way door, tested one Saturday. Prediction: lose maybe a quarter of buyers. Reality: sold 34 instead of 40, but margin per cookie jumped from 85 sen to RM1.35. Total profit went from RM34 to RM45.90 for *less* baking. The scary lever was the profitable one — which is exactly why it had gone unpulled.

3 APPLY IT

Write the experiment card: which lever, what change, your predicted effect on sales and profit. Run it for one real cycle (one market day, one week of orders). Record actual sales, margin, and total profit next to the prediction. Keep the change or roll it back — in writing, with the reason.

4 REFLECT

What did customers actually do versus what you feared they'd do? Where does your prediction error point — do you under-rate your offer, or over-rate your customers' price-sensitivity?

5 GET FEEDBACK

If any customer pushed back or walked away, note exactly what they said — that's the market speaking. Share the before/after card with your peer group or an adult and ask what they'd test next.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Teach the experiment shape — predict, change one thing, measure one cycle, decide — to a friend with any venture, and help them run their first pricing test. The shape transfers to everything; the sooner they own it, the better.

🧭 AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO

The prediction goes down *before* the experiment and it's yours — that's how you learn what your instincts are worth (your Think decision journal should recognise this move). AI can help design a clean test ('what would make this price test unfair or misleading?') — a genuinely good use. But no model knows your customers; only the Saturday knows. Run the Saturday.

You'll need: Experiment card (lever / change / prediction / result / keep-or-rollback)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ An experiment card exists with a pre-registered prediction.

☐ One real cycle ran, results are recorded next to the prediction, and a keep-or-rollback decision is written with its reason.

Unlocks after: Margin is the game

5 The one-page money picture

~40 min

1 CONCEPT

Everything this quarter compresses onto one page: what comes in, what goes out, what one unit truly costs, what an hour of you earns, the margin, and the experiment's verdict. Businesses call it a P&L; call it your money picture. Its job is to make the next decision obvious — and to be simple enough that you'll actually keep it updated.

2 REAL EXAMPLE

Investors read a one-page summary before anything else, because a venture that can't fit its truth on a page usually doesn't know its truth. The cookie teen's page ended with one line — 'RM2.50 stays; next: cut packaging cost, it's 18% of true cost for zero taste' — which is a 13-year-old running a business by the numbers. That line is the whole quarter.

3 APPLY IT

Build your one-page money picture from the quarter's sheets. End it with two written lines: the decision you already made (and its measured result), and the *next* decision the page points to. Then act on the next decision — or schedule exactly when you will.

4 REFLECT

Looking at the finished page: is this venture worth your hours as-is, worth it after changes, or teaching you things worth more than the money? All three answers are wins — but which is true, on the evidence?

5 GET FEEDBACK

Present the page to your decision-maker or peer group in under three minutes. Take one question you can't answer from the page, and add whatever number would have answered it.

6 TEACH IT BACK ★

Help a friend with any venture — bake sales, commissions, reselling — build their own one-page money picture from scratch: cost of one, hourly rate, margin, next decision. If their page ends with a real next decision, you've taught the whole quarter.

🧭 **AI JUDGMENT — WHEN TO USE IT, AND WHEN NOT TO**

AI can lay out the page and check your arithmetic — clerical work, fine. The two ending lines it must never write: what the numbers *mean* and what you'll *do* — that's the judgment the page exists to sharpen, and outsourcing it turns your money picture back into decoration. One last honest use: show it your page and ask 'what would a skeptical investor question here?' Then answer the question yourself, with a number.

You'll need: One-page money picture template (in / out / cost-of-one / hourly / margin / decisions)

SUCCESS CHECKLIST

☐ A complete one-page money picture exists with all five numbers current.
☐ It ends with the made decision (with result) and a committed next decision.

Unlocks after: Run a margin experiment